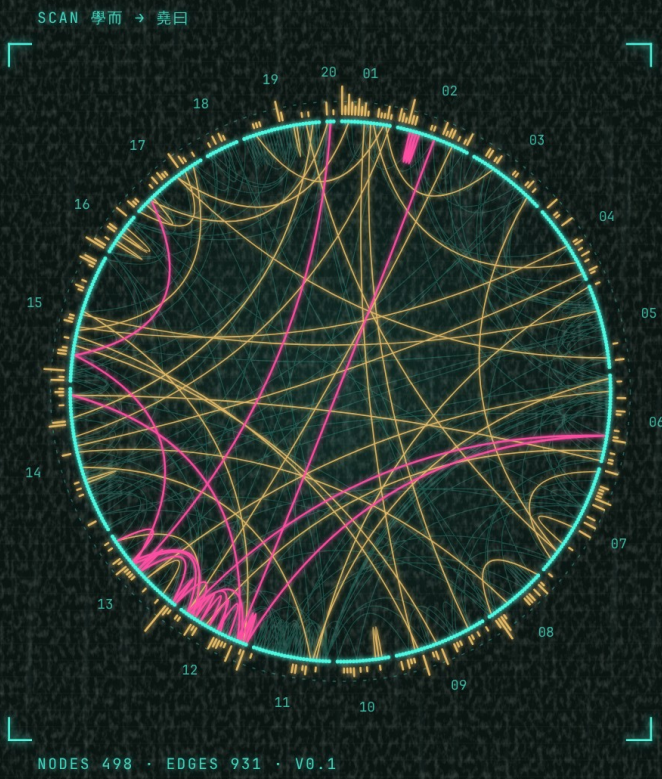
THE ANALECTS

REBUILT WITH AI



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498
chapters

931
connections

197
people

AI compared all 498 chapters with one another to find the threads; people checked every one against the page.

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The Analects Rebuilt with AI

498 chapters · 931 connections in all · every one checked against the original page

AI compared all 498 chapters with one another to find the threads; people checked every one against the page.

Compiled by Yikonglu · Base edition: Zhu Xi, Collected Commentaries on the Analects (Sibu beiyao printing)

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Quoting one chapter? Use the line at its foot, e.g. “— Analects 1.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.1”. Every page footer carries Yikonglu’s name and address too.

How to read this book

Other editions tell you how to read a chapter. This one adds a box under every chapter — “This chapter connects to” — showing which other chapters, people, books, occasions and calendar day it is tied to. Every chapter number is a link.

Three ways in. By book: from Xue er to Yao yue. By person: pick someone from the index of people and follow “next” through their life. By day: look up the calendar and read that day’s chapter.

Three labels. Each thread says where it comes from: in the text itself, a commentator’s reading (named, with book), or Yikonglu’s comparison (our own, for you to weigh). Threads we could not check against a page are left out.

The Chinese text follows Zhu Xi’s chapter division. English translations are Yikonglu’s working translations; the Chinese page at yikonglu.com is authoritative.

Contents Same question, different answers · Disciples at a glance · Xue er · Wei zheng · Ba yi · Li ren · Gongye Chang · Yong ye · Shu er · Tai bo · Zi han · Xiang dang · Xian jin · Yan Yuan · Zilu · Xian wen · Wei Ling Gong · Ji shi · Yang Huo · Weizi · Zizhang · Yao yue · Index of people · Index of occasions · Calendar: a chapter a day

Same question, different answers

Different people asked Confucius the same thing, and he answered each differently. Every answer is quoted from the text.

Asked about humaneness 8 times

6.20	Fan Chi	“The humane put the hard part first and the reward after”
12.1	Yan Yuan	“To restrain oneself and return to ritual is humaneness”
12.2	Zhonggong	“What you do not want for yourself, do not do to others”
12.3	Sima Niu	“The humane are slow to speak”
12.22	Fan Chi	“Love people”
13.19	Fan Chi	“Be respectful at home, reverent in your work, loyal to others”
15.9	Zigong	“Serve the worthiest of its officials, befriend the most humane of its scholars” (the question was how to practice humaneness)
17.6	Zizhang	“Respect, tolerance, trustworthiness, diligence, kindness”

Asked about filial piety 4 times

2.5	Meng Yizi	"Do not disobey"
2.6	Meng Wubo	"Let your parents worry only about your illness"
2.7	Ziyou	"Without reverence, where is the difference?"
2.8	Zixia	"The expression is the hard part"

Asked about government 10 times

12.7	Zigong	"Enough food. Enough arms. The people's trust"
12.11	Duke Jing of Qi	"Let the ruler be a ruler, the minister a minister, the father a father, the son a son"

12.14	Zizhang	"Hold the post without weariness; carry it out with loyalty"
12.17	Ji Kangzi	"To govern is to set right"
12.19	Ji Kangzi	"In governing, why use killing?"
13.1	Zilu	"Go before them; work hard for them"
13.2	Zhonggong	"Lead your officials, pardon small faults, promote the worthy and talented"
13.16	the Duke of She	"Those near are pleased, those far off come"
13.17	Zixia	"Do not seek speed; do not look to small gains"
20.2	Zizhang	"Honor the five excellences, banish the four evils" (the question was how to serve in government)

Asked about the gentleman 3 times

2.13	Zigong	"First act on your words, then let them follow"
12.4	Sima Niu	"The gentleman neither worries nor fears"
14.45	Zilu	"Cultivate yourself with reverence"

Asked about the shi 3 times

12.20	Zizhang	"Upright in substance and fond of what is right, weighing words and reading faces, mindful to defer to others" (the question was what makes a shi "distinguished")
13.20	Zigong	"Have a sense of shame in your conduct; sent abroad, do not disgrace your ruler's commission"
13.28	Zilu	"Earnest, encouraging, and genial"

Asked about wisdom 2 times

6.20	Fan Chi	"Devote yourself to what is right for the people; revere ghosts and spirits but keep them at a distance"

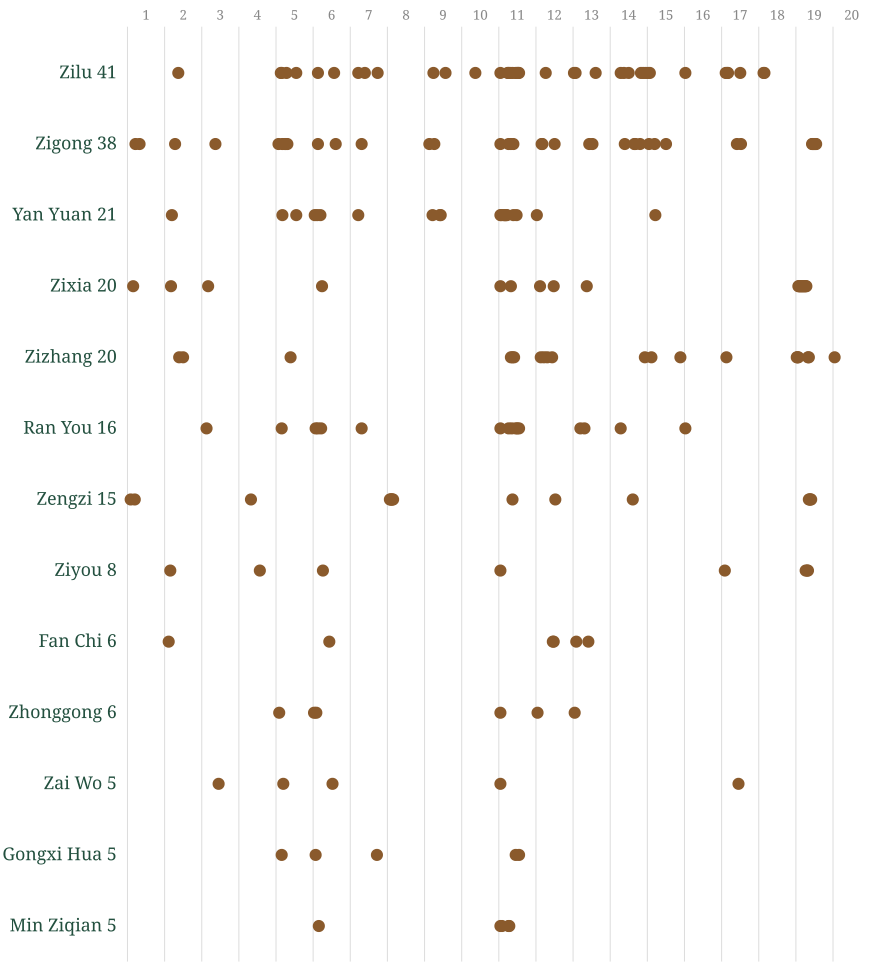
12.22	Fan Chi	"Know people"

Asked about exalting virtue 2 times

12.10	Zizhang	"Hold to loyalty and trustworthiness; move toward what is right"
12.21	Fan Chi	"The work first, the reward after"

Disciples at a glance

The twelve disciples who appear in five or more chapters. Each dot is a chapter; across are the twenty books, down are the people.



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Book 1 · Xue er

Analects 1.1

Day 1 of the calendar · every January 1

子曰：学而时习之，不亦说乎？有朋自远方来，不亦乐乎？人不知而不愠，不亦君子乎？

The Master said: To learn and, in season, to practise what you have learned — is that not a pleasure? To have friends come from afar — is that not a joy? To be unrecognised and yet not resentful — is that not what a gentleman is?

> **Yikonglu's note** "Practice" means drilling what you have learned on yourself, again and again, like a young bird flapping its wings over and over to learn to fly. It does not mean "reviewing at the proper times." Zhu Xi's commentary says, "Practice is a bird flying again and again": learning is copying what others do; practice is drilling yourself until you can do it.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: you watch a tutorial for a craft ten times and take neat notes, and when you try it you still can't do it. By Zhu Xi's reading, those ten times were spent watching other birds fly. The wings are your own; only after flapping them a few times can it be called practice.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 13: What "recording good sayings" looks like, the first chapter shows: one line, one principle. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 29: "At it in the morning, at it in the evening": Wang Xiang says this is exactly what "practicing it at all times" means. a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 70: “Few understand me, so those who follow me are precious”; Confucius said not to resent it when others do not understand you. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Starting School: The first line of the Analects, the easiest pick for the start of school. When writing it for a child, add a plain line: learn it, then go practice; once you've got it, you'll be glad all on your own.

Careful Xi 习 means practicing over and over, not just reviewing the textbook.

Occasion Farewells: For making plans at a farewell: when you return from afar, we'll meet again.

— Analects 1.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.2

Day 2 of the calendar · every January 2

有子曰：其为人也孝弟，而好犯上者，鲜矣；不好犯上，而好作乱者，未之有也。君子务本，本立而道生。孝弟也者，其为仁之本与?

Master You said: Those who are filial and fraternal yet fond of defying their superiors are few; those not fond of defying their superiors yet fond of starting disorder have never existed. The gentleman works at the root; once the root is set, the Way grows. Being filial and fraternal — is that not the root of humaneness?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: someone speaks movingly online about caring for strangers, then goes home and has little patience for his parents. By this chapter's order, his love may not be misplaced; he simply started from the far end.

This chapter connects to

People Youzi (You Ruo): appearance 1 of 4 (next 1.12)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 4: Kong Rong giving up the pears teaches the younger brother's part; Youzi says filial piety and respect for elders are the root of humaneness. a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 18: The Confucians make filial piety the root of humaneness, yet Laozi says "when the great Way is abandoned, there are humaneness and righteousness". Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 1.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.3

Day 2 of the calendar · every January 2

子曰：巧言令色，鲜矣仁！

The Master said: Clever words and a pleasing face — rarely is there humaneness in them.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the person in meetings who can pick up on anyone's remarks and attend to everyone's mood isn't necessarily a bad person; what matters is whether he does it to get the job done or just to be liked. A bird must fly by itself, love must start at home, and polish on the surface can't replace either.

This chapter connects to

See also 17.17: The Master said: Clever words and an ingratiating look — seldom are they humane.

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 22: Before he usurped the throne, Wang Mang was humble and courteous: judge people over time, not by a single moment. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 19: Laozi wants to "cut off cleverness and discard profit"; Confucius also disliked "clever words and an ingratiating face". Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 35: "The Way, when spoken, is bland and has no flavor": pleasant words do not keep people. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 81: “Truthful words are not beautiful; beautiful words are not truthful.” Confucius said: “Clever words and an ingratiating face: seldom is there humaneness in them.” Yikonglu's comparison

Do not use Naming: Avoid in names: “clever words” (巧言), said to seldom go with humaneness

— Analects 1.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.4

Day 3 of the calendar · every January 3

曾子曰：吾日三省吾身：为人谋而不忠乎？与朋友交而不信乎？传不习乎？

Master Zeng said: Each day I examine myself on three counts. In acting for others, have I been less than wholehearted? In dealing with friends, have I been less than trustworthy? What was passed on to me, have I failed to practise?

> **Yikonglu's note** Each day Zengzi checks himself on three things: did I do my best when acting for others, did I keep faith with friends, have I practiced what I learned. "Three" follows the three questions that come after, not "many times."

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a colleague asks you to look over a proposal. You spot a flaw, can't be bothered to say so, and reply, "Looks good." Tonight, you won't get past Zengzi's first question.

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 1 of 15 (next 1.9)

Occasion Starting a Job: Three questions to ask yourself before leaving work: Did I give my all to what I did for others? Did I keep my promises to colleagues? Have I practised what I learned until I've mastered it?

Occasion New Year: For a year-end review: Did I give my all in what I did for others? Did I keep faith with friends? Have I practised what I learned? Once a year isn't enough; Zengzi asked these every day.

— Analects 1.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.5

Day 4 of the calendar · every January 4

子曰：道千乘之国：敬事而信，节用而爱人，使民以时。

The Master said: To govern a state of a thousand chariots: be careful in affairs and keep faith; be sparing in expense and love the people; and call on the people's labour only in the right season.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a small shop where the owner keeps every promise to the staff, doesn't spend carelessly at month's end, and doesn't pile on personal errands when they're busiest.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 59: “In governing people and serving Heaven, nothing beats frugality”: Confucius, on governing, also spoke of “being sparing in expenditure and loving the people.” Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 67: “Frugal, therefore able to be expansive”; Confucius said “be sparing in expenditure and love the people.” Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 1.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 1.6

Day 4 of the calendar · every January 4

子曰：弟子入则孝，出则弟，谨而信，泛爱众，而亲仁。行有余力，则以学文。

The Master said: A young man should be filial at home and fraternal abroad, careful and trustworthy, broadly loving toward all and close to the humane. If he has strength left over after that, let him use it to study the texts.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: someone capable and well liked never reads, thinking he already knows what the books say. What he does isn't necessarily wrong; it's just that the day he gets something wrong, he'll have nothing to check it against.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 4: "Filial piety and respect for elders first, knowledge second": Wang Xiang and Atsumi both cite this chapter for that order. a commentator's reading

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 12: "When the Lesser Learning is done, go on to the Four Books": first learn to be a good person, then study texts with the energy left over. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion A New Baby: Can be written as a family motto for a child: be filial at home, respectful outside, careful in action, truthful in speech, generous to others, and close to good people. It goes on: "If you have energy left over, use it to study." Read your books, but virtue comes first.

Variant The base text has “出则弟／汎爱众”; the standard text has “出则悌／泛爱众”

— Analects 1.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.7

Day 5 of the calendar · every January 5

子夏曰：贤贤易色，事父母能竭其力，事君能致其身，与朋友交言而有信。虽曰未学，吾必谓之学矣。

Zixia said: One who values his wife for her character rather than her looks, serves his parents with all his strength, serves his ruler with his whole person, and keeps his word with friends — though people say he has not studied, I would certainly say he has.

> **Yikonglu's note** This line is about husband and wife: in a wife, value virtue, not looks. The lines that follow turn to serving parents, serving one's lord, and dealing with friends, so the four lines cover four human relationships. The video follows Zhu Xi, reading it as "turn a heart that loves beauty into a heart that loves the worthy"; Yikonglu takes the Qing scholars' husband-and-wife reading.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: say the elder in your family with only a few years of schooling is "unlearned," and Zixia would not agree.

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 1 of 20 (next 2.8)

Occasion Weddings: Yikonglu follows a Qing-dynasty reading: this line is about husband and wife, valuing the other's virtue over their looks. What follows covers serving parents, doing one's work, and making friends, so the four lines cover four human bonds. A wedding speech can start from this line.

— Analects 1.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.8

Day 6 of the calendar · every January 6

子曰：君子不重则不威，学则不固。主忠信。无友不如己者。过则勿惮改。

The Master said: If a gentleman lacks weight he will have no dignity, and what he learns will not hold firm. Make loyalty and trustworthiness your mainstay. Have no friend who is not your equal. When you err, do not fear to correct it.

> **Yikonglu's note** Do not befriend those who are not as good as you. That is exactly how Zhu Xi reads it, word for word. The comparison is about some particular strength of character, not status or rank; everyone surpasses me in something, and that makes them worth befriending.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the person willing to point out your mistakes to your face is most likely the friend you privately think is "better than me." He tells you twice and you don't change; the third time, he stops telling you.

This chapter connects to

See also 9.24: The Master said: Hold loyalty and good faith as primary. Do not befriend those not your...

Other books Daodejing, ch. 26: The excavated text reads "the gentleman travels all day without leaving his baggage wagons"; Confucius says "a gentleman without gravity has no dignity". Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Coming of Age: As an adult, no one covers for your mistakes. This line is just five characters: when you're wrong, don't be afraid to change.

— Analects 1.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.9

Day 7 of the calendar · every January 7

曾子曰：慎终追远，民德归厚矣。

Master Zeng said: Take care over the end, and follow the distant dead with remembrance, and the people's virtue will return to fullness.

Yikonglu's note Today: at Qingming, someone drives two hundred kilometers just to stand at a grave for ten minutes. No one is watching, and he goes anyway.

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 2 of 15 (previous 1.4, next 4.15)

Occasion Mourning: The most common line in eulogies and funeral couplets: see off the departed properly and remember distant ancestors, and people's hearts will grow generous.

— Analects 1.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.10

Day 8 of the calendar · every January 8

子禽问于子贡曰：夫子至于是邦也，必闻其政，求之与？抑与之与？子贡曰：夫子温、良、恭、俭、让以得之。夫子之求之也，其诸异乎人之求之与？

Ziqin asked Zigong: Whenever the Master arrives in a state he always hears about its government. Does he seek this, or is it given to him? Zigong said: The Master gets it by being warm, kind, respectful, frugal and deferential. The way the Master seeks it — is it not different from the way other men seek?

Yikonglu's note Today: some people hand out business cards everywhere and pull strings; others say nothing, yet people keep coming to ask their advice. Once they've asked, the job goes to someone else.

This chapter connects to

See also 9.6: The Grand Steward asked Zigong: Is your Master a sage? How many skills he has! Zigong…

People Chen Kang (Ziqin): appearance 1 of 3 (next 16.13)

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 1 of 38 (next 1.15)

— Analects 1.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.11

Day 9 of the calendar · every January 9

子曰：父在，观其志；父没，观其行；三年无改于父之道，可谓孝矣。

The Master said: While his father lives, observe his intentions; after his father dies, observe his conduct. If for three years he makes no change to his father's way, he may be called filial.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A father dies and leaves a small factory. His son has long disliked a few of its old rules. The one that cheated customers he changes the very next day. Another he waits three years to touch. Not because it was right, but because he can't yet bear to let it go.

This chapter connects to

See also 4.20: The Master said: If for three years he does not alter his father's way, he may be called...

— Analects 1.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.12

Day 10 of the calendar · every January 10

有子曰：礼之用，和为贵。先王之道斯为美，小大由之。有所不行，知和而和，不以礼节之，亦不可行也。

Master You said: In the practice of ritual, harmony is what is prized. That is what made the way of the former kings beautiful, and they followed it in matters great and small. Yet there are cases where it will not do: to know harmony and seek harmony without regulating it by ritual — that will not do either.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: In a small team, nobody wants to offend anybody, so at meetings all anyone says is "Looks good" or "Either way's fine." The meetings are very friendly, and the work drags on and gets messier.

This chapter connects to

People Youzi (You Ruo): appearance 2 of 4 (previous 1.2, next 1.13)

Occasion Weddings: Harmony at home matters most. But the second half of the chapter says harmony for its own sake, without measure, doesn't work either. At a wedding, "harmony is most precious" can go with "talk things over, and keep some rules too."

Careful Often taken to mean "smoothing things over." The original actually argues against seeking harmony at any cost.

— Analects 1.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.13

Day 11 of the calendar · every January 11

有子曰：信近于义，言可复也；恭近于礼，远耻辱也；因不失其亲，亦可宗也。

Master You said: When a promise comes close to what is right, one's word can be kept. When respect comes close to ritual, one keeps shame and disgrace away. When one relies on those one has not lost closeness with, one can look up to them.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A friend calls at midnight to borrow money, and you promise at once: "I'll transfer it tomorrow." You hang up, check your balance, and only then start to worry. What Youzi wants you to think about is the second before you hang up.

This chapter connects to

People Youzi (You Ruo): appearance 3 of 4 (previous 1.12, next 12.9)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 63: Lü Huiqing, explaining “Easy promises surely earn little trust,” speaks of “words that can be made good,” taken from Youzi's “When trust is close to rightness, one's word can be made good.”

a commentator's reading

— Analects 1.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.14

Day 12 of the calendar · every January 12

子曰：君子食无求饱，居无求安，敏于事而慎于言，就有道而正焉，可谓好学也已。

The Master said: A gentleman does not seek to eat his fill or live in comfort; he is quick in action and careful in speech, and goes to those who have the Way to be set straight. He may be called fond of learning.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: someone who goes to night school after work and eats a piece of bread on the subway for dinner.

This chapter connects to

See also 19.5: Zixia said: One who each day learns what he did not know, and each month does not forget…

Occasion Naming: Possible names: Minxing 敏行, Shenyan 慎言, Minzhi 敏之. Quick in action, careful in speech: suits families hoping for a steady, dependable child.

— Analects 1.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.15

Day 13 of the calendar · every January 13

子贡曰：贫而无谄，富而无骄，何如？子曰：可也。未若贫而乐，富而好礼者也。子贡曰：诗云：如切如磋，如琢如磨。其斯之谓与？子曰：赐也，始可与言诗已矣！告诸往而知来者。

Zigong said: Poor without flattery, rich without arrogance — how is that? The Master said: That will do. But it is not as good as poor and joyful, rich and fond of ritual. Zigong said: The Ode says, “as if cut, as if filed; as if carved, as if polished” — is that what you mean? The Master said: Ci, now I can begin to discuss the Odes with you. Told what has gone before, you know what comes after.

Yikonglu's note Today: Someone goes from renting to owning a home without ever bowing to anyone or showing off in front of anyone. That alone is hard.

This chapter connects to

See also 3.8: Zixia asked: “Her artful smile dimpling, her lovely eyes clear, white to set off the…

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 2 of 38 (previous 1.10, next 2.13)

Other books Book of Songs, Airs of Wei, "Qi Yu": "As if cut, as if filed; as if carved, as if polished." source

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 3: "Uncut jade makes no vessel": Zigong borrows the Book of Songs to say a person must be cut and polished like jade. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 9: "Rich and arrogant, one brings blame on oneself." Confucius too said "rich without arrogance" is not enough: better to be "rich and love ritual." Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 1.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 1.16

Day 14 of the calendar · every January 14

子曰：不患人之不己知，患不知人也。

The Master said: Do not be troubled that others do not know you; be troubled that you do not know others.

Yikonglu's note Today: At a new job, everyone worries the boss won't see how capable they are. What Confucius wants you to worry about first is whether you know who here can be relied on.

This chapter connects to

See also 14.32: The Master said: Do not worry that others do not know you; worry that you lack ability.

Occasion Graduation: For those just entering the working world: don't worry that no one knows you; first get to know others and understand them.

— Analects 1.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/1.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 2 · Wei zheng

Analects 2.1

Day 15 of the calendar · every January 15

子曰：为政以德，譬如北辰，居其所而众星共之。

The Master said: One who governs by virtue is like the pole star: it stays in its place, and all the other stars turn toward it.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A homeroom teacher keeps her word and does everything she promises. She doesn't have to shout every day. When the class gets noisy, the students look toward her on their own.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 6: "Answering to the center": the Pole Star stays in its place while the other stars turn around it. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 10: Heshang Gong reads "the gate of heaven" as the pole star; Confucius likens governing by virtue to the pole star. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 17: The ruler stays still and everyone naturally turns around him: just what Laozi calls "the very best". Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 2.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.2

Day 16 of the calendar · every January 16

子曰：《诗》三百，一言以蔽之，曰思无邪。

The Master said: The three hundred Odes can be covered by one phrase: thoughts without crookedness.

> **Yikonglu's note** "Without deviation" applies to the reader. Among the three hundred poems are love songs and laments; good poems awaken good feel-

ings, bad ones serve as warnings, and either way the reader's mind ends up set straight. Zhu Xi says the Songs "let people attain the correctness of their feelings and nature." There is no need to defend every poem.

Yikonglu's note Today: Someone says a certain novel is full of bad people and shouldn't be read. Zhu Xi doesn't see it that way. Reading a book about bad people, you see what is bad and rein yourself in.

This chapter connects to

Other books Book of Songs, Hymns of Lu, "Jiong": "Thoughts without swerving, the horses go forth." source

— Analects 2.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.3

Day 16 of the calendar · every January 16

子曰：道之以政，齐之以刑，民免而无耻；道之以德，齐之以礼，有耻且格。

The Master said: Guide them by decrees and keep them in line by punishments, and the people will stay out of trouble but have no sense of shame. Guide them by virtue and keep them in line by ritual, and they will have a sense of shame and, moreover, come right.

Yikonglu's note Today: The housing complex puts up a notice: a 200-yuan fine for littering. Nobody litters. But the day the camera breaks, the trash comes back.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 65: Wang Bi says that if a state is governed by cleverness, the people answer with cleverness; Confucius said that if the people are governed by punishments, they avoid them but feel no shame.
Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 2.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.4

Day 17 of the calendar · every January 17

子曰：吾十有五而志于学，三十而立，四十而不惑，五十而知天命，六十而耳顺，七十而从心所欲，不逾矩。

The Master said: At fifteen I set my heart on learning; at thirty I stood firm; at forty I had no doubts; at fifty I knew the decree of Heaven; at sixty my ear was attuned; at seventy I could follow my heart's desire without overstepping the line.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: At your fortieth birthday, a friend raises a glass: "Now you're free of doubts." But if you haven't kept learning, at forty you'll have doubts just the same.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 33: Confucius set his heart on learning at fifteen; Su Xun only resolved to study at twenty-seven. Read the two side by side. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 36: Liu Yan held office at seven; Confucius only set his heart on learning at fifteen. Early or late doesn't matter. What matters is resolve. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 38: Su Zhe explains "The highest virtue is not virtuous" by citing Confucius at seventy: "I followed what my heart desired without overstepping the line." a commentator's reading

Occasion Coming of Age: Confucius starts from age fifteen. At a coming-of-age ceremony you can tell the child: at fifteen you set your aim, at thirty you stand firm, and the years in between are yours.

Careful Li 立 in “at thirty I stood firm” means standing on your own with your own views, not just starting a family and a career.

Occasion Birthday Wishes for Elders: Use by age: fifty, "knew the will of Heaven"; sixty, "my ear was attuned"; seventy, "I could follow my heart's desire without overstepping the line." These are all Confucius speaking of himself. When the young write them for their elders, it's praise, not judgment.

— Analects 2.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.5

Day 18 of the calendar · every January 18

孟懿子问孝。子曰：无违。樊迟御，子告之曰：孟孙问孝于我，我对曰无违。樊迟曰：何谓也？子曰：生，事之以礼；死，葬之以礼，祭之以礼。

Meng Yizi asked about filial piety. The Master said: Do not go against it. As Fan Chi was driving him, the Master told him: Mengsun asked me about filial piety, and I answered, “Do not go against it.” Fan Chi said: What did you mean? The Master said: While they live, serve them according to ritual; when they die, bury them according to ritual and sacrifice to them according to ritual.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Elderly parents want a lavish birthday banquet, and the children borrow money to pay for it. Going along with it counts as obedience. By Hu Yin's line, it is exactly "doing what should not be done."

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about filial piety — Asked 4 times; see also 2.6 "Let your parents worry only about your illness" · 2.7 "Without reverence, where is the difference?" · 2.8 "The expression is the hard part"

People Meng Yizi: appears only here

People Fan Chi (Fan Xu): appearance 1 of 6 (next 6.20)

Other books Mencius, Teng Wen Gong I, chapter 2: Zengzi said: "While they live, serve them according to ritual; when they die, bury them according to ritual and sacrifice to them according to ritual..." source

Occasion Mourning: The full line on filial piety: while they live, serve them according to ritual; when they die, bury them according to ritual and sacrifice to them according to ritual. For mourning parents.

— Analects 2.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.6

Day 19 of the calendar · every January 19

孟武伯问孝。子曰：父母唯其疾之忧。

Meng Wubo asked about filial piety. The Master said: Parents worry only about their children falling ill.

> **Yikonglu's note** Parents worry only that their children will fall ill. Children who understand this and take care of themselves are being filial. Another reading is "give your parents nothing else to worry about," which Zhu Xi also accepts as valid.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Staying up late, drinking, riding without a helmet: you think that's your own business. On Zhu Xi's reading, this is exactly what parents are "always anxious about."

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about filial piety — Asked 4 times; see also 2.5 "Do not disobey" · 2.7 "Without reverence, where is the difference?" · 2.8 "The expression is the hard part"

People Meng Wubo: appearance 1 of 2 (next 5.7)

Occasion Visiting the Sick: For visiting a sick younger relative, or urging your children to look after themselves: parents can let go of anything except worry over a child's illness. Taking care of yourself is filial piety.

— Analects 2.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.7

Day 19 of the calendar · every January 19

子游问孝。子曰：今之孝者，是谓能养。至于犬马，皆能有养；不敬，何以别乎？

Ziyou asked about filial piety. The Master said: Filial piety nowadays means being able to feed one's parents. But even dogs and horses are fed. Without reverence, what is the difference?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: You send your parents money on time every month, but on the phone you're always impatient: "I know, I know." Not a cent is missing, yet the "gradual slide" Hu Yin spoke of has already begun.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about filial piety — Asked 4 times; see also 2.5 "Do not disobey" · 2.6 "Let your parents worry only about your illness" · 2.8 "The expression is the hard part"

People Ziyou (Yan Yan): appearance 1 of 8 (next 4.26)

— Analects 2.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 2.8

Day 20 of the calendar · every January 20

子夏问孝。子曰：色难。有事弟子服其劳，有酒食先生馔，曾是以为孝乎？

Zixia asked about filial piety. The Master said: The face is the hard part. When there is work, the young take on the toil; when there is wine and food, the elders are served first — is that really all filial piety is?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: You go home for the weekend, cook dinner and wash the dishes, but spend the whole evening looking down at your phone. When your parents talk, you just say "Mm."

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about filial piety — Asked 4 times; see also 2.5 "Do not disobey" · 2.6 "Let your parents worry only about your illness" · 2.7 "Without reverence, where is the difference?"

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 2 of 20 (previous 1.7, next 3.8)

— Analects 2.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.9

Day 21 of the calendar · every January 21

子曰：吾与回言终日，不违如愚。退而省其私，亦足以发。回也不愚。

The Master said: I talked with Hui all day and he never disagreed, as if he were slow. But when he withdrew and I looked at his private life, it was enough to bring out what I had said. Hui is not slow.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A newcomer in a training course never asks a question, and the team leader assumes he didn't understand. A month later, his work follows exactly the method taught in class.

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 1 of 21 (next 5.8)

— Analects 2.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.10

Day 21 of the calendar · every January 21

子曰：视其所以，观其所由，察其所安。人焉廋哉？人焉廋哉？

The Master said: Look at what he does, observe what he goes by, examine what he rests content in. How can a person hide? How can a person hide?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A colleague stays at the office later than anyone else every day. Look, and he is working. Observe, and he leaves only after the boss leaves. Examine, and the week the boss is away on a trip, he's gone by six.

— Analects 2.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.11

Day 22 of the calendar · every January 22

子曰：温故而知新，可以为师矣。

The Master said: One who reviews the old and comes to know the new may be a teacher.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 14: Know the principles of old and you can deal with what is in front of you. Confucius calls this "reviewing the old to know the new". Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 2.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.12

Day 23 of the calendar · every January 23

子曰：君子不器。

The Master said: The gentleman is not a vessel.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: An accountant keeps excellent books; that is her "vessel." But when coworkers quarrel, newcomers make mistakes or the company runs into trouble, people also like to come and ask her.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 11: Laozi says a vessel's use lies in its "emptiness"; Confucius says a gentleman must not be a mere vessel. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 2.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.13

Day 23 of the calendar · every January 23

子贡问君子。子曰：先行其言而后从之。

Zigong asked about the gentleman. The Master said: He first acts on his words, and then speaks of them.

Yikonglu's note Today: There's the person who is first to say "I'll handle it" at the meeting, and the one who says nothing afterward and puts the plan on the desk the next day. Zhou Fuxian means the second one, who only then speaks about how he did it.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about the gentleman — Asked 3 times; see also 12.4 "The gentleman neither worries nor fears" · 14.45 "Cultivate yourself with reverence"

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 3 of 38 (previous 1.15, next 3.17)

— Analects 2.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.14

Day 23 of the calendar · every January 23

子曰：君子周而不比，小人比而不周。

The Master said: The gentleman is inclusive and not partisan; the small man is partisan and not inclusive.

Yikonglu's note Today: Two people are both good at making friends. One treats everyone to dinner because they work together. The other treats everyone so they'll vote for him at awards time. The dishes on the table are exactly the same.

— Analects 2.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.15

Day 24 of the calendar · every January 24

子曰：学而不思则罔，思而不学则殆。

The Master said: To learn without thinking is to be lost; to think without learning is perilous.

Yikonglu's note Thinking without learning leaves you unsure when you act, hence "in peril." Yang Bojun translates it as "confused"; textbook editions differ on which reading they take, so the reading pack gives teachers both.

Yikonglu's note Today: One person has saved hundreds of online courses and never once thought any of them over. That is being lost. Another has never read a single book on the subject and comes up with a whole theory on his own, more convinced the more he thinks. That is being in danger.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 29: "Recite with the mouth, ponder with the mind": reciting is learning, pondering is thinking, and you need both.
Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 31: Grinding away is not the same as knowing how to learn: learning without thinking still leaves you confused.
Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 2.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.16

Day 25 of the calendar · every January 25

子曰：攻乎异端，斯害也已！

The Master said: To bore into one end of a matter only — that is harmful indeed.

Yikonglu's note Yiduan means one end of a matter. Clinging to one end and digging deep into it is harmful; Confucius himself "tapped both ends." The video follows Zhu Xi, reading it as "devoting oneself to heterodox teachings"; Yikonglu takes the Qing scholar Jiao Xun's reading, "each holding one end."

Yikonglu's note Today: Someone gets hooked on a "secret formula" of unknown origin, studies it every day and digs deeper and deeper, and won't listen to anything his family says.

— Analects 2.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.17

Day 26 of the calendar · every January 26

子曰：由！诲女知之乎？知之为知之，不知为不知，是知也。

The Master said: You, shall I teach you about knowing? To know what you know and to know what you do not know — that is knowing.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A client asks a question you can't answer. Making up an answer gets you through on the spot. Saying "Let me look into it and get back to you" looks bad on the spot.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 1 of 41 (next 5.6)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 71: “To know that you do not know is best”: the line where the two are most alike. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Starting School: Best for a teacher's first lesson of the term: if you don't understand in class, raise your hand. Saying you don't know is no shame; pretending to know is what costs you.

— Analects 2.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.18

Day 27 of the calendar · every January 27

子张学干禄。子曰：多闻阙疑，慎言其余，则寡尤；多见阙殆，慎行其余，则寡悔。言寡尤，行寡悔，禄在其中矣。

Zizhang was studying in order to gain office. The Master said: Hear much, set aside what is doubtful, and speak carefully of the rest — then you will make few mistakes. See much, set aside what is unsafe, and act carefully on the rest — then you will have few regrets. Few mistakes in speech, few regrets in conduct: office lies within that.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A young person just starting work asks an older colleague how to get promoted. The colleague says: if you're not sure about

something, don't say it yet; if you're not sure about a task, don't do it yet; say and do the rest with care.

This chapter connects to

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 1 of 20 (next 2.23)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 4: How to use "knowledge": hear much, see much, and set aside what you are unsure of. a commentator's reading

Occasion Starting a Job: Zizhang asked how to seek an official post. Confucius's answer is really about how to do a job: listen a lot, set aside what you're unsure of, and speak carefully even about what you are sure of; watch a lot, and hold off on what you're uneasy about. Fewer mistakes in speech, fewer regrets in action: that is where your livelihood lies.

— Analects 2.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.19

Day 28 of the calendar · every January 28

哀公问曰：何为则民服？孔子对曰：举直错诸枉，则民服；举枉错诸直，则民不服。

Duke Ai asked: What should I do so that the people will submit? Confucius replied: Raise up the straight and set them over the crooked, and the people will submit; raise up the crooked and set them over the straight, and the people will not submit.

Yikonglu's note Today: A company promotes someone who only reports good news, while another who works steadily and often says unwelcome things is left on the sidelines. No meeting needed. Everyone below already knows the score.

This chapter connects to

See also 12.22: Fan Chi asked about humaneness. The Master said: Love others. He asked about wisdom. The…

People Duke Ai of Lu: appearance 1 of 5 (next 3.21)

— Analects 2.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.20

Day 29 of the calendar · every January 29

季康子问：使民敬、忠以劝，如之何？子曰：临之以庄则敬，孝慈则忠，举善而教不能则劝。

Ji Kangzi asked: How can I make the people respectful, loyal and eager? The Master said: Approach them with dignity and they will be respectful; be filial and kind and they will be loyal; raise up the good and teach those who are not able, and they will be eager.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A store manager keeps a straight face, shows up on time and is polite to staff because he wants them to respect him. The staff can tell. What Zhang Shi means is a manager who is simply that kind of person, and the staff gradually follow.

This chapter connects to

People Ji Kangzi: appearance 1 of 8 (next 6.6)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 18: Laozi says filial piety and kindness show only when the six relations are at odds; Confucius says if those above are filial and kind, those below will be loyal. The same words, two readings.

Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 2.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.21

Day 30 of the calendar · every January 30

或谓孔子曰：子奚不为政？子曰：《书》云：孝乎惟孝、友于兄弟，施于有政。是亦为政，奚其为为政？

Someone said to Confucius: Why do you not take part in government? The Master said: The Book of Documents says: “Filial! Only be filial and a friend to your brothers, and extend it to government.” This too is taking part in government — why must one hold office to take part?

Yikonglu's note Today: someone asks a man who quit his job why he doesn't go back to work. He smiles and says looking after the old folks at home is serious work too. That's true. But the listener also understands there are probably other reasons he isn't going out.

This chapter connects to

People someone who spoke to Confucius: appears only here

— Analects 2.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 2.22

Day 31 of the calendar · every January 31

子曰：人而无信，不知其可也。大车无輗，小车无軏，其何以行之哉?

The Master said: A person without trustworthiness — I do not know how he can manage. A large cart without its yoke-bar, a small cart without its collar-bar — how can they go?

Yikonglu's note Today: a very capable colleague often lets the things he promised just fade away. Eventually, nobody dares hand him anything important.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 7: The last of the Five Constants is trustworthiness: without it, I do not know what a person can do.

Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 2.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.23

Day 32 of the calendar · every February 1

子张问：十世可知也？子曰：殷因于夏礼，所损益，可知也；周因于殷礼，所损益，可知也；其或继周者，虽百世可知也。

Zizhang asked: Can ten generations hence be known? The Master said: Yin followed the rites of Xia; what it took away and added can be known. Zhou followed the rites of Yin; what it took away and added can be known. Whoever succeeds Zhou, even a hundred generations on, can be known.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an old restaurant run by three generations. The sign has changed, the decor has changed, the menu has changed, but every guest is poured a cup of tea on arrival, and that hasn't changed in three generations. Understand those two handovers, and you can probably guess how the fourth generation will run it.

This chapter connects to

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 2 of 20 (previous 2.18, next 5.18)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 7: Yinshu, explaining the "Five Constants", quotes Huang Kan's subcommentary on this chapter: the Three Bonds and Five Constants do not change for a hundred generations. a commentator's reading

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 20: The three dynasties of Xia, Shang and Zhou followed one another; ritual was added to and cut back, and this can be known. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 29: "They record order and chaos and show rise and fall": reading history lets you infer later ages, and Confucius said even a hundred generations can be known. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 2.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 2.24

Day 33 of the calendar · every February 2

子曰：非其鬼而祭之，谄也。见义不为，无勇也。

The Master said: To sacrifice to spirits not one's own is flattery. To see what is right and not do it is cowardice.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: someone diligently sends gifts every holiday to the homes of bosses who have nothing to do with him; yet in meetings, knowing full well a plan is flawed, he says nothing.

— Analects 2.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/2.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 3 · Ba yi

Analects 3.1

Day 34 of the calendar · every February 3

孔子谓季氏：八佾舞于庭，是可忍也，孰不可忍也？

Confucius said of the Ji family: Eight rows of dancers in his courtyard — if he can bear to do this, what can he not bear to do?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a department head sits in the boss's seat at a meeting. It's just a chair, but everyone in the room takes note: if he can take this step, the next one won't be hard.

This chapter connects to

People the Ji family: appearance 1 of 7 (next 3.6)

— Analects 3.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.2

Day 34 of the calendar · every February 3

三家者以雍彻。子曰：相维辟公，天子穆穆，奚取于三家之堂？

The three families had the Yong ode sung as the sacrificial vessels were cleared. The Master said: “Assisting are the lords; the Son of Heaven, solemn and grave” — what place do these words have in the halls of the three families?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a small shop opens, and the banner over the door copies the line "Welcoming the heads of state of all nations." Nobody stops it, and nobody believes it.

This chapter connects to

People the Three Families: appears only here

— Analects 3.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.3

Day 35 of the calendar · every February 4

子曰：人而不仁，如礼何？人而不仁，如乐何？

The Master said: A person who is not humane — what has he to do with ritual? A person who is not humane — what has he to do with music?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: however fine the wedding and however moving the vows, if the two people don't truly hold each other in their hearts, the whole ceremony guarantees nothing.

— Analects 3.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.4

Day 35 of the calendar · every February 4

林放问礼之本。子曰：大哉问！礼，与其奢也，宁俭；丧，与其易也，宁戚。

Lin Fang asked about the root of ritual. The Master said: A great question! In ritual, rather frugal than extravagant; in mourning, rather grief than smooth arrangement.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: for an elder's birthday, one family orders a table crammed with dishes, and everyone at the table looks down at their own business. Another family just cooks a bowl of noodles and sits with the old person while they slowly finish it.

This chapter connects to

People Lin Fang: appearance 1 of 2 (next 3.6)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 67: Jiao Hong records Wang Pang's note, which explains “the second is frugality” with Confucius's “In ritual, rather than extravagance, better frugality.” a commentator's reading

Occasion Mourning: A funeral done in full is not as good as true grief in the heart. A simple funeral is fine, as long as the heart is in it.

— Analects 3.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.5

Day 36 of the calendar · every February 5

子曰：夷狄之有君，不如诸夏之亡也。

The Master said: The Yi and Di with rulers are not like the Xia states without them.

Yikonglu's note Confucius is rebuking his own side: even the Yi and Di tribes have rulers and an order of high and low, while the central states usurp and rebel, so having a ruler is as good as having none. An older reading takes it as "the Yi and Di with rulers are not as good as the central states without them"; Yikonglu does not take it.

Yikonglu's note Today: an old, famous firm has had its sign up for over a century, but each branch keeps its own accounts and nobody listens to the head office. The little shop next door has just one manager, and everything runs in good order.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 26: The Liao and Jin rulers called themselves emperors. Read this alongside Confucius's line: whether a people truly has a ruler depends on whether it has ritual. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 3.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.6

Day 36 of the calendar · every February 5

季氏旅于泰山。子谓冉有曰：女弗能救与？对曰：不能。子曰：呜呼！曾谓泰山，不如林放乎？

The Ji family made the lu sacrifice to Mount Tai. The Master said to Ran You: Could you not save them from this? He replied: I could not. The Master said: Alas! Will it be said that Mount Tai knows less than Lin Fang?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: you work for a boss who wants to do something against the rules. Your teacher asks: can't you talk him out of it? You say you can't. The teacher doesn't scold you, only says: even the old man who minds the door knows this is wrong.

This chapter connects to

People the Ji family: appearance 2 of 7 (previous 3.1, next 6.7)

People Lin Fang: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 3.4)

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 1 of 16 (next 5.7)

— Analects 3.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.7

Day 37 of the calendar · every February 6

子曰：君子无所争，必也射乎！揖让而升，下而饮，其争也君子。

The Master said: The gentleman does not compete — except, perhaps, in archery! Bowing and yielding, they go up; coming down, they drink. Even their competing is gentlemanly.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: when a chess match ends, the loser stands first, shakes hands, and says "That was a fine move." The winner replies, "I might not win next time." Neither gave an inch in the game, but what the onlookers remember is those two lines.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 22: "Because he does not contend, no one in the world can contend with him"; Confucius also says the gentleman has nothing to contend over. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 3.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.8

Day 38 of the calendar · every February 7

子夏问曰：巧笑倩兮，美目盼兮，素以为绚兮。何谓也？子曰：绘事后素。曰：礼后乎？子曰：起予者商也！始可与言诗已矣。

Zixia asked: “Her artful smile dimpling, her lovely eyes clear, white to set off the colours” — what does this mean? The Master said: The painting comes after the white ground. He said: Then ritual comes after? The Master said: Shang, you have drawn me out! Now I can talk about the Odes with you.

Yikonglu's note First the white ground, then the colors; first loyalty and good faith in a person, then ritual can be added. Zheng Xuan has another reading, in which the white is added last as an outline; it is worth noting as an alternative.

Yikonglu's note Today: repainting an old house, the old craftsman spends two days patching and priming the walls. The owner anxiously asks: what about the color? The craftsman says: if the base isn't smooth, any color will come out blotchy.

This chapter connects to

See also 1.15: Zigong said: Poor without flattery, rich without arrogance — how is that? The Master...

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 3 of 20 (previous 2.8, next 6.11)

Other books Book of Songs, Airs of Wei, "Shuo Ren": "Her artful smile so charming, her lovely eyes so bright." source

— Analects 3.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.9

Day 39 of the calendar · every February 8

子曰：夏礼吾能言之，杞不足征也；殷礼吾能言之，宋不足征也。文献不足故也，足则吾能征之矣。

The Master said: I can speak of the rites of Xia, but Qi cannot bear them out; I can speak of the rites of Yin, but Song cannot bear them out. That is because there are not enough records and worthies. If there were, I could bear them out.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Grandma makes a dish from her hometown. You ask for the recipe, and she says she never wrote one. The day you want to make it yourself, you find that what's missing isn't the piece of paper, but the person standing at the stove telling you about the heat as she cooks.

— Analects 3.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.10

Day 40 of the calendar · every February 9

子曰：禘自既灌而往者，吾不欲观之矣。

The Master said: At the di sacrifice, from the libation onwards, I do not wish to watch.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: At a school opening ceremony, everyone stands up straight while the flag is raised. By the time the principal reaches page three of his speech, people in the back rows are looking down at their phones.

— Analects 3.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.11

Day 40 of the calendar · every February 9

或问禘之说。子曰：不知也。知其说者之于天下也，其如示诸斯乎！指其掌。

Someone asked about the meaning of the di sacrifice. The Master said: I do not know. One who knew its meaning would deal with the world as if looking at this — and he pointed to his palm.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: At a family dinner, someone brings up an old family matter that shouldn't be discussed in front of everyone. An elder puts down his chopsticks and says, "That? I don't really know." A little later he adds, "Someone who truly understood it would see it as plainly as the palm of his own hand."

This chapter connects to

People someone who asked about the di sacrifice: appears only here

— Analects 3.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.12

Day 41 of the calendar · every February 10

祭如在，祭神如神在。子曰：吾不与祭，如不祭。

Sacrifice as if they were present; sacrifice to the spirits as if the spirits were present. The Master said: If I do not take part in the sacrifice, it is as if I had not sacrificed.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Your grandmother turns eighty. You're away on a work trip and can't get back, so you have someone take her a big red envelope. She gets it and says it's lovely. But that night, in your own heart, it feels as if the birthday never happened.

— Analects 3.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.13

Day 41 of the calendar · every February 10

王孙贾问曰：与其媚于奥，宁媚于灶，何谓也？子曰：不然，获罪于天，无所祷也。

Wangsun Jia asked: “Better to court the stove than the southwest corner” — what does that mean? The Master said: Not so. One who offends Heaven has nowhere to pray.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A new colleague is pulled aside and told quietly, "You'll barely see the big boss a few times a year. The one who really calls the shots is the department head, so get on good terms with him first." The newcomer smiles: "If the work is done right, you can deal with anyone. If it's done wrong, being on good terms with anyone won't help."

This chapter connects to

People Wangsun Jia: appearance 1 of 2 (next 14.20)

— Analects 3.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.14

Day 42 of the calendar · every February 11

子曰：周监于二代，郁郁乎文哉！吾从周。

The Master said: Zhou looked to the two dynasties before it — how rich and refined its culture! I follow Zhou.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: At a family's New Year's Eve dinner, a few dishes from grandma's generation are kept, mom adds two new ones, and the ones that were too oily or too salty slowly stop being made. Every dish on the table has a history, and the whole table still looks like this year.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 15: "The Duke of Zhou composed the Rites of Zhou": Confucius said Zhou ritual drew on the Xia and Shang, so he followed Zhou. Yikonglu's comparison

Analects 3.15

Day 42 of the calendar · every February 11

子入大庙，每事问。或曰：孰谓鄹人之子知礼乎？入大庙，每事问。子闻之曰：是礼也。

When the Master entered the Grand Temple he asked about everything. Someone said: Who says the son of the man from Zou knows ritual? In the Grand Temple he asks about everything. The Master heard and said: This is ritual.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A nurse with thirty years on the job still reads out the drug name, bed number and patient's name, one by one, before changing a dressing. A new intern asks quietly, "You still need to check?" The nurse says, "It's because I've done this for thirty years that I check."

This chapter connects to

People someone who mocked Confucius for asking about ritual: appears only here

People the man of Zou: appears only here

Variant The base text has “大庙”; the standard text has “太庙”

Analects 3.16

Day 43 of the calendar · every February 12

子曰：射不主皮，为力不同科，古之道也。

The Master said: In archery, piercing the hide is not the point, because men's strength is not of the same grade. That was the way of old.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: At a school sports day, the long jump is divided by grade. In a calligraphy contest, what counts is not whose characters are biggest but whose are best.

— Analects 3.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.17

Day 43 of the calendar · every February 12

子贡欲去告朔之饩羊。子曰：赐也，尔爱其羊，我爱其礼。

Zigong wanted to do away with the sacrificial sheep for announcing the new moon. The Master said: Si, you care about the sheep; I care about the rite.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: An old shop gave up making things by hand long ago, but every winter solstice the master still makes one pot by the old recipe and sets it on the counter, not for sale. His apprentice calls it a waste. The master says, "If I stop making this pot, the recipe is truly gone."

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 4 of 38 (previous 2.13, next 5.3)

— Analects 3.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.18

Day 44 of the calendar · every February 13

子曰：事君尽礼，人以为谄也。

The Master said: Serving one's lord with full ritual, people take it for flattery.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A new colleague is seated five minutes before every meeting and fills in every line of his expense forms. The old hands tease him for showing off. That is simply what the rules say.

— Analects 3.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.19

Day 44 of the calendar · every February 13

定公问：君使臣，臣事君，如之何？孔子对曰：君使臣以礼，臣事君以忠。

Duke Ding asked: How should a lord employ his ministers, and ministers serve their lord? Confucius replied: The lord employs his ministers with ritual; ministers serve their lord with loyalty.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A team leader first asks whether he's giving people enough respect; the person doing the work first asks whether the job is done properly. Neither starts by keeping score on the other.

This chapter connects to

People Duke Ding of Lu: appearance 1 of 2 (next 13.15)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 11: "The ruler respectful, the minister loyal": the ruler treats the minister with ritual, the minister serves the ruler with loyalty. Both sides have duties. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 3.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.20

Day 45 of the calendar · every February 14

子曰：《关雎》，乐而不淫，哀而不伤。

The Master said: The Guanju — joyful but not excessive, sorrowful but not hurtful.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Someone reading wedding vows breaks down halfway, wipes their eyes, and reads on to the last line.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 9: The seven emotions need not be stamped out, only kept in measure: joy without excess, grief without harm. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Weddings: "Guanju" is the first poem in the Book of Songs, about a gentleman seeking a fine lady. Confucius said it is joyful without excess and sorrowful without harm. If "Guanju" is read at a wedding, this line can follow.

Analects 3.21

Day 46 of the calendar · every February 15

哀公问社于宰我。宰我对曰：夏后氏以松，殷人以柏，周人以栗，曰使民战栗。子闻之曰：成事不说，遂事不谏，既往不咎。

Duke Ai asked Zai Wo about the altar of the soil. Zai Wo replied: The Xia used pine, the Yin cypress, and the Zhou chestnut (li), saying it would make the people tremble (zhanli). The Master heard and said: What is done is not discussed; what is accomplished is not remonstrated; what is past is not blamed.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: You casually forward an unverified message in a group chat, and within moments hundreds of people have seen it. The recall button only works for two minutes.

This chapter connects to

People Duke Ai of Lu: appearance 2 of 5 (previous 2.19, next 6.2)

People Zai Wo (Zai Yu): appearance 1 of 5 (next 5.9)

Analects 3.22

Day 47 of the calendar · every February 16

子曰：管仲之器小哉！或曰：管仲俭乎？曰：管氏有三归，官事不摄，焉得俭？然则管仲知礼乎？曰：邦君树塞门，管氏亦树塞门；邦君为两君之好，有反坫，管氏亦有反坫。管氏而知礼，孰不知礼？

The Master said: Guan Zhong's capacity was small indeed! Someone said: Was Guan Zhong frugal? He said: Guan had the Sangui terrace, and his officials held no double posts — how was that frugal? Then did Guan Zhong know ritual? He said: The ruler of a state has a screen at his gate, and Guan too had a screen at his gate; the ruler of a state, for meetings between two rulers, has a stand for inverted cups, and Guan too had such a stand. If Guan knew ritual, who does not know ritual?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A company keeps growing. The boss's office is done up like a palace, and the rules he sets apply only to others. The business grew; the man didn't grow with it.

This chapter connects to

See also 7.30: The Minister of Crime of Chen asked whether Duke Zhao knew ritual. Confucius said: He…

People Guan Zhong: appearance 1 of 4 (next 14.10)

People someone who asked about Guan Zhong: appears only here

Other books Daodejing, ch. 41: Wang Pang explains "The great vessel is completed late" by citing Confucius's remark that Guan Zhong was a small vessel.

a commentator's reading

— Analects 3.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.23

Day 48 of the calendar · every February 17

子语鲁大师乐。曰：乐其可知也：始作，翕如也；从之，纯如也，皦如也，绎如也，以成。

The Master spoke of music to the Grand Music Master of Lu, saying: Music can be understood. At the start, all comes together; as it unfolds, it is harmonious, clear, and continuous, until it is complete.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: At choir rehearsal, the first note must come in together; once together, it must blend; once blended, each part must still be heard; and the song is carried through to the end in one breath.

This chapter connects to

People the Grand Music Master of Lu: appears only here

— Analects 3.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.24

Day 49 of the calendar · every February 18

仪封人请见。曰：君子之至于斯也，吾未尝不得见也。从者见之。出曰：二三子，何患于丧乎？天下之无道也久矣，天将以夫子为木铎。

The border warden of Yi asked to be presented, saying: Whenever a gentleman comes here, I have never failed to see him. The followers presented him. Coming out, he said: My friends, why worry about his losing office? The world has long been without the Way; Heaven is going to use your master as a wooden-tongued bell.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: An older teacher taken out of the classroom starts a free class in the community activity room. More people come than were in her old class.

This chapter connects to

People the border warden of Yi: appears only here

— Analects 3.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.25

Day 50 of the calendar · every February 19

子谓韶，尽美矣，又尽善也。谓武，尽美矣，未尽善也。

The Master said of the Shao: Perfectly beautiful, and perfectly good. He said of the Wu: Perfectly beautiful, but not perfectly good.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Two equally impressive wins: one earned head-on, the other because the opponent was injured and withdrew. The trophy is the same; standing on the podium feels different.

— Analects 3.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 3.26

Day 50 of the calendar · every February 19

子曰：居上不宽，为礼不敬，临丧不哀，吾何以观之哉？

The Master said: Holding high position without generosity, performing ritual without reverence, attending mourning without grief — how could I bear to look at it?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: At a funeral, someone stands at the door of the mourning hall talking business on the phone. However generous his condolence gift, no one remembers he came.

— Analects 3.26 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/3.26 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 4 · Li ren

Analects 4.1

Day 51 of the calendar · every February 20

子曰：里仁为美。择不处仁，焉得知?

The Master said: It is beautiful to live where humaneness prevails. If one chooses not to dwell among the humane, how can one be called wise?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: People buying a home ask about the school district, the subway, and which floors get good light. Few think to ask how the neighbors in the building treat people.

This chapter connects to

Other books Mencius, Gongsun Chou I, chapter 7: Confucius said: "It is humaneness that makes a neighborhood beautiful." source

Other books Mencius, Gongsun Chou I, chapter 7: "If one chooses not to dwell in humaneness, how can one be wise?" source

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 1: Mencius's mother moved three times to choose good neighbors, and commentators all use this chapter to explain it: choose to live where humaneness is. a commentator's reading

— Analects 4.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.2

Day 51 of the calendar · every February 20

子曰：不仁者不可以久处约，不可以长处乐。仁者安仁，知者利仁。

The Master said: Those who are not humane cannot long endure hardship, nor long enjoy happiness. The humane rest in humaneness; the wise profit from humaneness.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Someone who has been out of work for six months still gets up at seven every day, shaves, and goes out for a run.

— Analects 4.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 4.3

Day 52 of the calendar · every February 21

子曰：唯仁者能好人，能恶人。

The Master said: Only the humane can love others and can hate others.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A competition judge sees a student she once taught take the stage, gets up from her seat, and gives no score for that round.

— Analects 4.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 4.4

Day 52 of the calendar · every February 21

子曰：苟志于仁矣，无恶也。

The Master said: If one truly sets one's heart on humaneness, there will be no evil.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A new driver scrapes the car three times in a year but never once runs a red light.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 23: Su Zhe, explaining "one at one with loss, loss too is glad to have", cites Confucius: set your heart on humaneness and you will do no evil, let alone on the Way. a commentator's reading

— Analects 4.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.5

Day 53 of the calendar · every February 22

子曰：富与贵是人之所欲也，不以其道得之，不处也；贫与贱是人之所恶也，不以其道得之，不去也。君子去仁，恶乎成名？君子无终食之间违仁，造次必于是，颠沛必于是。

The Master said: Wealth and rank are what people want; if not obtained by the proper way, one does not keep them. Poverty and lowliness are what people hate; if not come by through the proper way, one does not escape them. If a gentleman leaves humaneness, how can he make a name? A gentleman does not depart from humaneness even for the space of a meal; in haste he holds to it, in upheaval he holds to it.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: The bus brakes hard and everyone lurches forward. A young man's first move is to reach out and steady the old woman beside him.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 53: Wang Bi explains "a surplus of wealth and goods" with Confucius's words "if not obtained by the proper way."

a commentator's reading

— Analects 4.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.6

Day 54 of the calendar · every February 23

子曰：我未见好仁者，恶不仁者。好仁者，无以尚之；恶不仁者，其为仁矣，不使不仁者加乎其身。有能一日用其力于仁矣乎？我未见力不足者。盖有之矣，我未之见也。

The Master said: I have not seen one who loves humaneness or one who hates what is not humane. One who loves humaneness puts nothing above it; one who hates what is not humane practises humaneness by not letting the inhumane touch his person. Is there anyone who can spend his strength on humaneness for a single day? I have not seen one whose strength was not enough. Perhaps there are such, but I have not seen them.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Someone who says they have no time to exercise spends two hours scrolling on their phone in bed before sleep.

— Analects 4.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.7

Day 55 of the calendar · every February 24

子曰：人之过也，各于其党。观过，斯知仁矣。

The Master said: People's faults each belong to their kind. Look at the fault, and you will know the humaneness.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Two people are both half an hour late. One took an old man who had fallen in the street to the hospital; the other overslept.

— Analects 4.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.8

Day 56 of the calendar · every February 25

子曰：朝闻道，夕死可矣。

The Master said: If one hears the Way in the morning, one may die at dusk without regret.

> **Yikonglu's note** This is about one's own life. If in the morning you truly grasp the Way, you could die that evening without regret. Zhu Xi says that one who hears the Way "lives in accord and dies at peace."

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: An old man in a hospital bed finally makes sense of something he could never work out his whole life. He holds his daughter's hand and says, "Now I can rest easy."

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 41: Jiao Hong records Lü Huiqing's commentary, which cites "Hear the Way in the morning, and you may die in the evening," saying the highest scholar is one who has truly understood the Way.
a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 62: Su Zhe, explaining “If people are not good, why abandon them?”, speaks of “doing wrong in the morning and hearing the great Way in the evening,” adapting Confucius's “hearing the Way in the morning.”
a commentator's reading

— Analects 4.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.9

Day 57 of the calendar · every February 26

子曰：士志于道，而耻恶衣恶食者，未足与议也。

The Master said: A scholar who sets his heart on the Way, yet is ashamed of poor clothes and poor food, is not worth talking with.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Someone who says they're going to focus on exam prep first spends three days picking out the most expensive set of stationery.

— Analects 4.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.10

Day 57 of the calendar · every February 26

子曰：君子之于天下也，无适也，无莫也，义之与比。

The Master said: The gentleman, in dealing with the world, has no fixed yes and no fixed no; he sides with what is right.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A line judge at a tennis match doesn't decide in advance who should win or lose. She just bends down to see whether this ball touched the line.

— Analects 4.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.11

Day 58 of the calendar · every February 27

子曰：君子怀德，小人怀土；君子怀刑，小人怀惠。

The Master said: The gentleman cherishes virtue, the petty man cherishes his own ground; the gentleman cherishes the law, the petty man cherishes favors.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Two people get the same job offer in another city. One first asks what he can learn and how he can help. The other only looks at where he'd be comfortable: if it's comfortable he goes, if not he turns it down.

— Analects 4.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.12

Day 58 of the calendar · every February 27

子曰：放于利而行，多怨。

The Master said: One who acts by leaning on profit draws much resentment.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: In a shared flat, the one who never buys the shared supplies but uses the most of them moves out, and nobody comes out to see him off.

— Analects 4.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.13

Day 59 of the calendar · every February 28

子曰：能以礼让为国乎？何有？不能以礼让为国，如礼何？

The Master said: Can one govern a state with ritual and yielding? What difficulty is there? If one cannot govern a state with ritual and yielding, what use is ritual?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: At a wedding banquet, the decor, the seating and the speeches are all perfect, yet the two families argue over who gets the head table until everyone leaves.

— Analects 4.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.14

Day 59 of the calendar · every February 28

子曰：不患无位，患所以立；不患莫己知，求为可知也。

The Master said: Do not worry about having no position; worry about what you would stand on in it. Do not worry that no one knows you; seek to be worth knowing.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Dozens of résumés sent, and no reply. Some blame employers for not recognizing talent; others redo every project in their portfolio.

This chapter connects to

See also 15.18: The Master said: The gentleman is troubled by his own lack of ability, not by others'...

Occasion Coming of Age: For a first job search or choosing a major. Don't first worry about having no position; first worry about what qualifies you to stand in it.

— Analects 4.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.15

Day 60 of the calendar · every March 1

子曰：参乎！吾道一以贯之。曾子曰：唯。子出。门人问曰：何谓也？曾子曰：夫子之道，忠恕而已矣。

The Master said: Shen! My Way is threaded through by one. Zengzi said: Yes. The Master went out, and the disciples asked: What did he mean? Zengzi said: The Master's Way is loyalty and reciprocity, nothing more.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A veteran craftsman training newcomers doesn't lay out a hundred rules. He says just one thing: see your own step through to the end, and when it's done, think of the next person who takes it over.

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 3 of 15 (previous 1.9, next 8.3)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 20: "Between 'wei' and 'a', how great is the difference?": "wei" is a disciple's respectful reply to a teacher, the word Zengzi used to answer Confucius. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 39: Jiao Hong records Xizhai's commentary, which explains "those of old who attained the One" with Confucius's "my Way has one thread running through it." a commentator's reading

— Analects 4.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.16

Day 60 of the calendar · every March 1

子曰：君子喻于义，小人喻于利。

The Master said: The gentleman understands rightness; the small man understands profit.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Someone selling a used item online notices a scratch they hadn't mentioned and changes "9/10 condition" to "7/10" on their own.

— Analects 4.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.17

Day 61 of the calendar · every March 2

子曰：见贤思齐焉，见不贤而内自省也。

The Master said: Seeing a worthy person, think of equalling him; seeing an unworthy one, turn inward and examine yourself.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Coming across great work by someone their own age, some sneer, "Just lucky." Others quietly bookmark it and save the tutorial.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 35: "Take warning yourself": the warning is for yourself, not a stick to beat others with. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 4.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.18

Day 62 of the calendar · every March 3

子曰：事父母几谏。见志不从，又敬不违，劳而不怨。

The Master said: In serving your parents, remonstrate gently. If you see they will not follow, remain respectful and do not oppose them; labour on without resentment.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Your parents forward a fake health-supplement ad in the family group chat. Some reply right there in the group, "Fake again." Others call privately and talk it through slowly.

— Analects 4.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.19

Day 62 of the calendar · every March 3

子曰：父母在，不远游。游必有方。

The Master said: While your parents are alive, do not travel far; if you must travel, have a fixed direction.

Yikonglu's note Today: On a work trip or vacation, as soon as the plane lands, you share your location in the family group chat.

This chapter connects to

Occasion Farewells: For a child going far from home, always with the second half: if you go, let your parents know where you are. Today that means telling them you've arrived safely and letting them know when you move.

Careful Often only the first half is quoted, to stop someone from leaving. Zhu Xi says it means don't leave your parents unable to find you, not that you may never leave.

— Analects 4.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.20

Day 63 of the calendar · every March 4

子曰：三年无改于父之道，可谓孝矣。

The Master said: If for three years he does not alter his father's way, he may be called filial.

Yikonglu's note Today: When you were young, you remembered only half of what your parents told you. Once you're running a household yourself, you remember the other half.

This chapter connects to

See also 1.11: The Master said: While his father lives, observe his intentions; after his father dies,...

— Analects 4.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.21

Day 63 of the calendar · every March 4

子曰：父母之年，不可不知也。一则以喜，一则以惧。

The Master said: The ages of one's parents must not go unknown: on the one hand for joy, on the other for fear.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: The reminder for your parents' birthdays goes off in your phone calendar once a year, and the number gets bigger every year. When you see it, you're glad, and a little afraid.

This chapter connects to

Occasion New Year: The best line for going home at New Year: remember your parents are a year older, glad they are living long, and worried that they're growing old.

— Analects 4.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 4.22

Day 64 of the calendar · every March 5

子曰：古者言之不出，耻躬之不逮也。

The Master said: The ancients did not let their words out lightly, ashamed that their own conduct would not reach them.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: In the work chat, one person replies, "I'll definitely hand it in this week." Another says nothing and hands it in on Wednesday.

— Analects 4.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 4.23

Day 64 of the calendar · every March 5

子曰：以约失之者鲜矣。

The Master said: Those who go wrong through restraint are few.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: When moving house, the one who brings only two boxes ends up losing nothing.

— Analects 4.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.24

Day 64 of the calendar · every March 5

子曰：君子欲讷于言而敏于行。

The Master said: The gentleman wishes to be slow in speech and quick in action.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the person who says the least in the meeting is the first to finish the work once it breaks up.

This chapter connects to

See also 14.29: The Master said: The gentleman is ashamed to let his words outrun his deeds.

Other books Daodejing, ch. 56: Heshang Gong says "value action, not words"; Confucius says the gentleman is slow in speech and quick in action. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 81: “The good do not argue.” Confucius said the gentleman is slow in speech and quick in action. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 4.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.25

Day 65 of the calendar · every March 6

子曰：德不孤，必有邻。

The Master said: Virtue is not solitary; it is sure to have neighbours.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an old man in the housing complex puts out water for the stray cats every day. At first he was the only one; later, several families in the building began taking turns.

This chapter connects to

Occasion Naming: Possible names: Delin 德邻, Youlin 有邻, Bugu 不孤. The meaning: a person of virtue always draws people near. Also good for a small shop or a community reading room.

— Analects 4.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 4.26

Day 66 of the calendar · every March 7

子游曰：事君数，斯辱矣，朋友数，斯疏矣。

Ziyou said: In serving a ruler, importunity brings disgrace; among friends, importunity brings distance.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: you try to talk a friend out of something and send a dozen long messages in a row. The reply is just "ok."

This chapter connects to

People Ziyou (Yan Yan): appearance 2 of 8 (previous 2.7, next 6.12)

— Analects 4.26 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/4.26 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 5 · Gongye Chang

Analects 5.1

Day 67 of the calendar · every March 8

子谓公冶长，可妻也。虽在缧绁之中，非其罪也。以其子妻之。子谓南容，邦有道，不废；邦无道，免于刑戮。以其兄之子妻之。

The Master said of Gongye Chang: He is fit to be given a wife. Though he was in bonds, it was not his crime. And he gave him his own daughter as wife. The Master said of Nan Rong: When the state has the Way, he will not be cast aside; when the state lacks the Way, he will escape punishment. And he gave him his elder brother's daughter as wife.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: someone was once wrongly disciplined, and later cleared. Some colleagues still avoid him; others keep handing him the things that matter most.

This chapter connects to

See also 11.5: Nan Rong repeated the lines on the white jade tablet three times a day, and Confucius…

People Gongye Chang: appears only here

People Nan Rong (Nangong Kuo): appearance 1 of 3 (next 11.5)

People Confucius's daughter: appears only here

People Confucius's niece: appearance 1 of 2 (next 11.5)

People Confucius's elder brother: appearance 1 of 2 (next 11.5)

Occasion Weddings: Confucius chose a son-in-law by looking only at the man. Gongye Chang was in prison at the time, but Confucius said it was not his crime and gave him his daughter anyway. Parents-in-law can tell this story in a speech, meaning: it's you as a person we value.

— Analects 5.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.2

Day 68 of the calendar · every March 9

子谓子贱，君子哉若人！鲁无君子者，斯焉取斯?

The Master said of Zijian: A gentleman indeed is this man! If Lu had no gentlemen, where could he have got this from?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a newcomer wins an award, and the first thing she does on stage is point to her teacher in the audience.

This chapter connects to

People Zijian (Fu Buqi): appears only here

— Analects 5.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.3

Day 68 of the calendar · every March 9

子贡问曰：赐也何如？子曰：女器也。曰：何器也？曰：瑚琏也。

Zigong asked: What about me, Ci? The Master said: You are a vessel. He said: What vessel? He said: A hu-lian vessel of the ancestral temple.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the boss says, "You're the most useful person I've got." It feels good to hear. Back home, thinking it over, it sits a little wrong.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 5 of 38 (previous 3.17, next 5.8)

— Analects 5.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.4

Day 69 of the calendar · every March 10

或曰：雍也仁而不佞。子曰：焉用佞？御人以口给，屡憎于人。不知其仁，焉用佞？

Someone said: Yong is humane but not glib. The Master said: What use is glibness? Those who meet people with a ready tongue are often disliked. I do not know whether he is humane, but what use is glibness?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: someone who has an answer for everything and agrees to everything, but never follows through on anything. Three months in, colleagues steer around him.

This chapter connects to

People Zhonggong (Ran Yong): appearance 1 of 6 (next 6.1)

People someone who commented on Yong: appears only here

— Analects 5.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.5

Day 69 of the calendar · every March 10

子使漆雕开仕。对曰：吾斯之未能信。子说。

The Master wished Qidiao Kai to take office. He replied: I am not yet able to be sure of this. The Master was pleased.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: her manager wants to promote her. She says, "I can't handle that role yet. Give me another six months."

This chapter connects to

People Qidiao Kai: appears only here

— Analects 5.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.6

Day 70 of the calendar · every March 11

子曰：道不行，乘桴浮于海。从我者其由与？子路闻之喜。子曰：由也好勇过我，无所取材。

The Master said: If the Way does not prevail, I will board a raft and float out to sea. The one who would follow me would be Yóu, perhaps? Zilu heard this and was glad. The Master said: Yóu loves courage more than I do, but has nothing by which to measure things.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: someone in the group chat says offhand, "Why not quit and travel the world?" One friend has a backpack packed that same night.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 2 of 41 (previous 2.17, next 5.7)

— Analects 5.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.7

Day 71 of the calendar · every March 12

孟武伯问：子路仁乎？子曰：不知也。又问。子曰：由也，千乘之国，可使治其赋也，不知其仁也。求也何如？子曰：求也，千室之邑，百乘之家，可使为之宰也，不知其仁也。赤也何如？子曰：赤也，束带立于朝，可使与宾客言也，不知其仁也。

Meng Wubo asked: Is Zilu humane? The Master said: I do not know. He asked again. The Master said: You could be put in charge of the levies of a state of a thousand chariots; I do not know whether he is humane. What about Qiu? The Master said: Qiu could be made steward of a town of a thousand households or a house of a hundred chariots; I do not know whether he is humane. What about Chi? The Master said: Chi, with his sash tied, standing at court, could be made to speak with guests; I do not know whether he is humane.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: on a background check, you call the reference. The reference says: "His ability, I'll vouch for. His character, I can't say."

This chapter connects to

People Meng Wubo: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 2.6)

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 3 of 41 (previous 5.6, next 5.13)

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 2 of 16 (previous 3.6, next 6.3)

People Gongxi Hua (Gongxi Chi): appearance 1 of 5 (next 6.3)

— Analects 5.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.8

Day 72 of the calendar · every March 13

子谓子贡曰：女与回也孰愈？对曰：赐也何敢望回。回也闻一以知十，赐也闻一以知二。子曰：弗如也！吾与女弗如也。

The Master said to Zigong: Who is better, you or Hui? He replied: How would I dare to look up to Hui? Hui hears one thing and knows ten; I hear one thing and know two. The Master said: You are not his equal. I grant that you are not his equal.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the coach asks two players, "Which of you is better?" One of them, without a second thought, points at the other: "Him."

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 6 of 38 (previous 5.3, next 5.11)

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 2 of 21 (previous 2.9, next 5.25)

— Analects 5.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.9

Day 73 of the calendar · every March 14

宰予昼寝。子曰：朽木不可雕也，粪土之墙不可杇也，于予与何诛。子曰：始吾于人也，听其言而信其行；今吾于人也，听其言而观其行。于予与改是。

Zai Yu slept in the daytime. The Master said: Rotten wood cannot be carved; a wall of dung cannot be plastered. As for Yu, what is the use of scolding him? The Master said: At first, with people, I heard their words and trusted their conduct. Now, with people, I hear their words and watch their conduct. It was Yu who made me change.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: three gym memberships in one year, and not a single visit.

This chapter connects to

See also 15.22: The Master said: The gentleman does not promote a man because of his words, nor reject…

People Zai Wo (Zai Yu): appearance 2 of 5 (previous 3.21, next 6.24)

— Analects 5.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.10

Day 74 of the calendar · every March 15

子曰：吾未见刚者。或对曰：申枨。子曰：枨也欲，焉得刚?

The Master said: I have never seen anyone who is truly firm. Someone answered: Shen Cheng. The Master said: Cheng has desires; how can he be firm?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the one who argues hardest in meetings and won't yield to anyone stops dead in his tracks at a mall sale.

This chapter connects to

People Shen Cheng: appears only here

People someone who answered "Shen Cheng": appears only here

— Analects 5.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.11

Day 74 of the calendar · every March 15

子贡曰：我不欲人之加诸我也，吾亦欲无加诸人。子曰：赐也，非尔所及也。

Zigong said: What I do not wish others to do to me, I also wish not to do to others. The Master said: Ci, that is not something you have reached.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: she hates being woken at midnight by work messages, so anything she writes after 10 p.m. she schedules to send the next morning.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 7 of 38 (previous 5.8, next 5.12)

— Analects 5.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.12

Day 75 of the calendar · every March 16

子贡曰：夫子之文章，可得而闻也；夫子之言性与天道，不可得而闻也。

Zigong said: The Master's outward cultivation we may hear about; the Master's words on human nature and the Way of Heaven we may not hear about.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an apprentice has been chopping vegetables in the kitchen for three years. Only on this day does the old chef start teaching her about heat.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 8 of 38 (previous 5.11, next 5.14)

— Analects 5.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.13

Day 75 of the calendar · every March 16

子路有闻，未之能行，唯恐有闻。

When Zilu had heard something and had not yet been able to put it into practice, he only feared hearing something more.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: until you've finished practicing one course, you don't sign up for the next.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 4 of 41 (previous 5.7, next 5.25)

— Analects 5.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.14

Day 76 of the calendar · every March 17

子贡问曰：孔文子何以谓之文也？子曰：敏而好学，不耻下问，是以谓之文也。

Zigong asked: Why was Kong Wenzi called “wen”? The Master said: He was quick and loved learning, and was not ashamed to ask those below him; that is why he was called “wen”.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a boss with only a so-so reputation asks an intern, in front of the whole staff: "I don't understand this. Can you explain it?"

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 9 of 38 (previous 5.12, next 6.6)

People Kong Wenzi: appearance 1 of 2 (next 14.20)

— Analects 5.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.15

Day 77 of the calendar · every March 18

子谓子产，有君子之道四焉：其行己也恭，其事上也敬，其养民也惠，其使民也义。

The Master said of Zichan: He had four ways of the gentleman. In conducting himself he was respectful; in serving his superiors he was reverent; in nourishing the people he was kind; in employing the people he was just.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: don't judge a little shop that's been open thirty years by a single bad review.

This chapter connects to

People Zichan: appearance 1 of 3 (next 14.9)

— Analects 5.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.16

Day 78 of the calendar · every March 19

子曰：晏平仲善与人交，久而敬之。

The Master said: Yan Pingzhong was good at associating with others; long acquainted, he still treated them with respect.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: roommates for five years, and to borrow a charger he still knocks and asks first.

This chapter connects to

People Yan Ying (Yan Pingzhong): appears only here

— Analects 5.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.17

Day 78 of the calendar · every March 19

子曰：臧文仲居蔡，山节藻棁，何如其知也？

The Master said: Zang Wenzhong housed a great tortoise, with hills carved on the capitals and water-weeds painted on the king-posts. How can he be called wise?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: business is slow, so instead of asking customers why, the owner spends a fortune turning the door to face a new direction.

This chapter connects to

People Zang Wenzhong: appearance 1 of 2 (next 15.13)

— Analects 5.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.18

Day 79 of the calendar · every March 20

子张问曰：令尹子文三仕为令尹，无喜色；三已之，无愠色。旧令尹之政，必以告新令尹。何如？子曰：忠矣。曰：仁矣乎？曰：未知，焉得仁？崔子弑齐君，陈文子有马十乘，弃而违之。至于他邦，则曰：犹吾大夫崔子也。违之。之一邦，则又曰：犹吾大夫崔子也。违之。何如？子曰：清矣。曰：仁矣乎？曰：未知。焉得仁？

Zizhang asked: Prime Minister Ziwen took office as prime minister three times without a look of joy, and was dismissed three times without a look of resentment. He always told the new prime minister about the affairs of the old. What do you think of him? The Master said: He was loyal. — Was he humane? — I do not know; how could he be humane? — When Cuizi killed the lord of Qi, Chen Wenzi had ten teams of horses; he gave them up and left. On reaching another state he said: “They are like our grandee Cuizi,” and left. On reaching another state he again said: “They are like our grandee Cuizi,” and left. What do you think of him? The Master said: He was pure. — Was he humane? — I do not know; how could he be humane?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: before leaving the job, she hands over every task one by one, and even writes out the password list and leaves it on the desk.

This chapter connects to

- **People** Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 3 of 20 (previous 2.23, next 11.15)
- **People** Ziwen: appears only here
- **People** Cui Zhu: appears only here
- **People** Duke Zhuang of Qi: appears only here
- **People** Chen Wenzi: appears only here

— Analects 5.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.19

Day 80 of the calendar · every March 21

季文子三思而后行。子闻之，曰：再，斯可矣。

Ji Wenzi thought three times before he acted. When the Master heard of it, he said: Twice is enough.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: he reads a contract three times and still won't sign. By the fourth reading, he starts finding faults that aren't faults.

This chapter connects to

People Ji Wenzi: appears only here

— Analects 5.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.20

Day 80 of the calendar · every March 21

子曰：甯武子邦有道则知，邦无道则愚。其知可及也，其愚不可及也。

The Master said: When the state had the Way, Ning Wuzi was wise; when it lacked the Way, he was foolish. His wisdom can be matched; his foolishness cannot.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the year the company hit trouble, everyone else left. She stayed and sorted out a roomful of messy accounts, entry by entry.

This chapter connects to

People Ning Wuzi: appears only here

Variant The base text has “甯武子”; the standard text has “宁武子”

— Analects 5.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.21

Day 81 of the calendar · every March 22

子在陈曰：归与！归与！吾党之小子狂简，斐然成章，不知所以裁之。

When the Master was in Chen he said: Let us go home! Let us go home! The young men of my village are ambitious and careless; they have produced something of real pattern, but do not know how to cut it to shape.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a talented newcomer's proposal has good ideas on eight pages out of ten, and still needs someone to help cut it down.

— Analects 5.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.22

Day 82 of the calendar · every March 23

子曰：伯夷、叔齐不念旧恶，怨是用希。

The Master said: Bo Yi and Shu Qi did not keep old wrongs in mind, and so resentment was rare.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an old neighbor you once fought with later apologized. Pass in the stairwell now, and you still nod hello.

This chapter connects to

People Bo Yi: appearance 1 of 4 (next 7.14)

People Shu Qi: appearance 1 of 4 (next 7.14)

— Analects 5.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.23

Day 82 of the calendar · every March 23

子曰：孰谓微生高直？或乞醯焉，乞诸其邻而与之。

The Master said: Who says Weisheng Gao is upright? Someone asked him for vinegar; he begged it from his neighbour and gave it to them.

Yikonglu's note Today: a colleague asks to borrow a charging cable. He doesn't have one, so he runs next door, borrows one, and hands it over: "Here, use mine."

This chapter connects to

People Weisheng Gao: appears only here

People someone who asked for vinegar: appears only here

People Weisheng Gao's neighbor: appears only here

— Analects 5.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.24

Day 83 of the calendar · every March 24

子曰：巧言、令色、足恭，左丘明耻之，丘亦耻之。匿怨而友其人，左丘明耻之，丘亦耻之。

The Master said: Fine words, an ingratiating face, excessive deference — Zuoqiu Ming was ashamed of them, and I too am ashamed of them. Hiding resentment and befriending the man — Zuoqiu Ming was ashamed of it, and I too am ashamed of it.

Yikonglu's note Today: holding a grudge, yet first to raise a glass to him at dinner.

This chapter connects to

See also 17.17: The Master said: Clever words and an ingratiating look — seldom are they humane.

People Zuoqiu Ming: appears only here

— Analects 5.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.25

Day 84 of the calendar · every March 25

颜渊、季路侍。子曰：盍各言尔志？子路曰：愿车马、衣轻裘，与朋友共。敝之而无憾。颜渊曰：愿无伐善，无施劳。子路曰：愿闻子之志。子曰：老者安之，朋友信之，少者怀之。

Yan Yuan and Ji Lu were attending. The Master said: Why not each tell me your wishes? Zilu said: I would like to share my carriage, horses, clothes and light furs with my friends, and feel no regret if they wear them out. Yan Yuan said: I would like not to boast of my good points, nor make a show of my merits. Zilu said: We would like to hear your wishes, Master. The Master said: That the old be at ease, friends have trust, and the young be cherished.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: there's a woman in the neighborhood the elderly trust with their keys, and the kids run to her place first after school.

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 3 of 21 (previous 5.8, next 6.2)

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 5 of 41 (previous 5.13, next 6.6)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 24: "He who boasts gets no credit": Yan Yuan's wish was precisely not to boast of his own merits. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion A New Baby: Confucius's wish: to give the old peace, to be trusted by friends, and to cherish the young. At a baby's one-month celebration, elders can say: now the family has one more to "cherish."

— Analects 5.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 5.26

Day 85 of the calendar · every March 26

子曰：已矣乎！吾未见能见其过而内自讼者也。

The Master said: It is hopeless! I have yet to see anyone who can see his own faults and bring the charge against himself inwardly.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: she gave a wrong figure in a meeting and nobody noticed. After it ended, she sent a message correcting it herself.

— Analects 5.26 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.26 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 5.27

Day 85 of the calendar · every March 26

子曰：十室之邑，必有忠信如丘者焉，不如丘之好学也。

The Master said: In a hamlet of ten households there are surely people as loyal and trustworthy as I am, but none as fond of learning as I am.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: honest, reliable people are everywhere. People who start night school at sixty are rare.

— Analects 5.27 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/5.27 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 6 · Yong ye

Analects 6.1

Day 86 of the calendar · every March 27

子曰：雍也可使南面。仲弓问子桑伯子。子曰：可也简。仲弓曰：居敬而行简，以临其民，不亦可乎？居简而行简，无乃大简乎？子曰：雍之言然。

The Master said: Yong could be given the seat facing south. Zhonggong asked about Zisang Bozi. The Master said: He will do; he is simple. Zhonggong said: To dwell in reverence and act simply in governing the people — is that not acceptable? But to dwell in simplicity and act simply — is that not too simple? The Master said: Yong's words are right.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the team with the fewest rules and the most relaxed staff is led by the person who is the most punctual and organized of all.

This chapter connects to

People Zhonggong (Ran Yong): appearance 2 of 6 (previous 5.4, next 6.4)

People Zisang Bozi: appears only here

— Analects 6.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.2

Day 87 of the calendar · every March 28

哀公问：弟子孰为好学？孔子对曰：有颜回者好学，不迁怒，不贰过。不幸短命死矣！今也则亡，未闻好学者也。

Duke Ai asked: Which of your disciples loves learning? Confucius replied: There was Yan Hui who loved learning. He did not shift his anger, and did not repeat a fault. Unfortunately his life was short and he died. Now there is none; I have not heard of anyone who loves learning.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: chewed out at work, he still comes home, crouches down, and ties his child's shoes with care.

This chapter connects to

See also 11.6: Ji Kangzi asked which of the disciples loved learning. Confucius replied: There was Yan…

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 4 of 21 (previous 5.25, next 6.5)

People Duke Ai of Lu: appearance 3 of 5 (previous 3.21, next 12.9)

— Analects 6.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.3

Day 88 of the calendar · every March 29

子华使于齐，冉子为其母请粟。子曰：与之釜。请益。曰：与之庾。冉子与之粟五秉。子曰：赤之适齐也，乘肥马，衣轻裘。吾闻之也，君子周急不继富。原思为之宰，与之粟九百，辞。子曰：毋！以与尔邻里乡党乎！

Zihua was sent on a mission to Qi, and Ranzi asked for grain for his mother. The Master said: Give her a fu. He asked for more. The Master said: Give her a yu. Ranzi gave her five bing of grain. The Master said: When Chi went to Qi he rode fat horses and wore light furs. I have heard that the gentleman helps the needy, not adds to the rich. When Yuan Si became his steward, he was given nine hundred measures of grain, and declined. The Master said: Don't! Give it to your neighbours and villagers.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: financial aid doesn't go to the student who drives up in a sports car to collect it.

This chapter connects to

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 3 of 16 (previous 5.7, next 6.6)

People Gongxi Hua (Gongxi Chi): appearance 2 of 5 (previous 5.7, next 7.33)

People Gongxi Chi's mother: appears only here

People Yuan Si (Yuan Xian): appearance 1 of 3 (next 14.1)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 77: “Who can take his surplus to serve the world?”: Confucius said the gentleman helps those in urgent need and does not add to the wealth of the rich. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 6.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.4

Day 89 of the calendar · every March 30

子谓仲弓曰：犁牛之子骍且角，虽欲勿用，山川其舍诸？

The Master, speaking of Zhonggong, said: If the calf of a brindled ox is red and well-horned, even if people would rather not use it, would the spirits of the hills and rivers reject it?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: when hiring, look at the person's own skill and character, not at who his father is.

This chapter connects to

People Zhonggong (Ran Yong): appearance 3 of 6 (previous 6.1, next 11.2)

— Analects 6.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.5

Day 89 of the calendar · every March 30

子曰：回也，其心三月不违仁，其余则日月至焉而已矣。

The Master said: As for Hui, his heart could go three months without departing from humaneness; the rest reach it only for a day or a month, and that is all.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: three months without a single cigarette is not the same as the odd day you happened not to smoke.

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 5 of 21 (previous 6.2, next 6.9)

— Analects 6.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.6

Day 90 of the calendar · every March 31

季康子问：仲由可使从政也与？子曰：由也果，于从政乎何有？曰：赐也，可使从政也与？曰：赐也达，于从政乎何有？曰：求也，可使从政也与？曰：求也艺，于从政乎何有？

Ji Kangzi asked: Can Zhong You be put in charge of government? The Master said: Yóu is decisive; what difficulty would he have in government? He asked: Can Ci be put in charge of government? The Master said: Ci is perceptive; what difficulty would he have in government? He asked: Can Qiu be put in charge of government? The Master said: Qiu is accomplished; what difficulty would he have in government?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: one is decisive, one knows the market, one can build the spreadsheets. Each does what he does best.

This chapter connects to

See also 13.13: The Master said: If he can make himself correct, what difficulty would he have in…

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 10 of 38 (previous 5.14, next 6.28)

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 6 of 41 (previous 5.25, next 6.26)

People Ji Kangzi: appearance 2 of 8 (previous 2.20, next 10.11)

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 4 of 16 (previous 6.3, next 6.10)

— Analects 6.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.7

Day 91 of the calendar · every April 1

季氏使闵子骞为费宰。闵子骞曰：善为我辞焉。如有复我者，则吾必在汶上矣。

The Ji family wanted to make Min Ziqian steward of Bi. Min Ziqian said: Decline it for me tactfully. If anyone comes for me again, I shall surely be on the far side of the Wen.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a big conglomerate offers top price for a shop that's been in the family three generations. The owner won't sell.

This chapter connects to

People the Ji family: appearance 3 of 7 (previous 3.6, next 11.16)

People Min Ziqian (Min Sun): appearance 1 of 5 (next 11.2)

People the Ji family's messenger: appears only here

— Analects 6.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.8

Day 92 of the calendar · every April 2

伯牛有疾，子问之，自牖执其手，曰：亡之，命矣夫！斯人也而有斯疾也！斯人也而有斯疾也！

Boniu was ill. The Master went to ask after him, and holding his hand through the window, said: We are losing him; it is fate! That such a man should have such an illness! That such a man should have such an illness!

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a close friend is in an isolation ward. Through the glass, all you can do is press your palm against it.

This chapter connects to

People Boniu (Ran Geng): appearance 1 of 2 (next 11.2)

Occasion Visiting the Sick: When his student Boniu fell ill, Confucius went to see him and held his hand through the window. What matters most in visiting the

sick is going, and holding their hand.

Careful Confucius went on to say "We are losing him; it is fate!" This is grief at knowing Boniu was dying. Don't repeat it when visiting the sick.

— Analects 6.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.9

Day 93 of the calendar · every April 3

子曰：贤哉，回也！一箪食，一瓢饮，在陋巷。人不堪其忧，回也不改其乐。贤哉，回也！

The Master said: How worthy Hui is! A bamboo basket of rice, a gourd of water, living in a mean alley: others could not bear the hardship, yet Hui does not let it change his joy. How worthy Hui is!

Yikonglu's note Today: this isn't telling people to love being poor. It's that a small room and plain food can't hold back the thing that makes him glad inside.

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 6 of 21 (previous 6.5, next 7.10)

— Analects 6.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.10

Day 94 of the calendar · every April 4

冉求曰：非不说子之道，力不足也。子曰：力不足者，中道而废。今女画。

Ran Qiu said: It is not that I do not delight in your Way, Master; my strength is not enough. The Master said: Those whose strength is not enough give out halfway. You are drawing a line.

Yikonglu's note Today: "I'm just not cut out for this" often means you practiced for three days and stopped.

This chapter connects to

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 5 of 16 (previous 6.6, next 7.14)

— Analects 6.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.11

Day 94 of the calendar · every April 4

子谓子夏曰：女为君子儒，无为小人儒。

The Master said to Zixia: Be a scholar of the gentleman's kind, not a scholar of the petty man's kind.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: do you read to understand for yourself, or to snap a photo for others to see?

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 4 of 20 (previous 3.8, next 11.2)

— Analects 6.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.12

Day 95 of the calendar · every April 5

子游为武城宰。子曰：女得人焉尔乎？曰：有澹台灭明者，行不由径。非公事，未尝至于偃之室也。

Ziyou was steward of Wucheng. The Master said: Have you found good men there? He said: There is one Tantai Mieming, who never takes a shortcut when walking, and has never come to my rooms except on public business.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: you join the line at the back instead of slipping through a gap in the railings, and you don't drop by the boss's home unless it's on official business.

This chapter connects to

People Ziyou (Yan Yan): appearance 3 of 8 (previous 4.26, next 11.2)

People Tantai Mieming: appears only here

Other books Daodejing, ch. 53: "The people love shortcuts"; Confucius's school praised Tantai Mieming for "never taking shortcuts": the same little path.
Yikonglu's comparison

Variant The base text has “焉尔乎”; the standard text has “焉耳乎”

— Analects 6.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.13

Day 96 of the calendar · every April 6

子曰：孟之反不伐，奔而殿。将入门，策其马，曰：非敢后也，马不进也。

The Master said: Meng Zhifan does not boast. When the army fled, he guarded the rear. As they were about to enter the gate, he whipped his horse and said: It is not that I dared to stay behind; my horse would not go forward.

Yikonglu's note Today: at the celebration, the one who worked hardest pushes the trophy over to the colleague beside him.

This chapter connects to

People Meng Zhifan: appears only here

Other books Daodejing, ch. 24: Meng Zhifan covered the rear in a defeat, and on entering the city said his horse would not go faster, refusing the credit.
Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 6.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.14

Day 97 of the calendar · every April 7

子曰：不有祝鮀之佞而有宋朝之美，难乎免于今之世矣！

The Master said: Without the glibness of the priest Tuo, but with the beauty of Song Zhao, it is hard to escape harm in today's world!

Yikonglu's note Today: the screen is full of smooth talkers and retouched faces. Confucius's remark is a sigh, not a lesson to copy.

This chapter connects to

People Zhu Tuo: appearance 1 of 2 (next 14.20)

People Song Zhao: appears only here

— Analects 6.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.15

Day 97 of the calendar · every April 7

子曰：谁能出不由户？何莫由斯道也？

The Master said: Who can go out without using the door? Why then does no one follow this Way?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: one person follows the GPS along the main road and arrives; another takes a shortcut, runs into a fence, and turns back the way he came.

— Analects 6.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.16

Day 98 of the calendar · every April 8

子曰：质胜文则野，文胜质则史。文质彬彬，然后君子。

The Master said: When substance outweighs refinement, one is rustic; when refinement outweighs substance, one is a clerk. Only when refinement and substance are well blended is one a gentleman.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the gift box is three times the size of the pastry. You unwrap three layers, and inside is one small piece.

— Analects 6.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.17

Day 98 of the calendar · every April 8

子曰：人之生也直，罔之生也幸而免。

The Master said: Man lives by uprightness; the crooked live only by luck, having escaped.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the cashier gives her too much change. She counts it again and hands the extra back.

— Analects 6.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.18

Day 99 of the calendar · every April 9

子曰：知之者不如好之者，好之者不如乐之者。

The Master said: Those who know it are not equal to those who love it; those who love it are not equal to those who delight in it.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: still in the kitchen at midnight trying out a recipe, she takes a taste and is the first to laugh.

This chapter connects to

Occasion Starting School: For a child just starting an extracurricular class or choosing a major. Knowing it is not as good as liking it; liking it is not as good as getting into it and finding joy.

— Analects 6.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.19

Day 100 of the calendar · every April 10

子曰：中人以上，可以语上也；中人以下，不可以语上也。

The Master said: To those above the middling, one can speak of higher things; to those below the middling, one cannot speak of higher things.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a good teacher crouches down and starts with the simplest problem. It isn't condescension; it's so the student can really climb higher.

— Analects 6.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 6.20

Day 101 of the calendar · every April 11

樊迟问知。子曰：务民之义，敬鬼神而远之，可谓知矣。问仁。曰：仁者先难而后获，可谓仁矣。

Fan Chi asked about wisdom. The Master said: To devote oneself to what is right for the people, and to revere the spirits while keeping them at a distance, may be called wisdom. He asked about humaneness. The Master said: The humane put the difficulty first and the reward after; this may be called humaneness.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: lighting incense at a temple before an exam is fine. Back home, you still have to read the books yourself, page by page.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about humaneness — Asked 8 times; see also 12.1 “To restrain oneself and return to ritual is humaneness” · 12.2 “What you do not want for yourself, do not do to others” · 12.3 “The humane are slow to speak” · 12.22 “Love people” · 13.19 “Be respectful at home, reverent in your work, loyal to others” · 15.9 “Serve the worthiest of its officials, befriend the most humane of its scholars” (the question was how to practice humaneness) · 17.6 “Respect, tolerance, trustworthiness, diligence, kindness”

Same question Asked about wisdom — Asked 2 times; see also 12.22 "Know people"

People Fan Chi (Fan Xu): appearance 2 of 6 (previous 2.5, next 12.21)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 60: “When the Way is used to oversee the world, its ghosts lose their power”; Confucius said to respect ghosts and spirits but keep them at a distance. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 6.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.21

Day 102 of the calendar · every April 12

子曰：知者乐水，仁者乐山；知者动，仁者静；知者乐，仁者寿。

The Master said: The wise delight in water; the humane delight in mountains. The wise are active; the humane are still. The wise are joyful; the humane live long.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: one person loves running along the river; another loves spending a whole afternoon in a pavilion on the mountain.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 8: Laozi said "the highest good is like water"; Confucius said "the wise delight in water." Confucians and Daoists both compare people to water. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Naming: Possible names: Leshan 乐山, Leshui 乐水, Renjing 仁静. Le 乐 here means to delight in, and today it is read lè as usual. The mountain stands for steadiness, water for flowing freely; with two children, one could take the mountain and one the water.

Occasion Birthday Wishes for Elders: The safest line for a birthday: the humane live long. Just before it comes "The wise delight in water, the humane delight in mountains," so a birthday couplet can start from mountains and water.

— Analects 6.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.22

Day 102 of the calendar · every April 12

子曰：齐一变，至于鲁；鲁一变，至于道。

The Master said: With one change, Qi could reach the level of Lu; with one change, Lu could reach the Way.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: at one shop a loudspeaker blares about discounts, and there's a long line. At the old shop across the street, nobody hawks anything, and the clerk weighs out the full amount, not an ounce short.

— Analects 6.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.23

Day 102 of the calendar · every April 12

子曰：觚不觚，觚哉！觚哉！

The Master said: A gu that is not a gu — a gu indeed! A gu indeed!

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a thing called a "chair" that looks great but can't be sat on.

— Analects 6.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.24

Day 103 of the calendar · every April 13

宰我问曰：仁者，虽告之曰：井有仁焉。其从之也？子曰：何为其然也？君子可逝也，不可陷也；可欺也，不可罔也。

Zai Wo asked: If a humane man were told, 'Someone humane has fallen into the well,' would he go in after him? The Master said: Why would he do that? A gentleman can be made to go there, but not to fall in; he can be deceived, but not fooled into folly.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a caller says a family member is in trouble and money must be transferred right away. She hangs up and calls her family first.

This chapter connects to

People Zai Wo (Zai Yu): appearance 3 of 5 (previous 5.9, next 11.2)

— Analects 6.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.25

Day 104 of the calendar · every April 14

子曰：君子博学于文，约之以礼，亦可以弗畔矣夫！

The Master said: A gentleman who learns broadly in culture and restrains it with ritual may thereby avoid going astray.

Yikonglu's note Today: hundreds of courses saved in the bookmarks, and not one of them finished.

This chapter connects to

See also 12.15: The Master said: Learn broadly in culture and restrain it with ritual, and you may…

Other books Daodejing, ch. 81: “Those who know are not broadly learned; the broadly learned do not know.” Confucius said broad learning must also be held in check by ritual. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 6.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.26

Day 105 of the calendar · every April 15

子见南子，子路不说。夫子矢之曰：予所否者，天厌之！天厌之！

The Master went to see Nanzi, and Zilu was displeased. The Master swore: If I have done wrong, may Heaven reject me! May Heaven reject me!

Yikonglu's note Today: someone you have to meet on official business has a bad reputation. Meeting him is just doing things by the rules. As long as you hold your own ground, let the gossip be for now.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 7 of 41 (previous 6.6, next 7.10)

People Nanzi: appears only here

— Analects 6.26 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.26 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.27

Day 105 of the calendar · every April 15

子曰：中庸之为德也，其至矣乎！民鲜久矣。

The Master said: As a virtue, the constant mean is the highest of all! Yet it has long been rare among the people.

Yikonglu's note Today: a little noodle shop on the corner has opened on the dot every day for thirty years, and its broth has never been saltier or blander. The hard part isn't making one good bowl; it's making it the same every day.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 13: The two words in the title of the Doctrine of the Mean: Confucius long ago called it the highest virtue.
Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 6.27 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.27 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 6.28

Day 106 of the calendar · every April 16

子贡曰：如有博施于民而能济众，何如？可谓仁乎？子曰：何事于仁，必也圣乎！尧舜其犹病诸！夫仁者，己欲立而立人，己欲达而达人。能近取譬，可谓仁之方也已。

Zigong said: If someone gave widely to the people and could relieve the multitude, what would you say? Could he be called humane? The Master said: Why stop at humane? He would surely be a sage! Even Yao and Shun found this hard. The humane man, wishing to stand, helps others stand; wishing to reach, helps others reach. To take what is near as an example — this may be called the method of humaneness.

Yikonglu's note Today: saving the whole world is beyond anyone's reach. When an old man on the subway can't keep his balance and the person beside him stands up to offer a seat, that is within reach.

This chapter connects to

See also 14.45: Zilu asked about the gentleman. The Master said: He cultivates himself with reverence. Is…

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 11 of 38 (previous 6.6, next 7.14)

People Yao: appearance 1 of 4 (next 8.19)

People Shun: appearance 1 of 7 (next 8.18)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 7: "Put yourself last and you come first": think of others first and you yourself will stand firm. Confucius also said "wanting to stand, help others stand." Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 6.28 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/6.28 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 7 · Shu er

Analects 7.1

Day 107 of the calendar · every April 17

子曰：述而不作，信而好古，窃比于我老彭。

The Master said: I transmit and do not create; I trust and love antiquity. I venture to compare myself to our Old Peng.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an apprentice at an old family business follows the old recipe his master left, step by step. If he does it well, the recipe lives on.

This chapter connects to

People Lao Peng: appears only here

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 15: The "transmit" in "transmit the sages' words" is the same word Confucius used when he said he "transmits and does not create". Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 6: Du Daojian notes that Laozi often says "what the ancients called" and "the established sayings have it": he is passing on the ancients, just like Confucius's "transmitting, not creating." a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 14: "Hold to the Way of old to manage what is here today": Confucius likewise said he "trusted and loved antiquity". Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 7.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.2

Day 107 of the calendar · every April 17

子曰：默而识之，学而不厌，诲人不倦，何有于我哉？

The Master said: To store things silently in mind, to learn without tiring, to teach others without weariness — which of these is in me?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: praise the teacher still grading homework late at night, and she says: it's nothing, I still have a long way to go.

This chapter connects to

See also 7.33: The Master said: As for sagehood and humaneness, how would I dare? But working at them…

— Analects 7.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 7.3

Day 108 of the calendar · every April 18

子曰：德之不修，学之不讲，闻义不能徙，不善不能改，是吾忧也。

The Master said: Virtue not cultivated, learning not discussed, hearing what is right yet not moving toward it, having faults yet not correcting them — these are my worries.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: last night you promised not to stay up late; tonight you pick up the phone again. Knowing you should change counts only when you finally put the phone out of reach.

— Analects 7.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 7.4

Day 108 of the calendar · every April 18

子之燕居，申申如也，夭夭如也。

At leisure at home, the Master was relaxed and easy, cheerful and at ease.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: someone at home on the weekend, neither stiff nor slumped, smiling as she waters the flowers on the balcony.

— Analects 7.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.5

Day 109 of the calendar · every April 19

子曰：甚矣吾衰也！久矣，吾不复梦见周公。

The Master said: How far I have declined! It has been long since I last saw the Duke of Zhou in my dreams.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a retired engineer explains blueprints to young people with great animation, then adds at the end: as for the building sites, I can't get around those anymore.

This chapter connects to

People the Duke of Zhou: appearance 1 of 4 (next 8.11)

— Analects 7.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.6

Day 109 of the calendar · every April 19

子曰：志于道，据于德，依于仁，游于艺。

The Master said: Set your will on the Way, hold to virtue, rely on humaneness, and roam in the arts.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: work by day, an hour of calligraphy practice at night. Calligraphy won't put food on the table, but it keeps a person from falling apart.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 39: "Play brings no benefit" doesn't mean no play at all: Confucius also said "take your ease in the arts."

Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Naming: One line gives four names: Zhidao 志道, Jude 据德, Yiren 依仁, Youyi 游艺. Siblings can each take one, and in order they make the whole sentence. Yi 艺 here means the six skills: ritual, music, archery, charioteering, writing and arithmetic. Taking Youyi doesn't mean loving play.

— Analects 7.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.7

Day 109 of the calendar · every April 19

子曰：自行束修以上，吾未尝无诲焉。

The Master said: From anyone who brought a bundle of dried meat or more, I never withheld instruction.

> **Yikonglu's note** Shuxiu was a bundle of ten strips of dried meat, the humblest greeting gift of the time. Confucius means the bar was so low it barely existed, not that he charged tuition.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the community's free night school keeps its door open. Most who come are just off work; a notebook in hand is all they need.

— Analects 7.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.8

Day 110 of the calendar · every April 20

子曰：不愤不启，不悱不发。举一隅不以三隅反，则不复也。

The Master said: I do not open the way for one who is not eager, nor help out one who is not struggling to speak. If I show one corner and he cannot come back with the other three, I do not repeat myself.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the child has been stuck on a problem for half an hour. Mom has the answer in her hand but doesn't pass it over. She only asks: which step are you stuck on?

This chapter connects to

Occasion Starting School: A line for teachers and parents: give a pointer only when the child has thought hard and is getting anxious; help put it into words only when they want to say it but can't. At the start of term, don't rush to hand out every answer.

— Analects 7.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.9

Day 110 of the calendar · every April 20

子食于有丧者之侧，未尝饱也。子于是日哭，则不歌。

When the Master ate beside someone in mourning, he never ate his fill. On a day when he had wept, he did not sing.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: driving home from a funeral, the music comes on in the car, and you reach over and turn it off. No rule says so; you just can't sing.

This chapter connects to

People someone in mourning: appears only here

Occasion Mourning: Rules for the day of a condolence visit: eating beside a family in mourning, Confucius never ate his fill; on a day he had wept, he did not sing.

— Analects 7.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.10

Day 111 of the calendar · every April 21

子谓颜渊曰：用之则行，舍之则藏；唯我与尔有是夫。子路曰：子行三军，则谁与？子曰：暴虎冯河，死而无悔者，吾不与也。必也，临事而惧，好谋而成者也。

The Master said to Yan Yuan: When employed, act; when set aside, withdraw — only you and I are like this. Zilu said: If you led the three armies, whom would you take with you? The Master said: One who would fight a tiger bare-handed or ford a river on foot, dying without regret — him I would not take. It must be someone who approaches affairs with caution and likes to plan and succeed.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the night before a climbing team sets out, the leader spreads out the map and goes through it point by point: where can we re-

> treat, how many days will the water last, what if the weather turns? The one who asks the most detailed questions is often the boldest on the mountain.

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 7 of 21 (previous 6.9, next 9.10)

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 8 of 41 (previous 6.26, next 7.18)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 30: "Achieve the result but do not be proud, achieve it but do not boast": the commander Confucius wants is also one who "approaches the task with fear and succeeds through good planning". Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 69: “No disaster is greater than underestimating the enemy”: Confucius wanted exactly someone who “approaches a task with fear.” Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 73: “Brave in not daring, one lives”: Confucius did not want men who would fight a tiger bare-handed or wade across a river. Yikonglu's comparison

Variant The base text has “唯我与尔”; the standard text has “惟我与尔”

— Analects 7.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.11

Day 112 of the calendar · every April 22

子曰：富而可求也，虽执鞭之士，吾亦为之。如不可求，从吾所好。

The Master said: If wealth could be sought, I would do it even as a man holding the whip. If it cannot be sought, I follow what I love.

— Analects 7.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.12

Day 113 of the calendar · every April 23

子之所慎：齐、战、疾。

The things the Master was careful about: fasting, war, and illness.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 31: "Weapons are instruments of ill omen": war is one of the three things Confucius treated with the greatest care. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 68: “A good officer is not warlike”: war was among the things Confucius treated with the greatest care. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Visiting the Sick: Illness is one of the three things Confucius was most careful about. A word for the patient's family: don't let an illness drag on; do what the doctor says.

— Analects 7.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.13

Day 113 of the calendar · every April 23

子在齐闻韶，三月不知肉味。曰：不图为乐之至于斯也！

In Qi the Master heard the Shao music, and for three months did not know the taste of meat. He said: I never imagined music could reach such heights!

— Analects 7.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.14

Day 114 of the calendar · every April 24

冉有曰：夫子为卫君乎？子贡曰：诺。吾将问之。入，曰：伯夷、叔齐何人也？曰：古之贤人也。曰：怨乎？曰：求仁而得仁，又何怨。出，曰：夫子不为也。

Ran You said: Is our Master on the side of the ruler of Wei? Zigong said: Well, I will ask him. He went in and said: What sort of men were Boyi and Shuqi? The Master said: Worthy men of old. Did they feel resentment? They sought humaneness and attained it; what was there to resent? Zigong came out and said: The Master is not on his side.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 12 of 38 (previous 6.28, next 9.6)

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 6 of 16 (previous 6.10, next 11.2)

People Bo Yi: appearance 2 of 4 (previous 5.22, next 16.12)

People Shu Qi: appearance 2 of 4 (previous 5.22, next 16.12)

People Duke Chu of Wei: appearance 1 of 2 (next 13.3)

— Analects 7.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.15

Day 115 of the calendar · every April 25

子曰：饭疏食饮水，曲肱而枕之，乐亦在其中矣。不义而富且贵，于我如浮云。

The Master said: Eating coarse food and drinking water, bending my arm for a pillow — there is joy in this too. Wealth and rank gained unjustly are to me like floating clouds.

— Analects 7.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.16

Day 116 of the calendar · every April 26

子曰：加我数年，五十以学易，可以无大过矣。

The Master said: Give me a few more years, and if I could study the Changes at fifty, I might be free of great faults.

> **Yikonglu's note** Both readings have grounds. Zhu Xi reads it as studying the Changes; the Lu version of the Analects has "also" instead, which makes it "study again at fifty, and I too can be free of great errors." Yikonglu keeps both readings.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 14: The Three Changes connect with Confucius saying he studied the Changes late in life. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 7.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.17

Day 116 of the calendar · every April 26

子所雅言：诗、书、执礼，皆雅言也。

What the Master spoke in the standard pronunciation: the Odes, the Documents, and the conduct of ritual — all in the standard speech.

— Analects 7.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.18

Day 117 of the calendar · every April 27

叶公问孔子于子路，子路不对。子曰：女奚不曰，其为人也，发愤忘食，乐以忘忧，不知老之将至云尔。

The Duke of She asked Zilu about Confucius, and Zilu did not answer. The Master said: Why did you not say: He is the kind of man who forgets to eat in his eagerness, forgets his worries in his joy, and does not notice that old age is coming?

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 9 of 41 (previous 7.10, next 7.34)

People the Duke of She: appearance 1 of 3 (next 13.16)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 31: Tying one's hair to a beam and jabbing one's thigh with an awl are stories of hard study. Confucius said of himself that when absorbed in learning he forgot to eat. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 33: Su Xun "first resolved to study hard" at twenty-seven. The Yinshu commentary cites this line of Confucius to explain "resolved." a commentator's reading

Occasion Birthday Wishes for Elders: For elders still learning and still busy: so absorbed he forgets to eat, so happy he forgets his worries, not even noticing old age coming on. Confucius said that's the kind of man he was.

— Analects 7.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.19

Day 118 of the calendar · every April 28

子曰：我非生而知之者，好古，敏以求之者也。

The Master said: I was not born knowing. I love antiquity and am quick to seek it out.

— Analects 7.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.20

Day 118 of the calendar · every April 28

子不语：怪、力、乱、神。

The Master did not speak of the strange, of force, of disorder, or of spirits.

— Analects 7.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.21

Day 119 of the calendar · every April 29

子曰：三人行，必有我师焉。择其善者而从之，其不善者而改之。

The Master said: When three walk together, there is surely a teacher for me among them. I pick out the good and follow it; the not-good I correct in myself.

This chapter connects to

See also 7.27: The Master said: There may be those who act without knowing; I am not one of them. I hear...

Other books Daodejing, ch. 27: "The good man is the teacher of the bad; the bad man is the material of the good": Confucius says good and bad alike are teachers. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Starting School: For new classmates and roommates. Everyone around you has something worth learning; when you see someone's shortcoming, turn and check whether you have it too.

Careful The second half of the line is “and correct in myself what is not good in them”; it isn't only about finding good teachers.

— Analects 7.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.22

Day 120 of the calendar · every April 30

子曰：天生德于予，桓魋其如予何?

The Master said: Heaven gave birth to the virtue in me; what can Huan Tui do to me?

This chapter connects to

People Huan Tui: appears only here

— Analects 7.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.23

Day 120 of the calendar · every April 30

子曰：二三子以我为隐乎？吾无隐乎尔。吾无行而不与二三子者，是丘也。

The Master said: You, my disciples, think I am hiding something? I hide nothing from you. There is nothing I do that I do not share with you — that is who I am.

— Analects 7.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.24

Day 120 of the calendar · every April 30

子以四教：文、行、忠、信。

The Master taught four things: culture, conduct, loyalty, and good faith.

— Analects 7.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.25

Day 121 of the calendar · every May 1

子曰：圣人，吾不得而见之矣；得见君子者，斯可矣。子曰：善人，吾不得而见之矣；得见有恒者，斯可矣。亡而为有，虚而为盈，约而为泰，难乎有恒矣。

The Master said: A sage I cannot hope to see; if I could see a gentleman, that would be enough. The Master said: A good man I cannot hope to see; if I could see someone constant, that would be enough. Having nothing yet acting as if one has, being empty yet acting full, being straitened yet acting at ease — it is hard for such a one to be constant.

— Analects 7.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.26

Day 122 of the calendar · every May 2

子钓而不纲，弋不射宿。

The Master fished with a line but not with a net; he shot birds with a corded arrow, but not birds at roost.

— Analects 7.26 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.26 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.27

Day 122 of the calendar · every May 2

子曰：盖有不知而作之者，我无是也。多闻择其善者而从之，多见而识之，知之次也。

The Master said: There may be those who act without knowing; I am not one of them. I hear much, choose the good and follow it; I see much and remember it. This is the next best to knowing.

This chapter connects to

See also 7.21: The Master said: When three walk together, there is surely a teacher for me among them. I…

Other books Daodejing, ch. 48: Su Zhe explains "In pursuing learning, one gains daily" by citing Confucius's "hear much, choose the good and follow it," which he says is only "the next level of knowing." a commentator's reading

— Analects 7.27 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.27 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.28

Day 123 of the calendar · every May 3

互乡难与言，童子见，门人惑。子曰：与其进也，不与其退也，唯何甚！人洁己以进，与其洁也，不保其往也。

The people of Huxiang were hard to talk with. A boy from there came to see the Master, and the disciples were puzzled. The Master said: I approve of his coming forward, not of his going back. Why be so severe? When a person purifies himself to come forward, I approve of that purity; I do not vouch for his past.

This chapter connects to

People the boy from Huxiang: appears only here

— Analects 7.28 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.28 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.29

Day 123 of the calendar · every May 3

子曰：仁远乎哉？我欲仁，斯仁至矣。

The Master said: Is humaneness far away? I wish for humaneness, and here humaneness is.

— Analects 7.29 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.29 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.30

Day 124 of the calendar · every May 4

陈司败问：昭公知礼乎？孔子曰：知礼。孔子退，揖巫马期而进之，曰：吾闻君子不党，君子亦党乎？君取于吴为同姓，谓之吴孟子。君而知礼，孰不知礼？巫马期以告。子曰：丘也幸，苟有过，人必知之。

The Minister of Crime of Chen asked whether Duke Zhao knew ritual. Confucius said: He knew ritual. After Confucius withdrew, the minister bowed Wuma Qi forward and said: I have heard that a gentleman is not partial; is a gentleman partial after all? Your lord married a woman of Wu of the same surname and called her Wu Mengzi. If your lord knew ritual, who does not know ritual? Wuma Qi reported this. The Master said: I am fortunate. If I make a mistake, others are sure to know it.

This chapter connects to

See also 3.22: The Master said: Guan Zhong's capacity was small indeed! Someone said: Was Guan Zhong…

See also 19.21: Zigong said: The faults of the gentleman are like eclipses of the sun and moon. When he…

People the Minister of Justice of Chen: appears only here

People Duke Zhao of Lu: appears only here

People Wuma Qi (Wuma Shi): appears only here

People Wu Mengzi: appears only here

— Analects 7.30 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.30 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.31

Day 125 of the calendar · every May 5

子与人歌而善，必使反之，而后和之。

When the Master sang with others and someone sang well, he would have him repeat it, and then join in.

This chapter connects to

People Someone singing with Confucius: appears only here

— Analects 7.31 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.31 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.32

Day 125 of the calendar · every May 5

子曰：文，莫吾犹人也。躬行君子，则吾未之有得。

The Master said: In learning I may be no worse than others. But as for living as a gentleman in my own conduct, that I have not yet attained.

— Analects 7.32 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.32 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.33

Day 126 of the calendar · every May 6

子曰：若圣与仁，则吾岂敢？抑为之不厌，诲人不倦，则可谓云尔已矣。公西华曰：正唯弟子不能学也。

The Master said: As for sagehood and humaneness, how would I dare? But working at them without tiring and teaching others without weariness — that much may be said of me. Gongxi Hua said: That is exactly what we disciples cannot learn.

This chapter connects to

See also 7.2: The Master said: To store things silently in mind, to learn without tiring, to teach…

People Gongxi Hua (Gongxi Chi): appearance 3 of 5 (previous 6.3, next 11.21)

— Analects 7.33 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.33 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.34

Day 127 of the calendar · every May 7

子疾病，子路请祷。子曰：有诸？子路对曰：有之。诔曰：祷尔于上下神祇。子曰：丘之祷久矣。

The Master was gravely ill, and Zilu asked to offer prayers. The Master said: Is there such a thing? Zilu replied: There is. The eulogy says: We pray for you to the spirits above and below. The Master said: My praying has gone on for a long time.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 10 of 41 (previous 7.18, next 9.11)

— Analects 7.34 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.34 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.35

Day 127 of the calendar · every May 7

子曰：奢则不孙，俭则固。与其不孙也，宁固。

The Master said: Extravagance leads to arrogance; frugality leads to shabbiness. Rather than be arrogant, better to be shabby.

— Analects 7.35 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.35 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.36

Day 128 of the calendar · every May 8

子曰：君子坦荡荡，小人长戚戚。

The Master said: The gentleman is open and at ease; the petty man is always anxious and distressed.

— Analects 7.36 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.36 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 7.37

Day 129 of the calendar · every May 9

子温而厉，威而不猛，恭而安。

The Master was gentle yet stern, commanding yet not fierce, respectful yet at ease.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 58: “Sharp-edged but not cutting”: Confucius was “warm yet stern, dignified yet not fierce,” the same “A but not B” pattern.

Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 7.37 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/7.37 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 8 · Tai bo

Analects 8.1

Day 130 of the calendar · every May 10

子曰：泰伯，其可谓至德也已矣！三以天下让，民无得而称焉。

The Master said: Taibo may be called a man of the highest virtue! Three times he declined the realm, and the people could find no words to praise him.

This chapter connects to

See also 8.20: Shun had five ministers and the realm was well governed. King Wu said: I have ten…

People Taibo: appears only here

— Analects 8.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.2

Day 131 of the calendar · every May 11

子曰：恭而无礼则劳，慎而无礼则葸，勇而无礼则乱，直而无礼则绞。君子笃于亲，则民兴于仁；故旧不遗，则民不偷。

The Master said: Respect without ritual becomes toil; caution without ritual becomes timidity; courage without ritual becomes disorder; straightness without ritual becomes harshness. When the gentleman is devoted to his kin, the people rise to humaneness; when old friends are not forgotten, the people are not cold.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 58: "Straight but not reckless": straightness needs restraint. Confucius says straightness without ritual hurts people.

Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 8.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.3

Day 132 of the calendar · every May 12

曾子有疾，召门弟子曰：启予足！启予手！诗云战战兢兢，如临深渊，如履薄冰。而今而后，吾知免夫！小子！

Zengzi was ill and called his disciples: Uncover my feet! Uncover my hands! The Odes say: 'Fearful and careful, as if near a deep abyss, as if treading thin ice.' From now on, I know I am spared, my young friends!

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 4 of 15 (previous 4.15, next 8.4)

Other books Book of Songs, Lesser Odes, "Xiao Min": "Trembling and wary, as if at the edge of a deep abyss, as if treading on thin ice." source

Other books Daodejing, ch. 15: "Hesitant, as if crossing a river in winter": as careful as crossing a frozen river. Zengzi's quotation from the Book of Songs shows the same. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 22: Heshang Gong reads "return it whole" as returning one's body intact to one's parents; Zengzi on his deathbed, saying "uncover my feet, uncover my hands", did exactly this. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 8.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.4

Day 133 of the calendar · every May 13

曾子有疾，孟敬子问之。曾子言曰：鸟之将死，其鸣也哀；人之将死，其言也善。君子所贵乎道者三：动容貌，斯远暴慢矣；正颜色，斯近信矣；出辞气，斯远鄙倍矣。笾豆之事，则有司存。

Zengzi was ill and Meng Jingzi came to ask after him. Zengzi said: When a bird is about to die, its cry is mournful; when a man is about to die, his words are good. There are three things in the Way that a gentleman values: in his bearing, he keeps far from violence and insolence; in setting his countenance, he comes near to good faith; in his words and tone, he keeps far from vulgarity and impropriety. As for the matters of ritual vessels, there are officers for that.

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 5 of 15 (previous 8.3, next 8.5)

People Meng Jingzi: appears only here

— Analects 8.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.5

Day 134 of the calendar · every May 14

曾子曰：以能问于不能，以多问于寡；有若无，实若虚；犯而不校。昔者吾友尝从事于斯矣。

Zengzi said: Able, yet asking those less able; knowing much, yet asking those who know little; having, as if not having; full, as if empty; wronged, yet not retaliating — once I had a friend who lived this way.

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 6 of 15 (previous 8.4, next 8.6)

People Zengzi's friend: appears only here

Other books Daodejing, ch. 45: "Great fullness seems empty": Zengzi says his friend (Yan Yuan, according to Zhu Xi's commentary) had yet seemed to lack, was full yet seemed empty. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 76: “The strong and great sit below, the soft and weak sit above”: Zengzi said his friend (Yan Yuan, per Zhu Xi's commentary) had yet seemed to lack, was full yet seemed empty. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 8.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.6

Day 135 of the calendar · every May 15

曾子曰：可以托六尺之孤，可以寄百里之命，临大节而不可夺也。君子人与？君子人也。

Zengzi said: One who can be entrusted with an orphaned young ruler, who can be given charge of a state of a hundred li, and who in a great crisis cannot be swayed — is he a gentleman? He is a gentleman.

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 7 of 15 (previous 8.5, next 8.7)

— Analects 8.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.7

Day 136 of the calendar · every May 16

曾子曰：士不可以不弘毅，任重而道远。仁以为己任，不亦重乎？死而后已，不亦远乎？

Zengzi said: A scholar must be broad and resolute, for his burden is heavy and his road is long. He takes humaneness as his burden — is that not heavy? It ends only with death — is that not long?

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 8 of 15 (previous 8.6, next 11.17)

Occasion Naming: Possible names: Hongyi 弘毅, or just Hong 弘 or Yi 毅. Hong is breadth of mind, yi is toughness of character; together they give the sense of the line. Works for boys and girls.

Occasion Graduation: A closing line for a graduation speech. Just before it comes "A scholar must be broad and resolute": the road is long and the load is heavy, so the heart must be wide and the spirit tough.

— Analects 8.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.8

Day 137 of the calendar · every May 17

子曰：兴于诗，立于礼。成于乐。

The Master said: Be roused by the Odes, be established by ritual, be completed by music.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 10: The eight sounds are instruments; Confucius speaks of what music is for: character is completed in music.
Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 14: The order of Songs, ritual and music among the Six Classics: Confucius covers it all in one line.
Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 8.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.9

Day 137 of the calendar · every May 17

子曰：民可使由之，不可使知之。

The Master said: The people can be made to follow it, but cannot be made to understand it.

> **Yikonglu's note** "Cannot" means unable, not forbidden. The people can follow it, but not everyone can understand the reasons behind it. Master Cheng

said that claiming the sage kept the people from knowing is the scheming of later ages.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 65: “Not to enlighten the people but to keep them simple”: the two lines are often read side by side, and both depend on how the old commentaries read them. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 8.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.10

Day 137 of the calendar · every May 17

子曰：好勇疾贫，乱也。人而不仁，疾之已甚，乱也。

The Master said: One who loves daring and hates poverty will make trouble. A man who is not humane, if hated too much, will make trouble.

— Analects 8.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.11

Day 138 of the calendar · every May 18

子曰：如有周公之才之美，使骄且吝，其余不足观也已。

The Master said: Even with the talents and fine qualities of the Duke of Zhou, if a man were arrogant and stingy, the rest would not be worth looking at.

This chapter connects to

People the Duke of Zhou: appearance 2 of 4 (previous 7.5, next 11.16)

— Analects 8.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.12

Day 138 of the calendar · every May 18

子曰：三年学，不至于谷，不易得也。

The Master said: One who studies for three years without aiming at a salary is not easy to find.

— Analects 8.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.13

Day 139 of the calendar · every May 19

子曰：笃信好学，守死善道。危邦不入，乱邦不居。天下有道则见，无道则隐。邦有道，贫且贱焉，耻也；邦无道，富且贵焉，耻也。

The Master said: Hold firmly to good faith and love learning; guard the good Way unto death. Do not enter a state in danger; do not live in a state in disorder. When the realm has the Way, show yourself; when it lacks the Way, stay hidden. When the state has the Way, to be poor and lowly is shameful; when the state lacks the Way, to be rich and honored is shameful.

— Analects 8.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.14

Day 140 of the calendar · every May 20

子曰：不在其位，不谋其政。

The Master said: When not in the office, do not plan its affairs.

This chapter connects to

See also 14.27: The Master said: When not in the office, do not plan its affairs.

— Analects 8.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.15

Day 140 of the calendar · every May 20

子曰：师挚之始，关雎之乱，洋洋乎！盈耳哉。

The Master said: From Music Master Zhi's opening to the finale of the Guanju — how full and flowing it fills the ears!

This chapter connects to

People Music Master Zhi: appearance 1 of 2 (next 18.9)

— Analects 8.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.16

Day 140 of the calendar · every May 20

子曰：狂而不直，侗而不愿，悾悾而不信，吾不知之矣。

The Master said: Wild yet not straight, ignorant yet not honest, simple yet not trustworthy — such people I do not understand.

— Analects 8.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.17

Day 141 of the calendar · every May 21

子曰：学如不及，犹恐失之。

The Master said: Learn as if you could not catch up, and still fear losing it.

This chapter connects to

Occasion Starting School: For older students and those preparing for exams. Study as if you can't catch up, and once you have, still fear losing it.

— Analects 8.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.18

Day 141 of the calendar · every May 21

子曰：巍巍乎！舜禹之有天下也，而不与焉。

The Master said: How lofty! Shun and Yu possessed the realm, yet did not make it their concern.

This chapter connects to

People Shun: appearance 2 of 7 (previous 6.28, next 8.20)

People Yu: appearance 1 of 4 (next 8.21)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 2: "Achieve and do not dwell on it": Shun and Yu gained the realm without treating it as their own. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 13: "Valuing one's own person as the world": commentators borrow Confucius's praise of Shun and Yu, who "held the world yet did not make it their own". a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 29: Lü Huiqing's commentary, recorded by Jiao Hong, cites "Lofty indeed, how Shun and Yu held the world yet did not make it their own" to explain "the world is a sacred vessel; it cannot be acted upon". a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 51: "It gives life but does not possess; it acts but does not rely on it": holding the world without treating it as one's own. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 8.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.19

Day 142 of the calendar · every May 22

子曰：大哉！尧之为君也。巍巍乎！唯天为大，唯尧则之。荡荡乎！民无能名焉。巍巍乎！其有成功也。焕乎！其有文章。

The Master said: Great indeed was Yao as a ruler! How lofty! Only Heaven is great, and only Yao modeled himself on it. How vast! The people could find no name for it. How lofty were his achievements! How brilliant his culture!

This chapter connects to

People Yao: appearance 2 of 4 (previous 6.28, next 14.45)

Other books Mencius, Teng Wen Gong I, chapter 4: Confucius said: "Great indeed was Yao as a ruler!" source

Other books Mencius, Teng Wen Gong I, chapter 4: "Only Heaven is great, and only Yao modeled himself on it." source

Other books Mencius, Teng Wen Gong I, chapter 4: "So vast! The people could find no name for it!" source

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 19: Wang Xiang explains Yao using Confucius's own words of praise for Yao. a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 25: Laozi says "Heaven is great, earth is great, the king too is great"; Confucius praises Yao: "Only Heaven is great, and only Yao modeled himself on it." Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 34: "It completes its work and claims no credit": Confucius praised Yao, whose people could not say what made him so good. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 8.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.20

Day 143 of the calendar · every May 23

舜有臣五人而天下治。武王曰：予有乱臣十人。孔子曰：才难，不其然乎？唐、虞之际，于斯为盛。有妇人焉，九人而已。三分天下有其二，以服事殷。周之德，其可谓至德也已矣。

Shun had five ministers and the realm was well governed. King Wu said: I have ten ministers who keep order. Confucius said: Talent is hard to find — is it not so? From the time of Tang and Yu, it flourished most in this age; and one of them was a woman, so there were only nine men. Holding two thirds of the realm, Zhou still served Yin. The virtue of Zhou may be called the highest virtue.

This chapter connects to

See also 8.1: The Master said: Taibo may be called a man of the highest virtue! Three times he declined…

People Shun: appearance 3 of 7 (previous 8.18, next 12.22)

People King Wu of Zhou: appearance 1 of 3 (next 19.22)

People A woman: appears only here

People King Wen of Zhou: appearance 1 of 3 (next 9.5)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 19: "Tang and Yu" refers to Yao and Shun; Shun governed the world with five worthy ministers. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 20: King Wu of Zhou's "ten ministers of luan": luan here means to govern, so ten ministers able to bring order out of chaos. a commentator's reading

— Analects 8.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 8.21

Day 144 of the calendar · every May 24

子曰：禹，吾无间然矣。菲饮食，而致孝乎鬼神；恶衣服，而致美乎黻冕；卑宫室，而尽力乎沟洫。禹，吾无间然矣。

The Master said: In Yu I find no fault. He ate and drank simply, yet was utterly devoted to the spirits; he wore poor clothes, yet made his ceremonial robes and cap beautiful; he lived in a low palace, yet gave all his strength to the irrigation channels. In Yu I find no fault.

This chapter connects to

People Yu: appearance 2 of 4 (previous 8.18, next 14.6)

— Analects 8.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/8.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 9 · Zi han

Analects 9.1

Day 145 of the calendar · every May 25

子罕言利与命与仁。

The Master seldom spoke of profit, but he endorsed fate and endorsed humaneness.

> **Yikonglu's note** Confucius seldom spoke of profit, but he endorsed fate and endorsed humaneness. The Analects mentions humaneness more than a hundred times, so saying Confucius rarely spoke of it doesn't hold up. The video follows Zhu Xi, saying he rarely spoke of all three; Yikonglu takes the reading that 与 means "endorse."

— Analects 9.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.2

Day 145 of the calendar · every May 25

达巷党人曰：大哉孔子！博学而无所成名。子闻之，谓门弟子曰：吾何执？执御乎？执射乎？吾执御矣。

A man of Daxiang village said: Great indeed is Confucius! He has learned so broadly, yet made no name in any one thing. Hearing this, the Master said to his disciples: What should I take up? Charioteering? Archery? I will take up charioteering.

This chapter connects to

People A man from Daxiang: appears only here

— Analects 9.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.3

Day 146 of the calendar · every May 26

子曰：麻冕，礼也；今也纯，俭。吾从众。拜下，礼也；今拜乎上，泰也。虽违众，吾从下。

The Master said: A linen cap is the ritual; now silk is used, which is more frugal, and I follow the majority. Bowing below the hall is the ritual; now people bow above it, which is presumptuous. Though it goes against the majority, I bow below.

— Analects 9.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.4

Day 146 of the calendar · every May 26

子绝四：毋意，毋必，毋固，毋我。

The Master was free of four things: no presumption, no insistence, no stubbornness, no self.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 13: Wang Pang, explaining "I have great trouble because I have a body", cites Confucius's "no self" and says the principle is the same. a commentator's reading

— Analects 9.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.5

Day 147 of the calendar · every May 27

子畏于匡。曰：文王既没，文不在兹乎？天之将丧斯文也，后死者不得与于斯文也；天之未丧斯文也，匡人其如予何？

The Master was in peril in Kuang. He said: Since King Wen is gone, is culture not here in me? If Heaven meant to destroy this culture, those who came after would not have shared in it. If Heaven does not mean to destroy this culture, what can the people of Kuang do to me?

This chapter connects to

People King Wen of Zhou: appearance 2 of 3 (previous 8.20, next 19.22)

— Analects 9.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.6

Day 148 of the calendar · every May 28

大宰问于子贡曰：夫子圣者与？何其多能也？子贡曰：固天纵之将圣，又多能也。子闻之，曰：大宰知我乎？吾少也贱，故多能鄙事。君子多乎哉？不多也。牢曰：子云，吾不试，故艺。

The Grand Steward asked Zigong: Is your Master a sage? How many skills he has! Zigong said: Heaven has indeed endowed him to be nearly a sage, and he has many skills as well. Hearing this, the Master said: Does the Grand Steward know me? When young I was of low station, so I became skilled in many humble things. Does a gentleman need many skills? Not many. Lao said: The Master said, 'I was not given office, so I learned the arts.'

This chapter connects to

See also 1.10: Ziqin asked Zigong: Whenever the Master arrives in a state he always hears about its…

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 13 of 38 (previous 7.14, next 9.12)

People The Grand Steward: appears only here

People Lao (Qin Lao): appears only here

Variant The base text has “大宰”; the standard text has “太宰”

— Analects 9.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.7

Day 149 of the calendar · every May 29

子曰：吾有知乎哉？无知也。有鄙夫问于我，空空如也，我叩其两端而竭焉。

The Master said: Do I have knowledge? I do not. If a common man asks me something, and I am completely empty, I lay out both ends of the matter and exhaust it.

This chapter connects to

People A common fellow: appears only here

Other books Daodejing, ch. 10: "Clear and reaching in all four directions, can you be without knowledge?": Confucius also called himself "without knowledge". When someone asked him something, he questioned both ends until it was clear. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 71: Confucius called himself ignorant, which fits neatly with Laozi's “knowing that you do not know.” Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 9.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.8

Day 150 of the calendar · every May 30

子曰：凤鸟不至，河不出图，吾已矣夫！

The Master said: The phoenix does not come, the River gives forth no chart. It is all over with me!

— Analects 9.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.9

Day 150 of the calendar · every May 30

子见齐衰者、冕衣裳者与瞽者，见之，虽少必作；过之，必趋。

When the Master saw someone in mourning dress, someone in ceremonial cap and robes, or a blind man, he would rise on seeing them, even if they were young; passing them, he would quicken his step.

— Analects 9.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.10

Day 151 of the calendar · every May 31

颜渊喟然叹曰：仰之弥高，钻之弥坚；瞻之在前，忽焉在后。夫子循循然善诱人，博我以文，约我以礼。欲罢不能，既竭吾才，如有所立卓尔。虽欲从之，末由也已。

Yan Yuan sighed deeply and said: The more I look up to it, the higher it is; the more I bore into it, the harder it is. I see it before me, and suddenly it is behind. The Master leads people on step by step; he broadens me with culture and restrains me with ritual. I want to stop but cannot. When I have used up all my ability, it seems to stand there, towering. Though I want to follow it, there is no way.

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 8 of 21 (previous 7.10, next 9.19)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 32: On the "standing tall" in "still toiled to stand tall": Yan Yuan said Confucius's learning stood high before him, and however hard he chased it, he could not catch up. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 9.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.11

Day 152 of the calendar · every June 1

子疾病，子路使门人为臣。病间，曰：久矣哉！由之行诈也，无臣而为有臣。吾谁欺？欺天乎？且予与其死于臣之手也，无宁死于二三子之手乎？且予纵不得大葬，予死于道路乎？

The Master was gravely ill, and Zilu had disciples act as his retainers. When the illness eased, the Master said: How long Zilu has been practicing this deceit! I have no retainers, yet he acts as if I do. Whom am I deceiving? Am I deceiving Heaven? Besides, rather than die in the hands of retainers, would I not rather die in your hands, my friends? And even if I am not given a grand burial, would I die by the roadside?

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 11 of 41 (previous 7.34, next 9.26)

Occasion Visiting the Sick: When Confucius was gravely ill, he said: rather than die in the hands of retainers, I would die among you, my students. The people at the bedside matter more than the show.

— Analects 9.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.12

Day 153 of the calendar · every June 2

子贡曰：有美玉于斯，韫匮而藏诸？求善贾而沽诸？子曰：沽之哉！沽之哉！我待贾者也。

Zigong said: Here is a beautiful jade. Should one store it away in a case, or seek a good price and sell it? The Master said: Sell it! Sell it! I am waiting for the right price.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 14 of 38 (previous 9.6, next 11.2)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 70: “Wearing coarse cloth, holding jade within”: with the same jade, Confucius would “sell it!”, while Laozi keeps it tucked inside his robe. Yikonglu's comparison

Variant The base text has “韞匵”; the standard text has “韞椟”

— Analects 9.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.13

Day 154 of the calendar · every June 3

子欲居九夷。或曰：陋，如之何！子曰：君子居之，何陋之有？

The Master wished to live among the nine Yi tribes. Someone said: They are crude; what would you do? The Master said: If a gentleman lived there, what crudeness would there be?

This chapter connects to

People Someone who asked about the Nine Yi: appears only here

— Analects 9.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.14

Day 154 of the calendar · every June 3

子曰：吾自卫反鲁，然后乐正，雅颂各得其所。

The Master said: Only after I returned from Wei to Lu was the music set right, and the Ya and Song each found their proper place.

— Analects 9.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.15

Day 155 of the calendar · every June 4

子曰：出则事公卿，入则事父兄，丧事不敢不勉，不为酒困，何有于我哉？

The Master said: Abroad, serving dukes and ministers; at home, serving father and elder brothers; in mourning, never daring not to do my utmost; never being overcome by wine — which of these is in me?

— Analects 9.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.16

Day 156 of the calendar · every June 5

子在川上，曰：逝者如斯夫！不舍昼夜。

Standing by a river, the Master said: It flows on like this, never ceasing day or night.

> **Yikonglu's note** Zhu Xi reads it as heaven and earth moving without a moment's pause, urging people never to stop learning; most modern readers take it as a sigh over time flowing away like water. Both readings work, and Yikonglu keeps both: one teaches us to treasure time, the other not to rest.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 8: Looking at the same water, Confucius saw time that never stops. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 21: Chunfu's commentary, recorded by Jiao Hong, cites Su Shi's "what passes is like this, yet it never goes", using Confucius's sigh by the river to explain "from ancient times till now, its name has not departed". a commentator's reading

Occasion New Year: Watching the river on New Year's Day. Zhu Xi read it as the world's ceaseless motion, urging people to keep learning without stopping; most readers today take it as time flowing away like water. Both readings suit the New Year: one is about cherishing time, the other about never resting.

— Analects 9.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.17

Day 157 of the calendar · every June 6

子曰：吾未见好德如好色者也。

The Master said: I have never seen anyone who loves virtue as much as he loves beauty.

This chapter connects to

See also 15.12: The Master said: It is hopeless! I have never seen anyone who loves virtue as much as he…

— Analects 9.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.18

Day 157 of the calendar · every June 6

子曰：譬如为山，未成一篑，止，吾止也；譬如平地，虽覆一篑，进，吾往也。

The Master said: It is like building a mound: if I stop when it lacks only one basket of earth, it is I who stop. It is like leveling the ground: even if I have tipped out only one basket, if I go on, it is I who go forward.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 64: “A nine-story tower rises from a heap of earth”: Confucius said that if you stop a mound one basketful short, it is you who stopped. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion New Year: Write your New Year's resolutions under this line: a mountain one basket of earth short, and if you stop, you stopped; on level ground with only one basket tipped out, and if you go on, you went on. Success or failure is up to you.

— Analects 9.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.19

Day 158 of the calendar · every June 7

子曰：语之而不惰者，其回也与！

The Master said: One who never grew lax when I spoke to him — that was Hui!

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 9 of 21 (previous 9.10, next 9.20)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 41: Su Zhe explains "When the highest scholar hears the Way, he practices it diligently," saying Yan Hui was such a scholar.

a commentator's reading

— Analects 9.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.20

Day 158 of the calendar · every June 7

子谓颜渊，曰：惜乎！吾见其进也，未见其止也。

Speaking of Yan Yuan, the Master said: What a pity! I saw him go forward; I never saw him stop.

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 10 of 21 (previous 9.19, next 11.2)

— Analects 9.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.21

Day 158 of the calendar · every June 7

子曰：苗而不秀者有矣夫！秀而不实者有矣夫！

The Master said: There are sprouts that never flower! There are flowers that never bear fruit!

— Analects 9.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.22

Day 159 of the calendar · every June 8

子曰：后生可畏，焉知来者之不如今也？四十、五十而无闻焉，斯亦不足畏也已。

The Master said: The young are to be held in awe. How do we know those to come will not equal those of today? But one who at forty or fifty has made no name — he is not worth holding in awe.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 2: "What will he do when old?": if you don't study when young and still haven't progressed by forty or fifty, you are not worth fearing. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 34: Child prodigies "were called remarkable." Confucius said the young deserve our awe, but also warned that anyone still unknown at forty or fifty is not worth fearing. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Graduation: Best from a teacher to graduates: how do we know your future won't measure up to our present?

Careful The second half is “If at forty or fifty one has still made no name, then one is not worth fearing.” It urges hard work while young; it doesn't just praise the young.

Occasion A New Baby: A blessing for a newborn: who's to say this child won't one day surpass us as we are now?

— Analects 9.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.23

Day 160 of the calendar · every June 9

子曰：法语之言，能无从乎？改之为贵。巽与之言，能无说乎？绎之为贵。说而不绎，从而不改，吾末如之何也已矣。

The Master said: Words of correction — can one fail to accept them? What matters is to change. Words of gentle advice — can one fail to be pleased? What matters is to think them through. Pleased but not thinking it through, accepting but not changing — with such a person I can do nothing.

This chapter connects to

See also 15.15: The Master said: With one who never asks, 'What should I do? What should I do?', I can do…

— Analects 9.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.24

Day 161 of the calendar · every June 10

子曰：主忠信，毋友不如己者，过则勿惮改。

The Master said: Hold loyalty and good faith as primary. Do not befriend those not your equal. When you err, do not fear to correct it.

This chapter connects to

See also 1.8: The Master said: If a gentleman lacks weight he will have no dignity, and what he learns…

— Analects 9.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.25

Day 162 of the calendar · every June 11

子曰：三军可夺帅也，匹夫不可夺志也。

The Master said: The three armies can be robbed of their commander; a common man cannot be robbed of his will.

This chapter connects to

Occasion Coming of Age: Pifu 匹夫 means an ordinary person, man or woman alike. The commander of a great army can be seized, but no one can take away an ordinary person's resolve.

— Analects 9.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.26

Day 163 of the calendar · every June 12

子曰：衣敝缊袍，与衣狐貉者立，而不耻者，其由也与？不忮不求，何用不臧？子路终身诵之。子曰：是道也，何足以臧？

The Master said: Wearing a tattered padded robe and standing beside men in fox and badger furs without shame — that would be You, would it not? 'Not envious, not grasping — how could he not be good?' Zilu kept reciting these lines all his life. The Master said: That way alone — how is it enough to be good?

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 12 of 41 (previous 9.11, next 10.17)

Other books Book of Songs, Airs of Bei, "Xiong Zhi": "Not envious, not grasping, how could he be anything but good?" source

— Analects 9.26 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.26 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.27

Day 164 of the calendar · every June 13

子曰：岁寒，然后知松柏之后彫也。

The Master said: Only when the year turns cold do we know that the pine and cypress are the last to wither.

This chapter connects to

Occasion Naming: Use song 松 (pine) or bai 柏 (cypress) in a name; a study or shop could be called Houdiao 后凋 or Suihan 岁寒. 彫 is written 凋 today. The meaning: only when it turns cold do you see which trees don't wither. The name is about holding up under hardship.

Variant The base text has “后彫”; the standard text has “后凋”

— Analects 9.27 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.27 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.28

Day 165 of the calendar · every June 14

子曰：知者不惑，仁者不忧，勇者不惧。

The Master said: The wise are not perplexed; the humane are not anxious; the brave are not afraid.

— Analects 9.28 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.28 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.29

Day 165 of the calendar · every June 14

子曰：可与共学，未可与适道；可与适道，未可与立；可与立，未可与权。

The Master said: Some you can study with, but not go with toward the Way; some you can go with toward the Way, but not stand with; some you can stand with, but not weigh things with.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 36: Emperor Xuanzong of Tang defended "What is to be shrunk must first be stretched" by citing Confucius's "one may stand with him,

but not yet weigh circumstances with him": this is adapting to circumstances, not trickery. a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 40: "Reversal is the movement of the Way": Confucius also knew that besides holding to the constant, one must adapt to change. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 9.29 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.29 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 9.30

Day 166 of the calendar · every June 15

唐棣之华，偏其反而。岂不尔思？室是远而。子曰：未之思也，夫何远之有？

'The blossoms of the cherry tree flutter and turn. How could I not think of you? But your home is far away.' The Master said: He did not really think of her. What distance would there be?

— Analects 9.30 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/9.30 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 10 · Xiang dang

Analects 10.1

Day 167 of the calendar · every June 16

孔子于乡党，恂恂如也，似不能言者。其在宗庙朝廷，便便言，唯谨尔。

In his home village, Confucius was simple and sincere, as if unable to speak. In the ancestral temple and at court, he spoke fluently, but always with care.

— Analects 10.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.2

Day 168 of the calendar · every June 17

朝，与下大夫言，侃侃如也；与上大夫言，阇阇如也。君在，踧踖如也。与与如也。

At court, speaking with lower officers, he was direct and at ease; speaking with higher officers, he was respectful and exact. When the ruler was present, he was reverent yet composed.

— Analects 10.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.3

Day 169 of the calendar · every June 18

君召使摈，色勃如也，足躩如也。揖所与立，左右手。衣前后，襜如也。趋进，翼如也。宾退，必复命曰：宾不顾矣。

When the ruler summoned him to receive guests, his face would change and his steps would quicken. Bowing to those standing beside him, he moved his hands left and right, his robe swaying evenly front and back. Hurrying forward, he moved like a bird with spread wings. When the guest had left, he would report: The guest is no longer looking back.

This chapter connects to

See also 10.4: Entering the palace gate, he bowed as if there were no room for him. He did not stand in…

— Analects 10.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.4

Day 170 of the calendar · every June 19

入公门，鞠躬如也，如不容。立不中门，行不履阈。过位，色勃如也，足躩如也，其言似不足者。摄齐升堂，鞠躬如也，屏气似不息者。出，降一等，逞颜色，怡怡如也。没阶趋，翼如也。复其位，踧踖如也。

Entering the palace gate, he bowed as if there were no room for him. He did not stand in the middle of the gateway nor step on the threshold. Passing the ruler's seat, his face changed and his steps quickened, and he spoke as if short of words. Lifting his robe to ascend the hall, he bowed and held his breath as if not breathing. Coming out and descending one step, he relaxed his face and looked at ease. At the bottom of the steps he hurried forward like a bird with spread wings. Returning to his place, he was reverent and composed.

This chapter connects to

See also 10.3: When the ruler summoned him to receive guests, his face would change and his steps would…

See also 10.5: Holding the jade tablet, he bowed as if it were too heavy to bear. He raised it as if…

Variant The base text has “没阶趋翼如也”; the standard text has “没阶趋进翼如也”

— Analects 10.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.5

Day 171 of the calendar · every June 20

执圭，鞠躬如也，如不胜。上如揖，下如授。勃如战色，足蹜蹜，如有循。享礼，有容色。私觌，愉愉如也。

Holding the jade tablet, he bowed as if it were too heavy to bear. He raised it as if bowing and lowered it as if handing something over. His face was grave as if in fear, and his steps were short as if following a line. At the presentation of gifts, his face was composed; at a private meeting, he was cheerful.

This chapter connects to

See also 10.4: Entering the palace gate, he bowed as if there were no room for him. He did not stand in…

— Analects 10.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.6

Day 172 of the calendar · every June 21

君子不以绀緅饰。红紫不以为亵服。当暑，袗绨绤，必表而出之。缁衣羔裘，素衣麑裘，黄衣狐裘。亵裘长。短右袂。必有寝衣，长一身有半。狐貉之厚以居。去丧，无所不佩。非帷裳，必杀之。羔裘玄冠不以吊。吉月，必朝服而朝。

The gentleman did not use dark purple or puce for trimmings, nor red or purple for everyday clothes. In hot weather he wore unlined fine or coarse linen, always over an inner garment. With a black robe, lambskin; with a white robe, fawnskin; with a yellow robe, fox fur. His everyday fur coat was long, with the right sleeve short. He always had a sleeping garment one and a half times his body length. Thick fox and badger furs were for sitting at home. Out of mourning, he wore all his pendants. Except for the ceremonial skirt, his skirts were cut narrower. He did not wear lambskin and a black cap to offer condolences. On the first day of the month, he always went to court in court dress.

— Analects 10.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.7

Day 173 of the calendar · every June 22

齐，必有明衣，布。齐，必变食，居必迁坐。

When fasting, he always had a clean garment of plain cloth. When fasting, he always changed his diet and moved to a different place to sit.

— Analects 10.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.8

Day 174 of the calendar · every June 23

食不厌精，脍不厌细。食饐而餲，鱼馁而肉败，不食。色恶，不食。臭恶，不食。失饪，不食。不时，不食。割不正，不食。不得其酱，不食。肉虽多，不使胜食气。惟酒无量，不及乱。沽酒市脯不食。不撤姜食。不多食。祭于公，不宿肉。祭肉不出三日。出三日，不食之矣。食不语，寝不言。虽疏食菜羹，瓜祭，必齐如也。

He did not tire of finely polished rice or of finely sliced meat. Rice that had spoiled and turned sour, fish gone bad, or meat that had rotted, he did not eat. Food of bad color he did not eat; food of bad smell he did not eat. Food badly cooked he did not eat; food out of season he did not eat. Meat not cut properly he did not eat; without the right sauce he did not eat. Even when there was much meat, he did not let it overpower the rice. Only in wine he set no limit, but never to the point of disorder. Wine and dried meat bought at the market he did not eat. He did not do without ginger, but did not eat much. After a sacrifice at the duke's, he did not keep the meat overnight. Sacrificial meat he did not keep beyond three days; beyond three days, he would not eat it. He did not converse while eating, nor talk in bed. Even with coarse rice and vegetable soup, he offered some in sacrifice, always with reverence.

This chapter connects to

Variant The base text has “惟酒无量”; the standard text has “唯酒无量”

— Analects 10.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.9

Day 175 of the calendar · every June 24

席不正，不坐。

If the mat was not straight, he did not sit.

— Analects 10.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.10

Day 175 of the calendar · every June 24

乡人饮酒，杖者出，斯出矣。乡人傩，朝服而立于阼阶。

When villagers drank together, he left only after those with walking staffs had left. When villagers held the exorcism, he stood on the eastern steps in court dress.

This chapter connects to

Occasion Birthday Wishes for Elders: Etiquette at a birthday banquet: when drinking with fellow villagers, Confucius left only after the elders with walking sticks had gone. Young people shouldn't leave the table first.

— Analects 10.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.11

Day 176 of the calendar · every June 25

问人于他邦，再拜而送之。康子馈药，拜而受之。曰：丘未达，不敢尝。

When sending a messenger to inquire after someone in another state, he bowed twice as he sent him off. When Ji Kangzi sent him medicine, he bowed and accepted it, saying: I do not know this medicine, so I dare not taste it.

This chapter connects to

People Ji Kangzi: appearance 3 of 8 (previous 6.6, next 11.6)

— Analects 10.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.12

Day 176 of the calendar · every June 25

厩焚。子退朝，曰：伤人乎？不问马。

The stables burned down. Returning from court, the Master said: Was anyone hurt? He did not ask about the horses.

> **Yikonglu's note** When the stables burned, Confucius asked only whether anyone was hurt, not about the horses. The "Xiang Dang" book records what mattered more and what came first; there is no need to repunctuate the line so that Confucius also asks about the horses.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 8: However important the six domestic animals are, they do not count as much as people: when the stables burned, Confucius asked only whether anyone was hurt. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 10.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.13

Day 177 of the calendar · every June 26

君赐食，必正席先尝之；君赐腥，必熟而荐之；君赐生，必畜之。侍食于君，君祭，先饭。疾，君视之，东首，加朝服，拖绅。君命召，不俟驾行矣。入太庙，每事问。

When the ruler gave him cooked food, he would straighten his mat and taste it first. When the ruler gave him raw meat, he would cook it and offer it to his ancestors. When the ruler gave him a live animal, he would raise it. When dining in attendance on the ruler, while the ruler made the offering, he would taste the food first. When he was ill and the ruler came to see him, he lay with his head to the east, with his court robe laid over him and his sash drawn across. When summoned by the ruler's command, he set off without waiting for his carriage to be yoked. Entering the Grand Temple, he asked about everything.

This chapter connects to

Occasion Visiting the Sick: When Confucius was ill, the ruler came to see him. He could not get up, so he received his guest with his court robes laid over him. The sick should keep their dignity, and visitors should help them keep it.

— Analects 10.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.14

Day 178 of the calendar · every June 27

朋友死，无所归。曰：于我殡。朋友之馈，虽车马，非祭肉，不拜。

When a friend died with no one to take charge, he said: Let the funeral be held at my house. For gifts from friends, even a carriage and horses, he did not bow unless it was sacrificial meat.

This chapter connects to

People A friend of Confucius: appears only here

Occasion Mourning: When a friend died with no family to see to things, Confucius said: I will take care of the funeral. The weightiest words between friends.

— Analects 10.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.15

Day 179 of the calendar · every June 28

寢不尸，居不容。见齐衰者，虽狎，必变。见冕者与瞽者，虽亵，必以貌。凶服者式之。式负版者。有盛馔，必变色而作。迅雷风烈，必变。

He did not sleep stretched out like a corpse, nor sit at home with formal bearing. When he saw someone in mourning dress, even an intimate, his expression changed. When he saw someone in ceremonial cap or a blind man, even someone he saw often, he showed proper bearing. To one in mourning clothes he bowed from his carriage; he bowed to those carrying the registers of the state. When a fine feast was served, his expression changed and he rose. At sudden thunder or violent wind, his expression changed.

This chapter connects to

Variant The base text has “居不容”; the standard text has “居不客”

— Analects 10.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.16

Day 180 of the calendar · every June 29

升车，必正立执绥。车中，不内顾，不疾言，不亲指。

Mounting his carriage, he always stood upright and held the strap. In the carriage, he did not look around, did not speak hurriedly, and did not point.

— Analects 10.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 10.17

Day 180 of the calendar · every June 29

色斯举矣，翔而后集。曰：山梁雌雉，时哉！时哉！子路共之，三嗅而作。

Seeing the look on their faces, the birds rose, circled, and then settled together. He said: The hen pheasants on the mountain bridge — how timely! How timely! Zilu bowed to them; they sniffed three times and flew off.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 13 of 41 (previous 9.26, next 11.2)

— Analects 10.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/10.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 11 · Xian jin

Analects 11.1

Day 181 of the calendar · every June 30

子曰：先进于礼乐，野人也；后进于礼乐，君子也。如用之，则吾从先进。

The Master said: Those who first advanced in ritual and music were country folk; those who later advanced in ritual and music were gentlemen. If I were to use them, I would follow those who came first.

— Analects 11.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.2

Day 182 of the calendar · every July 1

子曰：从我于陈、蔡者，皆不及门也。德行：颜渊，闵子骞，冉伯牛，仲弓。言语：宰我，子贡。政事：冉有，季路。文学：子游，子夏。

The Master said: Those who followed me in Chen and Cai are no longer at my gate. In virtuous conduct: Yan Yuan, Min Ziqian, Ran Boniu, Zhonggong. In speech: Zai Wo, Zigong. In government: Ran You, Jilu. In culture and learning: Ziyou, Zixia.

This chapter connects to

- **People** Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 5 of 20 (previous 6.11, next 11.15)
- **People** Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 15 of 38 (previous 9.12, next 11.12)
- **People** Ziyou (Yan Yan): appearance 4 of 8 (previous 6.12, next 17.4)
- **People** Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 11 of 21 (previous 9.20, next 11.3)
- **People** Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 14 of 41 (previous 10.17, next 11.11)
- **People** Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 7 of 16 (previous 7.14, next 11.12)
- **People** Zai Wo (Zai Yu): appearance 4 of 5 (previous 6.24, next 17.21)

People Zhonggong (Ran Yong): appearance 4 of 6 (previous 6.4, next 12.2)

People Min Ziqian (Min Sun): appearance 2 of 5 (previous 6.7, next 11.4)

People Boniu (Ran Geng): appearance 2 of 2 (previous 6.8)

— Analects 11.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.3

Day 183 of the calendar · every July 2

子曰：回也非助我者也，于吾言无所不说。

The Master said: Hui is no help to me; there is nothing I say that he is not pleased with.

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 12 of 21 (previous 11.2, next 11.6)

— Analects 11.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.4

Day 183 of the calendar · every July 2

子曰：孝哉闵子骞！人不间于其父母昆弟之言。

The Master said: How filial Min Ziqian is! No one can find fault with what his parents and brothers say of him.

This chapter connects to

People Min Ziqian (Min Sun): appearance 3 of 5 (previous 11.2, next 11.12)

People Min Ziqian's father: appears only here

People Min Ziqian's mother: appears only here

— Analects 11.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.5

Day 184 of the calendar · every July 3

南容三复白圭，孔子以其兄之子妻之。

Nan Rong repeated the lines on the white jade tablet three times a day, and Confucius gave him his elder brother's daughter as wife.

This chapter connects to

See also 5.1: The Master said of Gongye Chang: He is fit to be given a wife. Though he was in bonds, it…

People Nan Rong (Nangong Kuo): appearance 2 of 3 (previous 5.1, next 14.6)

People Confucius's niece: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 5.1)

People Confucius's elder brother: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 5.1)

Occasion Weddings: Nan Rong kept reciting the poem's line that "a wrong word can't be taken back," so Confucius gave him his niece in marriage. A line for the bride and groom: in married life, be careful what you say.

— Analects 11.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.6

Day 184 of the calendar · every July 3

季康子问：弟子孰为好学？孔子对曰：有颜回者好学，不幸短命死矣！今也则亡。

Ji Kangzi asked which of the disciples loved learning. Confucius replied: There was Yan Hui who loved learning. Unfortunately, his life was short and he died. Now there is no one.

This chapter connects to

See also 6.2: Duke Ai asked: Which of your disciples loves learning? Confucius replied: There was Yan…

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 13 of 21 (previous 11.3, next 11.7)

People Ji Kangzi: appearance 4 of 8 (previous 10.11, next 12.17)

— Analects 11.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.7

Day 185 of the calendar · every July 4

颜渊死，颜路请子之车以为之椁。子曰：才不才，亦各言其子也。鲤也死，有棺而无椁。吾不徒行以为之椁。以吾从大夫之后，不可徒行也。

When Yan Yuan died, Yan Lu asked for the Master's carriage to make an outer coffin for him. The Master said: Talented or not, each speaks of his own son. When Li died, he had an inner coffin but no outer coffin. I did not go on foot to make an outer coffin for him. Since I follow behind the ministers, I cannot go on foot.

This chapter connects to

See also 14.22: Chen Chengzi murdered Duke Jian. Confucius bathed and went to court, and reported to Duke…

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 14 of 21 (previous 11.6, next 11.8)

People Yan Lu: appears only here

People Kong Li (Boyu): appearance 1 of 3 (next 16.13)

— Analects 11.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.8

Day 186 of the calendar · every July 5

颜渊死。子曰：噫！天丧予！天丧予！

When Yan Yuan died, the Master said: Alas! Heaven has destroyed me! Heaven has destroyed me!

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 15 of 21 (previous 11.7, next 11.9)

Occasion Mourning: Confucius's first words on hearing of Yan Yuan's death: Heaven is destroying me. For the loss of a student or a kindred spirit.

Careful Zhu Xi says Confucius was grieving that no one was left to pass on the Way, not saying he himself would die.

— Analects 11.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.9

Day 186 of the calendar · every July 5

颜渊死，子哭之恸。从者曰：子恸矣。曰：有恸乎？非夫人之为恸而谁为！

When Yan Yuan died, the Master wept for him with abandon. His followers said: Master, you weep with abandon. He said: Do I? If not for this man, for whom should I weep so?

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 16 of 21 (previous 11.8, next 11.10)

People A follower: appears only here

Occasion Mourning: When Yan Yuan died, Confucius wept so hard that those with him tried to calm him. Confucius said: if not for this man, for whom should I grieve? Suitable for mourning a close friend.

— Analects 11.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.10

Day 187 of the calendar · every July 6

颜渊死，门人欲厚葬之，子曰：不可。门人厚葬之。子曰：回也视予犹父也，予不得视犹子也。非我也，夫二三子也。

When Yan Yuan died, the disciples wanted to give him a lavish burial. The Master said: No. The disciples gave him a lavish burial. The Master said: Hui looked on me as a father, yet I could not treat him as a son. It was not I; it was you, my friends.

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 17 of 21 (previous 11.9, next 11.18)

— Analects 11.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.11

Day 188 of the calendar · every July 7

季路问事鬼神。子曰：未能事人，焉能事鬼？敢问死。曰：未知生，焉知死？

Jilu asked about serving the spirits. The Master said: You cannot yet serve people; how can you serve spirits? He ventured to ask about death. The Master said: You do not yet understand life; how can you understand death?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a young person asks an old doctor of Chinese medicine how to live a long life. The old doctor says: first eat today's three meals properly and get enough sleep.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 15 of 41 (previous 11.2, next 11.12)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 50: This chapter of Laozi is all about life and death. Confucius says that if you do not yet understand life, how can you understand death? Yikonglu's comparison

Variant The base text has “敢问死”; the standard text has “曰敢问死”

— Analects 11.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.12

Day 189 of the calendar · every July 8

闵子侍侧，闾闾如也；子路，行行如也；冉有、子贡，侃侃如也。子乐。若由也，不得其死然。

Min Ziqian stood beside the Master, respectful and exact; Zilu, bold and firm; Ran You and Zigong, direct and at ease. The Master was pleased. 'As for You, I fear he will not die a natural death.'

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an old master craftsman leading a group of newcomers is glad to see each apprentice turning out in his own way. Then he turns

to the one who pushes hardest: slow down a little, don't work yourself into the ground. ---

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 16 of 38 (previous 11.2, next 11.15)

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 16 of 41 (previous 11.11, next 11.14)

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 8 of 16 (previous 11.2, next 11.16)

People Min Ziqian (Min Sun): appearance 4 of 5 (previous 11.4, next 11.13)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 42: "The violent and strong do not die a natural death": Confucius had the same worry about the hard, forceful Zilu. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 73: “Brave in daring, one is killed”: this is just what Confucius feared for Zilu. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 11.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.13

Day 190 of the calendar · every July 9

魯人为长府。闵子骞曰：仍旧贯，如之何？何必改作？子曰：夫人不言，言必有中。

The people of Lu were rebuilding the Long Treasury. Min Ziqian said: Why not keep it as it was? Why must it be rebuilt? The Master said: That man seldom speaks, but when he speaks, he hits the mark.

Yikonglu's note Today: a meeting argues for an hour over whether to renovate the whole office building. An old employee who rarely speaks up says: fix the part of the roof that leaks, and that's enough.

This chapter connects to

People Min Ziqian (Min Sun): appearance 5 of 5 (previous 11.12)

— Analects 11.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.14

Day 191 of the calendar · every July 10

子曰：由之瑟奚为于丘之门？门人不敬子路。子曰：由也升堂矣，未入于室也。

The Master said: What is You's zither doing at my gate? The disciples stopped respecting Zilu. The Master said: You has ascended to the hall, though he has not yet entered the inner room.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the coach tells a veteran in front of the whole team, "Your touch is too stiff," and the newcomers stop taking him seriously. So the coach has to add: he's been a starter for years; he's only missing that last bit of finesse.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 17 of 41 (previous 11.12, next 11.17)

— Analects 11.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.15

Day 192 of the calendar · every July 11

子贡问：师与商也孰贤？子曰：师也过，商也不及。曰：然则师愈与？子曰：过犹不及。

Zigong asked: Who is the worthier, Shi or Shang? The Master said: Shi goes too far; Shang does not go far enough. Then is Shi better? The Master said: Going too far is the same as not going far enough.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: two new cooks: one uses too much salt, the other too little. The diners taste both dishes and say neither is good.

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 6 of 20 (previous 11.2, next 12.5)

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 17 of 38 (previous 11.12, next 11.18)

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 4 of 20 (previous 5.18, next 11.17)

— Analects 11.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.16

Day 193 of the calendar · every July 12

季氏富于周公，而求也为之聚敛而附益之。子曰：非吾徒也。小子鸣鼓而攻之，可也。

The Ji family was richer than the Duke of Zhou, yet Qiu collected taxes for them and added to their wealth. The Master said: He is no disciple of mine. You may beat the drum and attack him, my young friends.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an accountant cooks the books to help his boss dodge taxes, and an old classmate finds out. The classmate doesn't beat around the bush; he tells him to his face: keep doing this and you're no classmate of mine. But if you're willing to make it right, I'll go with you to pay it back. ---

This chapter connects to

People the Ji family: appearance 4 of 7 (previous 6.7, next 13.2)

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 9 of 16 (previous 11.12, next 11.21)

People the Duke of Zhou: appearance 3 of 4 (previous 8.11, next 18.10)

— Analects 11.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.17

Day 194 of the calendar · every July 13

柴也愚，参也鲁，师也辟，由也喭。

Chai is simple, Shen is slow, Shi is showy, You is coarse.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: before graduation, the old homeroom teacher writes one line for each student. Not praise, but the one thing each of them most needs to fix. ---

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 9 of 15 (previous 8.7, next 12.24)

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 18 of 41 (previous 11.14, next 11.21)

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 5 of 20 (previous 11.15, next 11.19)

People Zigao (Gao Chai): appearance 1 of 2 (next 11.24)

— Analects 11.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.18

Day 194 of the calendar · every July 13

子曰：回也其庶乎，屡空。赐不受命，而货殖焉，亿则屡中。

The Master said: Hui comes close, yet he is often in want. Ci does not accept his lot and goes into trade; his guesses often hit the mark.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: two old classmates: one sticks with poorly paid research; the other went into business and reads the market right every time. At the reunion everyone praises the businessman; the teacher only asks the researcher: can you still lose yourself in your reading these days? ---

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 18 of 38 (previous 11.15, next 12.7)

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 18 of 21 (previous 11.10, next 11.22)

— Analects 11.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.19

Day 195 of the calendar · every July 14

子张问善人之道。子曰：不践迹，亦不入于室。

Zizhang asked about the way of the good man. The Master said: He does not follow in others' footsteps, yet he does not enter the inner room.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a very handy person works out on his own how to fix a neighbor's old clock. But ask him to move on to finer watches, and he stalls there: he never trained under a master.

This chapter connects to

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 6 of 20 (previous 11.17, next 12.6)

— Analects 11.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 11.20

Day 195 of the calendar · every July 14

子曰：论笃是与，君子者乎？色庄者乎？

The Master said: Approving of someone because his talk is earnest — is he a true gentleman, or only grave in appearance?

— Analects 11.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.21

Day 196 of the calendar · every July 15

子路问：闻斯行诸？子曰：有父兄在，如之何其闻斯行之？冉有问：闻斯行诸？子曰：闻斯行之。公西华曰：由也问闻斯行诸，子曰有父兄在；求也问闻斯行诸，子曰闻斯行之。赤也惑，敢问。子曰：求也退，故进之；由也兼人，故退之。

Zilu asked: Should I act at once on what I hear? The Master said: While your father and elder brothers are alive, how can you act at once on what you hear? Ran You asked: Should I act at once on what I hear? The Master said: Act at once on what you hear. Gongxi Hua said: When You asked, you said 'your father and elder brothers are alive'; when Qiu asked, you said 'act at once.' I am confused and venture to ask. The Master said: Qiu holds back, so I urged him on; You has the drive of two men, so I held him back.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 19 of 41 (previous 11.17, next 11.23)

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 10 of 16 (previous 11.16, next 11.23)

People Gongxi Hua (Gongxi Chi): appearance 4 of 5 (previous 7.33, next 11.25)

— Analects 11.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.22

Day 197 of the calendar · every July 16

子畏于匡，颜渊后。子曰：吾以女为死矣。曰：子在，回何敢死？

The Master was in peril in Kuang, and Yan Yuan fell behind. The Master said: I thought you were dead. He said: While you live, Master, how would I dare die?

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 19 of 21 (previous 11.18, next 12.1)

— Analects 11.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.23

Day 198 of the calendar · every July 17

季子然问：仲由、冉求可谓大臣与？子曰：吾以子为异之问，曾由与求之问。所谓大臣者：以道事君，不可则止。今由与求也，可谓具臣矣。曰：然则从之者与？子曰：弑父与君，亦不从也。

Ji Ziran asked: Can Zhong You and Ran Qiu be called great ministers? The Master said: I thought you would ask about someone remarkable, but you ask about You and Qiu. What is called a great minister serves his ruler by the Way, and when he cannot, he resigns. Now You and Qiu may be called ministers to fill a post. Then would they just go along? The Master said: In killing a father or a ruler, they would not go along.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 20 of 41 (previous 11.21, next 11.24)

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 11 of 16 (previous 11.21, next 11.25)

People Ji Ziran: appears only here

— Analects 11.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.24

Day 199 of the calendar · every July 18

子路使子羔为费宰。子曰：贼夫人之子。子路曰：有民人焉，有社稷焉。何必读书，然后为学？子曰：是故恶夫佞者。

Zilu had Zigao made steward of Bi. The Master said: You are harming another man's son. Zilu said: There are people there, and altars to the land and grain. Why must one read books before one counts as learned? The Master said: This is why I dislike glib talkers.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 21 of 41 (previous 11.23, next 11.25)

People Zigao (Gao Chai): appearance 2 of 2 (previous 11.17)

— Analects 11.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 11.25

子路、曾皙、冉有、公西华侍坐。子曰：以吾一日长乎尔，毋吾以也。居则曰：不吾知也！如或知尔，则何以哉？子路率尔而对曰：千乘之国，摄乎大国之间，加之以师旅，因之以饥馑；由也为之，比及三年，可使有勇，且知方也。夫子哂之。求！尔何如？对曰：方六七十，如五六十，求也为之，比及三年，可使足民。如其礼乐，以俟君子。赤！尔何如？对曰：非曰能之，愿学焉。宗庙之事，如会同，端章甫，愿为小相焉。点！尔何如？鼓瑟希，铿尔，舍瑟而作。对曰：异乎三子者之撰。子曰：何伤乎？亦各言其志也。曰：莫春者，春服既成。冠者五六人，童子六七人，浴乎沂，风乎舞雩，咏而归。夫子喟然叹曰：吾与点也！三子者出，曾皙后。曾皙曰：夫三子者之言何如？子曰：亦各言其志也已矣。曰：夫子何哂由也？曰：为国以礼，其言不让，是故哂之。唯求则非邦也与？安见方六七十如五六十而非邦也者？唯赤则非邦也与？宗庙会同，非诸侯而何？赤也为之小，孰能为之大？

Zilu, Zeng Xi, Ran You, and Gongxi Hua sat in attendance. The Master said: Because I am a little older than you, do not hold back on my account. You often say, 'No one knows me.' If someone did know you, what would you do? Zilu answered at once: A state of a thousand chariots, hemmed in between great states, beset by armies and then by famine — if I governed it, in three years I could give the people courage and a sense of direction. The Master smiled at him. Qiu, what about you? He answered: A territory of sixty or seventy li, or fifty or sixty — if I governed it, in three years I could make the people have enough. As for ritual and music, I would wait for a gentleman. Chi, what about you? He answered: I do not say I could do it, but I would like to learn. At the ancestral temple, or at assemblies of the lords, in robe and cap, I would like to be a junior assistant. Dian, what about you?

His zither-playing slowed, it rang out, and he set it aside and rose. He answered: Mine is different from what these three have chosen. The Master said: What harm is there? Each is just speaking of his aims. He said: In late spring, when the spring clothes are made, with five or six young men and six or seven boys, to bathe in the Yi, enjoy the breeze at the rain altar, and come home singing. The Master sighed deeply and said: I am with Dian! When the three went out, Zeng Xi stayed behind and said: What did you think of what those three said? The Master said: Each was just speaking of his aims. Why did you smile at You? To govern a state takes ritual, and his words were not modest; that is why I smiled. And was Qiu not speaking of a state? How is a territory of sixty or seventy li not a state? And was Chi not speaking of a state? The ancestral temple and assemblies — what are they if not the business of the lords? If Chi would be a junior, who could be a senior?

> **Yikonglu's note** One reading sees the mood of late spring: bathing by the river, enjoying the breeze, going home singing. Another sees a rain-prayer sacrifice, with Zeng Dian also speaking of governing through ritual and music. Yikonglu keeps both readings.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 22 of 41 (previous 11.24, next 12.12)

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 12 of 16 (previous 11.23, next 13.9)

People Gongxi Hua (Gongxi Chi): appearance 5 of 5 (previous 11.21)

People Zeng Xi (Zeng Dian): appears only here

— Analects 11.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/11.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 12 · Yan Yuan

Analects 12.1

Day 201 of the calendar · every July 20

颜渊问仁。子曰：克己复礼为仁。一日克己复礼，天下归仁焉。为仁由己，而由人乎哉？颜渊曰：请问其目。子曰：非礼勿视，非礼勿听，非礼勿言，非礼勿动。颜渊曰：回虽不敏，请事斯语矣。

Yan Yuan asked about humaneness. The Master said: To restrain oneself and return to ritual is humaneness. If for one day one could restrain oneself and return to ritual, the whole realm would turn to humaneness. Practicing humaneness comes from oneself — how could it come from others? Yan Yuan said: May I ask for the details? The Master said: Look at nothing contrary to ritual; listen to nothing contrary to ritual; say nothing contrary to ritual; do nothing contrary to ritual. Yan Yuan said: Though I am not quick, I will make these words my task.

> **Yikonglu's note** Keji means governing your every action so that it accords with ritual. In the next line, "humaneness comes from oneself," ji simply means oneself; taking it as "selfish desire" doesn't work. The video follows Zhu Xi, reading it as conquering selfish desire; Yikonglu takes Ma Rong's reading, "restraining oneself."

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about humaneness — Asked 8 times; see also 6.20 “The humane put the hard part first and the reward after” · 12.2 “What you do not want for yourself, do not do to others” · 12.3 “The humane are slow to speak” · 12.22 “Love people” · 13.19 “Be respectful at home, reverent in your work, loyal to others” · 15.9 “Serve the worthiest of its officials, befriend the most humane of its

scholars” (the question was how to practice humaneness) · 17.6 “Respect, tolerance, trustworthiness, diligence, kindness”

See also 12.2: Zhonggong asked about humaneness. The Master said: Going out the gate, act as if…

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 20 of 21 (previous 11.22, next 15.10)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 12: Wu Cheng cites Dong Sijing: Confucius's "four do-nots" begin with seeing, which fits Laozi's "the five colors blind the eye" and "for the belly, not the eye". a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 33: Su Zhe explains "one who overcomes himself is strong" as "able to overcome the self and return to one's nature," clearly adapting Confucius's "overcome the self and return to ritual." a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 52: "Block the openings, shut the doors": Laozi closes the doors of eyes and ears, while Confucius says not to look at or listen to what is contrary to ritual. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Coming of Age: Being an adult means keeping yourself in check. Yikonglu reads keji 克己 as restraining oneself: you govern your every action yourself rather than waiting for others to. The later phrase “humaneness comes from oneself” means just this.

— Analects 12.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.2

Day 202 of the calendar · every July 21

仲弓问仁。子曰：出门如见大宾，使民如承大祭。己所不欲，勿施于人。在邦无怨，在家无怨。仲弓曰：雍虽不敏，请事斯语矣。

Zhonggong asked about humaneness. The Master said: Going out the gate, act as if receiving an honored guest; employing the people, act as if conducting a great sacrifice. What you do not want for yourself, do not do to others. In the state, there will be no resentment; in the family, there will be no resentment. Zhonggong said: Though I am not quick, I will make these words my task.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about humaneness — Asked 8 times; see also 6.20 “The humane put the hard part first and the reward after” · 12.1 “To restrain oneself and return to ritual is humaneness” · 12.3 “The humane are slow to speak” · 12.22 “Love people” · 13.19 “Be respectful at home, reverent in your work, loyal to others” · 15.9 “Serve the worthiest of its officials, befriend the most humane of its scholars” (the question was how to practice humaneness) · 17.6 “Respect, tolerance, trustworthiness, diligence, kindness”

See also 12.1: Yan Yuan asked about humaneness. The Master said: To restrain oneself and return to…

See also 15.23: Zigong asked: Is there one word that one can practice all one's life? The Master said: Is…

People Zhonggong (Ran Yong): appearance 5 of 6 (previous 11.2, next 13.2)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 15: "Grave, like a guest": solemn as a visitor. Confucius says that when you go out, act as if meeting an honored guest.

Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 12.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.3

Day 203 of the calendar · every July 22

司马牛问仁。子曰：仁者其言也讱。曰：其言也讱，斯谓之仁已乎？子曰：为之难，言之得无讱乎？

Sima Niu asked about humaneness. The Master said: The humane are slow to speak. He said: Slow to speak — is that all it takes to be called humane? The Master said: When doing is hard, can one help being slow to speak?

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about humaneness — Asked 8 times; see also 6.20 “The humane put the hard part first and the reward after” · 12.1 “To restrain oneself and return to ritual is humaneness” · 12.2 “What you do not want for yourself, do not do to others” · 12.22 “Love people” · 13.19 “Be respectful at home, reverent in your work, loyal to others” · 15.9 “Serve the worthiest of its officials, befriend the most humane of its scholars” (the question was how to practice humaneness) · 17.6 “Respect, tolerance, trustworthiness, diligence, kindness”

People Sima Niu (Sima Geng): appearance 1 of 3 (next 12.4)

— Analects 12.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.4

Day 204 of the calendar · every July 23

司马牛问君子。子曰：君子不忧不惧。曰：不忧不惧，斯谓之君子已乎？子曰：内省不疚，夫何忧何惧？

Sima Niu asked about the gentleman. The Master said: The gentleman neither worries nor fears. He said: Neither worrying nor fearing — is that all it takes to be called a gentleman? The Master said: If one looks within and finds nothing amiss, what is there to worry about or fear?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: on the day the auditors come to check the books, the calmest person in the office is the accountant who has never touched a cent of public money. It isn't that he's bold; it's that whatever page the ledger falls open to, he has nothing to fear.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about the gentleman — Asked 3 times; see also 2.13 "First act on your words, then let them follow" · 14.45 "Cultivate yourself with reverence"

People Sima Niu (Sima Geng): appearance 2 of 3 (previous 12.3, next 12.5)

— Analects 12.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.5

Day 205 of the calendar · every July 24

司马牛忧曰：人皆有兄弟，我独亡。子夏曰：商闻之矣：死生有命，富贵在天。君子敬而无失，与人恭而有礼。四海之内，皆兄弟也。君子何患乎无兄弟也?

Sima Niu said sorrowfully: Everyone has brothers; I alone have none. Zixia said: I have heard this: life and death are a matter of fate; wealth and rank rest with Heaven. If a gentleman is reverent and makes no mistakes, respectful to others and observant of ritual, then all within the four seas are his brothers. Why should a gentleman worry about having no brothers?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an only child at college far from home has no family to go back to for the Mid-Autumn Festival, so his roommate brings him home for dinner. This is where Zixia's words land: you don't really gain a brother; it's that when you keep to ritual and treat people with respect, others are willing to treat you as one.

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 7 of 20 (previous 11.15, next 12.22)

People Sima Niu (Sima Geng): appearance 3 of 3 (previous 12.4)

Do not use Visiting the Sick: Don't say this one to a sick person.

Careful Zixia said this to comfort Sima Niu, who feared his brothers would come to harm, and it is followed directly by "the gentleman is reverent and makes no mistakes, respectful to others and observant of ritual": fate is not ours to control; what we can do is keep ourselves in order. Pulled out on its own and said to a sick person, it sounds like telling them to accept their fate.

Occasion Farewells: Ideal for seeing someone off abroad or to study overseas: treat people with respect and courtesy, and wherever you go you'll find people who are like brothers.

Careful These are Zixia's words comforting Sima Niu. Before them comes "the gentleman is reverent and makes no mistakes, respectful to others and observant of ritual"; only on that condition are all within the four seas brothers.

Analects 12.6

Day 206 of the calendar · every July 25

子张问明。子曰：浸润之谮，肤受之愬，不行焉；可谓明也已矣。浸润之谮，肤受之愬，不行焉；可谓远也已矣。

Zizhang asked about clear-sightedness. The Master said: One on whom slander that seeps in slowly and complaints that cut to the skin have no effect may be called clear-sighted. One on whom they have no effect may be called far-sighted.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: for half a year, someone in the office murmurs in your ear every few days, "Xiao Zhang seems to be late again," never once exaggerating. On promotion day, you find you came to believe it long ago. Seeing through this is what is called being clear-sighted.

This chapter connects to

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 7 of 20 (previous 11.19, next 12.10)

Analects 12.7

Day 207 of the calendar · every July 26

子贡问政。子曰：足食。足兵。民信之矣。子贡曰：必不得已而去，于斯三者何先？曰：去兵。子贡曰：必不得已而去，于斯二者何先？曰：去食。自古皆有死，民无信不立。

Zigong asked about government. The Master said: Enough food, enough arms, and the trust of the people. Zigong said: If one had no choice but to give up one of the three, which first? The Master said: Give up arms. Zigong said: If one had no choice but to give up one of the remaining two, which first? The Master said: Give up food. Since ancient times, all have died; without the people's trust, nothing stands.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a small shop has been open for twenty years. If stock runs out, you can restock; if money is tight, you can borrow. But once a customer feels you cheated him even once, the door is shut. Give up the troops first, then the food; never give up trust.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about government — Asked 10 times; see also 12.11 "Let the ruler be a ruler, the minister a minister, the father a father, the son a son" · 12.14 "Hold the post without weariness; carry it out with loyalty" · 12.17 "To govern is to set right" · 12.19 "In governing, why use killing?" · 13.1 "Go before them; work hard for them" · 13.2 "Lead your officials, pardon small faults, promote the worthy and talented" · 13.16 "Those near are pleased, those far off come" · 13.17 "Do not seek speed; do not look to small gains" · 20.2 "Honor the five excellences, banish the four evils" (the question was how to serve in government)

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 19 of 38 (previous 11.18, next 12.8)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 17: "Where trust is lacking, there is distrust": Confucius too puts trust ahead of food and arms. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 12.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.8

Day 208 of the calendar · every July 27

棘子成曰：君子质而已矣，何以文为？子贡曰：惜乎！夫子之说，君子也。驷不及舌。文犹质也，质犹文也。虎豹之鞟犹犬羊之鞟。

Ji Zicheng said: A gentleman is substance, that is all; what need is there for refinement? Zigong said: What a pity, sir, that you speak of the gentleman so! A team of four horses cannot overtake the tongue. Refinement is as important as substance, and substance as refinement. The hide of a tiger or leopard, stripped of its hair, is just like the hide of a dog or sheep.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an engineer says, I just do the work well; I don't write documentation or give reports. Zigong would say: doing the work well is substance; making it understandable is refinement. Put two hides with the fur stripped off side by side, and the boss can't tell which one was the tiger's.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 20 of 38 (previous 12.7, next 12.23)

People Ji Zicheng: appears only here

Other books Daodejing, ch. 56: Heshang Gong explains "those who speak do not know" with Zigong's saying "a team of four horses cannot overtake the tongue."

a commentator's reading

— Analects 12.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.9

Day 209 of the calendar · every July 28

哀公问于有若曰：年饥，用不足，如之何？有若对曰：盍彻乎？曰：二，吾犹不足，如之何其彻也？对曰：百姓足，君孰与不足？百姓不足，君孰与足？

Duke Ai asked You Ruo: The harvest is poor and there is not enough for expenses. What should be done? You Ruo replied: Why not tax at one tenth? The Duke said: Even at two tenths I do not have enough; how could I tax at one tenth? He replied: When the people have enough, how can the ruler not have enough? When the people do not have enough, how can the ruler have enough?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: business on a shopping street has slowed, and the landlords are discussing whether to raise rents to cover losses or cut them so the shops survive. Youzi's reckoning is the second: only if every shop stays open do the landlords collect rent; with half the shops closed, rents raised sky-high still bring in nothing.

This chapter connects to

People Youzi (You Ruo): appearance 4 of 4 (previous 1.13)

People Duke Ai of Lu: appearance 4 of 5 (previous 6.2, next 14.22)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 75: “The people starve because those above eat up too much in taxes”; You Ruo urged Duke Ai to cut taxes: “If the people have enough, how can the ruler not have enough?” Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 79: “Those with virtue keep the tally; those without virtue keep the levy”: che (彻) was the Zhou-dynasty tax law, and Youzi urged Duke Ai to adopt it. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 12.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.10

Day 210 of the calendar · every July 29

子张问崇德、辨惑。子曰：主忠信，徙义，崇德也。爱之欲其生，恶之欲其死。既欲其生，又欲其死，是惑也。诚不以富，亦祇以异。

Zizhang asked about exalting virtue and discerning delusion. The Master said: Hold loyalty and good faith as primary and move toward what is right — that is exalting virtue. When you love someone you want him to live; when you hate him you want him to die. Wanting him to live and also wanting him to die — that is delusion. 'Truly it is not for wealth, but only for something different.'

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: fans praise a celebrity to the skies one day, and the next day, after one piece of news, they want him gone for good. The people who praised him and the people who want him gone are the same people. Confucius calls this confusion.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about exalting virtue — Asked 2 times; see also 12.21 "The work first, the reward after"

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 8 of 20 (previous 12.6, next 12.14)

Other books Book of Songs, Lesser Odes, "Wo Xing Qi Ye": "Truly not for wealth, but only for something different." source

Variant The base text has “亦祇以异”; the standard text has “亦只以异”

— Analects 12.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.11

Day 211 of the calendar · every July 30

齐景公问政于孔子。孔子对曰：君君，臣臣，父父，子子。公曰：善哉！信如君不君，臣不臣，父不父，子不子，虽有粟，吾得而食诸?

Duke Jing of Qi asked Confucius about government. Confucius replied: Let the ruler be a ruler, the minister a minister, the father a father, the son a son. The Duke said: Excellent! Truly, if the ruler is not a ruler, the minister not a minister, the father not a father, the son not a son, even if there is grain, would I get to eat it?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: in a company where the boss keeps grabbing the manager's work, the manager has nothing to do, so he goes and runs the front desk; with nobody at the front desk, customers walk in and no one greets them. The eight characters come down to this: everyone in their own place, everyone doing their own job.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about government — Asked 10 times; see also 12.7 "Enough food. Enough arms. The people's trust" · 12.14 "Hold the post without weariness; carry it out with loyalty" · 12.17 "To govern is to set right" · 12.19 "In governing, why use killing?" · 13.1 "Go before them; work hard for them" · 13.2 "Lead your officials, pardon small faults, promote the worthy and talented" · 13.16 "Those near are pleased, those far off come" · 13.17 "Do not seek speed; do not look to small gains" · 20.2 "Honor the five excellences, banish the four evils" (the question was how to serve in government)

People Duke Jing of Qi: appearance 1 of 3 (next 16.12)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 5: The Three Bonds set the roles of ruler and minister, father and son, husband and wife; Confucius's version is that each first does his own part. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 11: The spirit of the Ten Duties: each role does its own part. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 25: Jiao Hong records Li Yue's reading "model on earth as earth, on heaven as heaven, on the Way as the Way", citing the pattern of

Confucius's "let the ruler be ruler, the minister minister, the father father, the son son" as evidence. a commentator's reading

— Analects 12.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.12

Day 212 of the calendar · every July 31

子曰：片言可以折狱者，其由也与？子路无宿诺。

The Master said: One who could settle a lawsuit with half a word — that would be You, would it not? Zilu never slept on a promise.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: two households in a residential complex have fought over a parking space for half a month. Old Zhang from property management says one line, "Go by last year's registration," and both sides drop it. Not because he outranks them, but because in ten years he has never said anything he didn't follow through on.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 23 of 41 (previous 11.25, next 13.1)

— Analects 12.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.13

Day 212 of the calendar · every July 31

子曰：听讼，吾犹人也，必也使无讼乎！

The Master said: In hearing lawsuits I am like anyone else. What is needed is to make sure there are no lawsuits!

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a neighborhood office has two mediators. One closes cases fast; the other has almost no cases on her desk. That second one goes door to door every spring and settles things like water bills and junk piled in stairwells in advance. The one Confucius would value is her.

— Analects 12.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.14

Day 213 of the calendar · every August 1

子张问政。子曰：居之无倦，行之以忠。

Zizhang asked about government. The Master said: Hold your post without weariness, and carry it out with loyalty.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a new homeroom teacher is the first to arrive at school every day in the first week of term; by November, she arrives later than the students. The "never tire" Confucius told Zizhang about is about November.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about government — Asked 10 times; see also 12.7 "Enough food. Enough arms. The people's trust" · 12.11 "Let the ruler be a ruler, the minister a minister, the father a father, the son a son" · 12.17 "To govern is to set right" · 12.19 "In governing, why use killing?" · 13.1 "Go before them; work hard for them" · 13.2 "Lead your officials, pardon small faults, promote the worthy and talented" · 13.16 "Those near are pleased, those far off come" · 13.17 "Do not seek speed; do not look to small gains" · 20.2 "Honor the five excellences, banish the four evils" (the question was how to serve in government)

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 9 of 20 (previous 12.10, next 12.20)

— Analects 12.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.15

Day 213 of the calendar · every August 1

子曰：博学于文，约之以礼，亦可以弗畔矣夫！

The Master said: Learn broadly in culture and restrain it with ritual, and you may thereby avoid going astray.

This chapter connects to

See also 6.25: The Master said: A gentleman who learns broadly in culture and restrains it with ritual…

— Analects 12.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.16

Day 214 of the calendar · every August 2

子曰：君子成人之美，不成人之恶。小人反是。

The Master said: The gentleman helps others achieve what is good in them, not what is bad. The petty man does the opposite.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a colleague has proposed a project. You happen to have material that could help him pull it off, and also a remark that could sink it. A gentleman hands over the material, then helps him strike that remark.

— Analects 12.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.17

Day 215 of the calendar · every August 3

季康子问政于孔子。孔子对曰：政者，正也。子帅以正，孰敢不正？

Ji Kangzi asked Confucius about government. Confucius replied: To govern is to be correct. If you lead by being correct, who will dare not be correct?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a workshop supervisor requires workers to be on the floor at eight, while he himself shows up at eight-thirty. The workers say nothing, but they are all thinking the same thing: I'll come when the supervisor comes.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about government — Asked 10 times; see also 12.7 "Enough food. Enough arms. The people's trust" · 12.11 "Let the ruler be a ruler, the minister a minister, the father a father, the son a son" · 12.14 "Hold the post without

weariness; carry it out with loyalty" · 12.19 "In governing, why use killing?" · 13.1 "Go before them; work hard for them" · 13.2 "Lead your officials, pardon small faults, promote the worthy and talented" · 13.16 "Those near are pleased, those far off come" · 13.17 "Do not seek speed; do not look to small gains" · 20.2 "Honor the five excellences, banish the four evils" (the question was how to serve in government)

See also 12.19: Ji Kangzi asked Confucius about government: What if I killed those without the Way in…

People Ji Kangzi: appearance 5 of 8 (previous 11.6, next 12.18)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 37: The excavated text reads "Heaven and earth will set themselves right." Confucius says, "If you lead with rightness, who will dare not be right?" Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 75: “The people are hard to govern because those above take action”; Confucius said that if those above are upright, those below will not dare be otherwise. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 12.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.18

Day 215 of the calendar · every August 3

季康子患盗，问于孔子。孔子对曰：苟子之不欲，虽赏之不窃。

Ji Kangzi was troubled by thieves and asked Confucius. Confucius replied: If you yourself did not covet, they would not steal even if you rewarded them for it.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a senior executive complains that staff keep taking printer paper home, yet last month's expense claims included his whole family's vacation. Only when the boss doesn't take from the company will the staff stop taking from it.

This chapter connects to

People Ji Kangzi: appearance 6 of 8 (previous 12.17, next 12.19)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 3: Explaining "not displaying the desirable keeps the people's hearts from disorder," Lü Huiqing cites Confucius's reply to Ji Kangzi: if

you yourself are not greedy, no one would steal even if you paid them to.
a commentator's reading

— Analects 12.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.19

Day 216 of the calendar · every August 4

季康子问政于孔子曰：如杀无道，以就有道，何如？孔子对曰：子为政，焉用杀？子欲善，而民善矣。君子之德风，小人之德草。草上之风，必偃。

Ji Kangzi asked Confucius about government: What if I killed those without the Way in order to bring about the Way? Confucius replied: In governing, why use killing? If you desire the good, the people will be good. The virtue of the gentleman is the wind; the virtue of the petty man is the grass. When the wind passes over the grass, it surely bends.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: at the dinner table, a father yells at his child, "Stop staring at your phone," while scrolling through videos himself. Whichever way the wind blows, the grass bends; the child isn't watching his mouth, he's watching his hands.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about government — Asked 10 times; see also 12.7 "Enough food. Enough arms. The people's trust" · 12.11 "Let the ruler be a ruler, the minister a minister, the father a father, the son a son" · 12.14 "Hold the post without weariness; carry it out with loyalty" · 12.17 "To govern is to set right" · 13.1 "Go before them; work hard for them" · 13.2 "Lead your officials, pardon small faults, promote the worthy and talented" · 13.16 "Those near are pleased, those far off come" · 13.17 "Do not seek speed; do not look to small gains" · 20.2 "Honor the five excellences, banish the four evils" (the question was how to serve in government)

See also 12.17: Ji Kangzi asked Confucius about government. Confucius replied: To govern is to be…

People Ji Kangzi: appearance 7 of 8 (previous 12.18, next 14.20)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 23: Laozi says a gale cannot last a whole morning; Confucius likens the gentleman's virtue to the wind. The same word "wind", two uses. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 57: Jiao Hong records Xizhai's commentary, which cites "when the wind passes over the grass, the grass must bend" to explain "I do nothing, and the people transform themselves." a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 74: “There is always the executioner to do the killing”; Confucius said governing has no need of killing. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 12.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.20

Day 217 of the calendar · every August 5

子张问：士何如斯可谓之达矣？子曰：何哉，尔所谓达者？子张对曰：在邦必闻，在家必闻。子曰：是闻也，非达也。夫达也者，质直而好义，察言而观色，虑以下人。在邦必达，在家必达。夫闻也者，色取仁而行违，居之不疑。在邦必闻，在家必闻。

Zizhang asked: What must a scholar be like to be called accomplished? The Master said: What do you mean by accomplished? Zizhang replied: Known throughout the state, known throughout the clan. The Master said: That is being known, not being accomplished. The accomplished man is upright in substance and loves what is right; he weighs people's words and observes their looks, and is mindful to put himself below others. He is sure to succeed in the state and in the clan. As for the man who is merely known, he puts on a look of humaneness but acts against it, and dwells in this without doubt. He is sure to be known in the state and in the clan.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: two people make online content. One has over ten million followers and is recognized everywhere, yet no one in the business

will work with him. The other has few followers, but when he says something in the industry, everyone trusts it and things get done. The first is being famous; the second is getting through.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about the shi — Asked 3 times; see also 13.20 "Have a sense of shame in your conduct; sent abroad, do not disgrace your ruler's commission" · 13.28 "Earnest, encouraging, and genial"

See also 13.28: Zilu asked: What must one be like to be called a scholar? The Master said: Earnest,...

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 10 of 20 (previous 12.14, next 14.43)

— Analects 12.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.21

Day 218 of the calendar · every August 6

樊迟从游于舞雩之下，曰：敢问崇德、修慝、辨惑。子曰：善哉问！先事后得，非崇德与？攻其恶，无攻人之恶，非修慝与？一朝之忿，忘其身，以及其亲，非惑与？

Fan Chi was walking with the Master below the rain altar and said: May I ask about exalting virtue, rooting out hidden faults, and discerning delusion? The Master said: A good question! Putting the work first and the reward after — is that not exalting virtue? Attacking your own faults and not those of others — is that not rooting out hidden faults? In a morning's anger forgetting yourself and even your parents — is that not delusion?

Yikonglu's note Today: someone cuts you off on the road and you floor it to chase him. In the three seconds you're chasing, your child is in the back seat. Confucius's "a moment's anger that makes you forget yourself and even your family" is those three seconds.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about exalting virtue — Asked 2 times; see also 12.10 "Hold to loyalty and trustworthiness; move toward what is right"

People Fan Chi (Fan Xu): appearance 3 of 6 (previous 6.20, next 12.22)

— Analects 12.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.22

Day 219 of the calendar · every August 7

樊迟问仁。子曰：爱人。问知。子曰：知人。樊迟未达。子曰：举直错诸枉，能使枉者直。樊迟退，见子夏。曰：乡也，吾见于夫子而问知，子曰：举直错诸枉，能使枉者直。何谓也？子夏曰：富哉言乎！舜有天下，选于众，举皋陶，不仁者远矣。汤有天下，选于众，举伊尹，不仁者远矣。

Fan Chi asked about humaneness. The Master said: Love others. He asked about wisdom. The Master said: Know others. Fan Chi did not understand. The Master said: Raise up the straight and set them over the crooked, and the crooked can be made straight. Fan Chi withdrew and went to see Zixia, saying: Just now I saw the Master and asked about wisdom, and he said, 'Raise up the straight and set them over the crooked, and the crooked can be made straight.' What does this mean? Zixia said: How rich these words are! When Shun held the realm, he chose from among the many and raised up Gao Yao, and the inhumane went far away. When Tang held the realm, he chose from among the many and raised up Yi Yin, and the inhumane went far away.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a department promotes its fairest person to manager, and half a year later the few who liked to game the system have stopped. Not because they were fired, but because they straightened out. That is "raise the straight and set them over the crooked, and you can make the crooked straight."

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about humaneness — Asked 8 times; see also 6.20 “The humane put the hard part first and the reward after” · 12.1 “To restrain oneself and return to ritual is humaneness” · 12.2 “What you do not want for yourself, do not do to others” · 12.3 “The humane are slow to speak” · 13.19 “Be respectful at home, reverent in your work, loyal to others” · 15.9 “Serve the worthiest of its officials, befriend the most humane of its scholars” (the question was how to practice humaneness) · 17.6 “Respect, tolerance, trustworthiness, diligence, kindness”

Same question Asked about wisdom — Asked 2 times; see also 6.20 "Devote yourself to what is right for the people; revere ghosts and spirits but keep them at a distance"

See also 2.19: Duke Ai asked: What should I do so that the people will submit? Confucius replied: Raise…

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 8 of 20 (previous 12.5, next 13.17)

People Fan Chi (Fan Xu): appearance 4 of 6 (previous 12.21, next 13.4)

People Shun: appearance 4 of 7 (previous 8.20, next 14.45)

People Gao Yao: appears only here

People Tang of Shang: appearance 1 of 2 (next 20.1)

People Yi Yin: appears only here

— Analects 12.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.23

Day 220 of the calendar · every August 8

子贡问友。子曰：忠告而善道之，不可则止，毋自辱焉。

Zigong asked about friendship. The Master said: Advise him faithfully and guide him well; if that fails, stop. Do not bring humiliation on yourself.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a friend has been drinking and wants to drive. You've told him twice and he won't listen. The third time, you don't keep arguing; you just don't get in his car, and you don't fall out with him either. The "stop" Confucius means is: say what needs saying, then take yourself back.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 21 of 38 (previous 12.8, next 13.20)

Occasion Farewells: When a friend takes a path you disagree with: advise them sincerely and speak kindly; if they won't listen, stop, and don't ruin the friendship by pressing.

— Analects 12.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 12.24

Day 220 of the calendar · every August 8

曾子曰：君子以文会友，以友辅仁。

Zengzi said: The gentleman gathers friends through culture, and through friends supports his humaneness.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a book club of a dozen people reads the same book each month. They go home afterward, and the next day at work each treats people a little better than the month before. This is meeting friends through learning and letting friends support humaneness; a dinner party isn't.

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 10 of 15 (previous 11.17, next 14.28)

Occasion Graduation: Perfect for class yearbooks and graduation photos: you became friends by studying together, and your friends helped you become better.

— Analects 12.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/12.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 13 · Zilu

Analects 13.1

Day 221 of the calendar · every August 9

子路问政。子曰：先之，劳之。请益。曰：无倦。

Zilu asked about government. The Master said: Go before the people and work hard for them. He asked for more. The Master said: Do not grow weary.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a team is moving a warehouse. The team leader lifts the first box and says "Follow me," and the whole crew gets moving; if he stands to the side shouting "Hurry up," everyone is slow. "Never tire" means: you carried the first box, and you still carry the hundredth.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about government — Asked 10 times; see also 12.7 "Enough food. Enough arms. The people's trust" · 12.11 "Let the ruler be a ruler, the minister a minister, the father a father, the son a son" · 12.14 "Hold the post without weariness; carry it out with loyalty" · 12.17 "To govern is to set right" · 12.19 "In governing, why use killing?" · 13.2 "Lead your officials, pardon small faults, promote the worthy and talented" · 13.16 "Those near are pleased, those far off come" · 13.17 "Do not seek speed; do not look to small gains" · 20.2 "Honor the five excellences, banish the four evils" (the question was how to serve in government)

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 24 of 41 (previous 12.12, next 13.3)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 66: “To lead the people, put yourself behind them”: Confucius said that in governing you go first and bear the hardship yourself.

Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 13.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.2

Day 221 of the calendar · every August 9

仲弓为季氏宰，问政。子曰：先有司，赦小过，举贤才。曰：焉知贤才而举之？曰：举尔所知。尔所不知，人其舍诸？

Zhonggong, as steward of the Ji family, asked about government. The Master said: Put your officers first, pardon small faults, and raise up the worthy and talented. He said: How can I know the worthy and talented to raise them? The Master said: Raise those you know. Those you do not know — will others pass them over?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a new department manager spends his first week not doing the work himself but assigning every task to a person. He lets someone's one-time lateness go and quickly promotes whoever is capable. He says, "I don't know yet who's capable." Confucius's answer: promote the ones you know; the ones you don't, the people below will push forward themselves.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about government — Asked 10 times; see also 12.7 "Enough food. Enough arms. The people's trust" · 12.11 "Let the ruler be a ruler, the minister a minister, the father a father, the son a son" · 12.14 "Hold the post without weariness; carry it out with loyalty" · 12.17 "To govern is to set right" · 12.19 "In governing, why use killing?" · 13.1 "Go before them; work hard for them" · 13.16 "Those near are pleased, those far off come" · 13.17 "Do not seek speed; do not look to small gains" · 20.2 "Honor the five excellences, banish the four evils" (the question was how to serve in government)

People the Ji family: appearance 5 of 7 (previous 11.16, next 16.1)

People Zhonggong (Ran Yong): appearance 6 of 6 (previous 12.2)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 3: Confucius urged "promote the worthy and talented"; Laozi said "do not exalt the worthy." On employing people, the two schools are exact opposites. Yikonglu's comparison

Variant The base text has “曰举尔所知”; the standard text has “子曰举尔所知”

— Analects 13.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.3

Day 222 of the calendar · every August 10

子路曰：卫君待子而为政，子将奚先？子曰：必也，正名乎？子路曰：有是哉，子之迂也。奚其正？子曰：野哉由也！君子于其所不知，盖阙如也。名不正，则言不顺；言不顺，则事不成；事不成，则礼乐不兴；礼乐不兴，则刑罚不中；刑罚不中，则民无所措手足。故君子名之必可言也，言之必可行也。君子于其言，无所苟而已矣。

Zilu said: The ruler of Wei is waiting for you to govern. What will you do first? The Master said: It must be to rectify names! Zilu said: Is that so? How impractical you are, Master! Why rectify them? The Master said: How crude you are, You! A gentleman leaves aside what he does not know. If names are not correct, speech does not follow; if speech does not follow, affairs do not succeed; if affairs do not succeed, ritual and music do not flourish; if ritual and music do not flourish, punishments miss the mark; if punishments miss the mark, the people do not know where to put hand or foot. So when a gentleman names something, it must be sayable; when he says it, it must be doable. In his words the gentleman allows nothing careless.

> **Yikonglu's note** Rectifying names starts with a concrete matter: in Wei, father and son were fighting over the throne, and their proper titles were in disorder. Only from there does it extend to names matching reality.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: one person in a company has "Vice President" printed on his business card but no real authority; another is called "Director" and handles everything a vice president should. In meetings, nobody listens to the "Vice President," and nobody dares treat the "Director's" word as final. A matter gets pushed around for two months and goes nowhere, and the staff don't know whom to follow. What Confucius is saying is: first get those two business cards right.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 25 of 41 (previous 13.1, next 13.28)

People Duke Chu of Wei: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 7.14)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 22: The "usurped" in "Wang Mang usurped" is the historians' fixed label; once names are settled, right and wrong are clear. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 23: Which of the Three Kingdoms was the legitimate line? Historians were arguing over the rightful name and title. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 25: The text says "received the abdication of Zhou"; the commentator writes "usurped." The dispute is over name versus reality. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 32: "Once things are regulated, there are names; once there are names, one must know where to stop": Confucius wanted to rectify names, and Laozi says that once names are set up, one must know when to stop. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 57: Su Zhe explains "the more laws and orders are displayed" by citing Confucius's chapter on rectifying names: "the people will not know where to put hand or foot." a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 74: Su Zhe, explaining “The people do not fear death,” also quotes Confucius's “the people will not know where to put hand or foot.” a commentator's reading

Variant The base text has “无所措手足”; the standard text has “无所错手足”

— Analects 13.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.4

Day 223 of the calendar · every August 11

樊迟请学稼，子曰：吾不如老农。请学为圃。曰：吾不如老圃。樊迟出。子曰：小人哉，樊须也！上好礼，则民莫敢不敬；上好义，则民莫敢不服；上好信，则民莫敢不用情。夫如是，则四方之民襁负其子而至矣，焉用稼?

Fan Chi asked to learn farming. The Master said: I am not as good as an old farmer. He asked to learn gardening. The Master said: I am not as good as an old gardener. Fan Chi went out. The Master said: What a petty man Fan Xu is! If those above love ritual, the people will not dare be irreverent; if those above love what is right, the people will not dare disobey; if those above love good faith, the people will not dare be insincere. If it is so, the people of the four quarters will come with their children strapped on their backs. What need is there for farming?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a factory director with several hundred people under him goes to the workshop every day to learn welding, and welds worse than anyone. What he should be learning is how to make workers want to stay: pay on time, give awards fairly, keep his word. Keeping the workers matters more than his being able to weld.

This chapter connects to

People Fan Chi (Fan Xu): appearance 5 of 6 (previous 12.22, next 13.19)

— Analects 13.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.5

Day 224 of the calendar · every August 12

子曰：诵诗三百，授之以政，不达；使于四方，不能专对；虽多，亦奚以为?

The Master said: One may recite the three hundred Odes, yet when given a post in government, fail to carry it out, and when sent on missions abroad, be unable to answer on his own. However many he has learned, what use are they?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: someone has memorized a whole bookcase of management books. Put him in charge of a ten-person team and it's chaos within a week; send him to negotiate with a client and he can't get a word in. Confucius's question is: what you've read, can you actually use it?

— Analects 13.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.6

Day 224 of the calendar · every August 12

子曰：其身正，不令而行；其身不正，虽令不从。

The Master said: If he himself is correct, things are done without orders; if he himself is not correct, even with orders they are not obeyed.

This chapter connects to

See also 13.13: The Master said: If he can make himself correct, what difficulty would he have in...

Other books Daodejing, ch. 43: "Teaching without words" is teaching by example. Confucius says that if you are upright yourself, things get done without orders.

Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 13.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.7

Day 225 of the calendar · every August 13

子曰：鲁卫之政，兄弟也。

The Master said: The governments of Lu and Wei are brothers.

— Analects 13.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.8

Day 225 of the calendar · every August 13

子谓卫公子荆，善居室。始有，曰：苟合矣。少有，曰：苟完矣。富有，曰：苟美矣。

The Master said of Prince Jing of Wei that he managed his household well. When he first had something, he said: It will more or less do. When he had a little more, he said: It is more or less complete. When he was rich, he said: It is more or less fine.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a couple renting a place start with a bed and a stove and say, "That's enough." They move somewhere a bit bigger, add a sofa, and say, "That's complete." They buy their own home and say, "That's lovely." Another couple insists on waiting until everything is perfect before each move, and in ten years they haven't moved once.

This chapter connects to

People Prince Jing of Wei: appears only here

— Analects 13.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.9

Day 226 of the calendar · every August 14

子适卫，冉有仆。子曰：庶矣哉！冉有曰：既庶矣，又何加焉？曰：富之。曰：既富矣，又何加焉？曰：教之。

The Master went to Wei, with Ran You driving. The Master said: How numerous the people are! Ran You said: Now that they are numerous, what more should be done? Make them prosperous. Now that they are prosperous, what more should be done? Teach them.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a new development zone spends its first three years recruiting hard, and people come. In the next three, factories multiply and wages rise. In the seventh year, parents at the construction site gate ask: where will our kids go to school? Fail to think of that step, and people start leaving. Mr. Hu's line is harsher: the school is built and the teachers are hired, but if those doing the teaching don't live by it themselves, that isn't teaching.

This chapter connects to

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 13 of 16 (previous 11.25, next 13.14)

— Analects 13.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.10

Day 227 of the calendar · every August 15

子曰：苟有用我者，期月而已可也，三年有成。

The Master said: If anyone would employ me, within a year things would be in fair shape, and in three years there would be results.

— Analects 13.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.11

Day 227 of the calendar · every August 15

子曰：善人为邦百年，亦可以胜残去杀矣。诚哉是言也！

The Master said: 'If good men governed a state for a hundred years, they could overcome cruelty and do away with killing.' How true this saying is!

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 74: Confucius said that if good people governed a state for a hundred years, they too could do away with cruelty and killing.
Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 13.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.12

Day 228 of the calendar · every August 16

子曰：如有王者，必世而后仁。

The Master said: Even with a true king, it would take a generation for humaneness to prevail.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 13.10–13.12 discussed together)** Today: a new manager takes over a mess. In one year, the rules are on the wall and people show up to meetings. In three, no one is late and the books balance. To get the people there to do things well without anyone watching, you need to replace a generation and raise another, and that takes thirty years. Confucius lays out these four numbers to say: don't demand of one year what takes three, and don't praise three years for what takes thirty.

— Analects 13.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.13

Day 228 of the calendar · every August 16

子曰：苟正其身矣，于从政乎何有？不能正其身，如正人何？

The Master said: If he can make himself correct, what difficulty would he have in government? If he cannot make himself correct, how can he correct others?

This chapter connects to

See also 6.6: Ji Kangzi asked: Can Zhong You be put in charge of government? The Master said: Yóu is…

See also 13.6: The Master said: If he himself is correct, things are done without orders; if he himself…

— Analects 13.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.14

Day 229 of the calendar · every August 17

冉子退朝。子曰：何晏也？对曰：有政。子曰：其事也。如有政，虽不吾以，吾其与闻之。

Ran Zi returned from court. The Master said: Why so late? He replied: There was state business. The Master said: It must have been family business. If there had been state business, though I am not in office, I would have heard of it.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 13.13–13.14 discussed together)** Today: a small-time department head settles company business behind closed doors with a few people, then tells everyone afterward. A veteran employee asks just one thing: is this a company decision, or the decision of you few? If it's the company's, how is it that an old hand like me never heard about it? No shouting, no cursing, and the proper titles are set right. That one question is what Confucius put to Ran You.

This chapter connects to

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 14 of 16 (previous 13.9, next 14.13)

— Analects 13.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.15

Day 230 of the calendar · every August 18

定公问：一言而可以兴邦，有诸？孔子对曰：言不可以若是其几也。人之言曰：为君难，为臣不易。如知为君之难也，不几乎一言而兴邦乎？曰：一言而丧邦，有诸？孔子对曰：言不可以若是其几也。人之言曰：予无乐乎为君，唯其言而莫予违也。如其善而莫之违也，不亦善乎？如不善而莫之违也，不几乎一言而丧邦乎？

Duke Ding asked: Is there a single saying that can make a state flourish? Confucius replied: A saying cannot be expected to do that much. But people say, 'It is hard to be a ruler, and not easy to be a minister.' If one understood how hard it is to be a ruler, would that not come close to a single saying making a state flourish? He asked: Is there a single saying that can ruin a state? Confucius replied: A saying cannot be expected to do that much. But people say, 'I take no joy in being ruler, except that no one contradicts what I say.' If what he says is good and no one contradicts it, is that not good? If what he says is not good and no one contradicts it, would that not come close to a single saying ruining a state?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a boss's proudest line is "No one in this company dares tell me no." From that day on, meetings are nothing but nodding. When he's right, no one says so; when he's wrong, no one says so either. By the third mistake, the company is gone. Confucius isn't faulting the words themselves; he's faulting the little bit of pride in the man who says them.

This chapter connects to

People Duke Ding of Lu: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 3.19)

— Analects 13.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.16

Day 231 of the calendar · every August 19

叶公问政。子曰：近者说，远者来。

The Duke of She asked about government. The Master said: When those near are pleased and those far away come.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about government — Asked 10 times; see also 12.7 "Enough food. Enough arms. The people's trust" · 12.11 "Let the ruler be a ruler, the minister a minister, the father a father, the son a son" · 12.14 "Hold the post without weariness; carry it out with loyalty" · 12.17 "To govern is to set right" · 12.19 "In governing, why use killing?" · 13.1 "Go before them; work hard for them" · 13.2 "Lead your officials, pardon small faults, promote the worthy and talented" · 13.17 "Do not seek speed; do not look to small gains" · 20.2 "Honor the five excellences, banish the four evils" (the question was how to serve in government)

People the Duke of She: appearance 2 of 3 (previous 7.18, next 13.18)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 80: “Neighboring states within sight of each other… yet the people grow old and die without visiting one another.” Confucius, by contrast, said to make those near glad and those far away come. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 13.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.17

Day 231 of the calendar · every August 19

子夏为莒父宰，问政。子曰：无欲速，无见小利。欲速，则不达；见小利，则大事不成。

Zixia, as steward of Jufu, asked about government. The Master said: Do not seek speed; do not look to small gains. Seek speed and you will not get there; look to small gains and great affairs will not be accomplished.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 13.16–13.17 discussed together)** Today: a new store manager wants to double sales in her first month and runs promotions every day, wearing out the regular customers until they leave. A new village party secretary first fixes the streetlight at the village entrance that's been broken for three years, and people passing through from other villages say this village is in good hands. Confucius's words to Zixia were aimed at Zixia's own failing. When you hear "want it fast and you won't get there" today, first ask: is this about me?

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about government — Asked 10 times; see also 12.7 "Enough food. Enough arms. The people's trust" · 12.11 "Let the ruler be a ruler, the minister a minister, the father a father, the son a son" · 12.14 "Hold the post without weariness; carry it out with loyalty" · 12.17 "To govern is to set right" · 12.19 "In governing, why use killing?" · 13.1 "Go before them; work hard for them" · 13.2 "Lead your officials, pardon small faults, promote the worthy and talented" · 13.16 "Those near are pleased, those far off come" · 20.2 "Honor the five excellences, banish the four evils" (the question was how to serve in government)

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 9 of 20 (previous 12.22, next 19.3)

Occasion Starting a Job: For someone taking over a new project. Rush for results and they won't come; keep your eye on small gains and big things won't get done.

— Analects 13.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.18

Day 232 of the calendar · every August 20

叶公语孔子曰：吾党有直躬者，其父攘羊，而子证之。孔子曰：吾党之直者异于是。父为子隐，子为父隐，直在其中矣。

The Duke of She said to Confucius: In my village there is an upright man. When his father stole a sheep, the son bore witness against him. Confucius said: The upright in my village are different. The father covers for the son, and the son covers for the father. Uprightness lies in this.

> **Yikonglu's note** Father and son not coming forward against each other is ordinary human feeling. "Covering" means not testifying and urging reform behind closed doors, not helping fake anything. Today's criminal procedure law likewise does not compel close relatives to testify in court.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: in court, a son is called to testify against his father. Today's Criminal Procedure Law has a provision: the court may not compel a defendant's spouse, parents, or children to appear and testify. This provision is a shadow of "kin concealing for kin," and its root is in this chapter. Confucius isn't saying stealing a sheep is fine; he's saying: a society that forces a son to accuse his father is rotten at the root first.

This chapter connects to

People the Duke of She: appearance 3 of 3 (previous 13.16)

People Upright Gong: appears only here

People Upright Gong's father: appears only here

— Analects 13.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.19

Day 233 of the calendar · every August 21

樊迟问仁。子曰：居处恭，执事敬，与人忠。虽之夷狄，不可弃也。

Fan Chi asked about humaneness. The Master said: Be respectful at home, reverent in handling affairs, loyal in dealing with others. Even among the barbarian tribes, these cannot be abandoned.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: someone is sent by his company to a worksite abroad, where no one knows him and no one supervises him. In the morning he still puts on his work clothes neatly, still checks each job step by step, still does what he promised his coworkers. Confucius's "even among the barbarian tribes, these must not be abandoned" means: when no one is watching, are you still the same person?

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about humaneness — Asked 8 times; see also 6.20 “The humane put the hard part first and the reward after” · 12.1 “To restrain oneself and return to ritual is humaneness” · 12.2 “What you do not want for yourself, do not do to others” · 12.3 “The humane are slow to speak” · 12.22 “Love people” · 15.9 “Serve the worthiest of its officials, befriend the most humane of its scholars” (the question was how to practice humaneness) · 17.6 “Respect, tolerance, trustworthiness, diligence, kindness”

People Fan Chi (Fan Xu): appearance 6 of 6 (previous 13.4)

Occasion Starting a Job: A workplace code in nine characters: be respectful in daily life, serious in your work, wholehearted with others. Confucius said you must not drop it wherever you go.

— Analects 13.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.20

Day 234 of the calendar · every August 22

子贡问曰：何如斯可谓之士矣？子曰：行己有耻，使于四方，不辱君命，可谓士矣。曰：敢问其次。曰：宗族称孝焉，乡党称弟焉。曰：敢问其次。曰：言必信，行必果，硜硜然小人哉！抑亦可以为次矣。曰：今之从政者何如？子曰：噫！斗筲之人，何足算也。

Zigong asked: What must one be like to be called a scholar? The Master said: One who conducts himself with a sense of shame, and when sent abroad does not disgrace his ruler's commission, may be called a scholar. He said: May I ask about the next level? One whose clan praises his filial piety and whose village praises his respect for elders. May I ask about the next? One whose word is always kept and whose actions are always carried through — stubborn little men! Yet they may count as the next level. He said: What about those in government today? The Master said: Ah! Men of the peck and the bushel — hardly worth counting.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a company is hiring. The first grade knows which jobs not to take, and when sent to meet a client, gets the job done. The second grade is someone his family and old neighbors all say is reliable. The third grade always does what he promised, and sees it through even when he knows it's wrong; Confucius calls such people rigid, but they still beat the ones who talk big and deliver nothing. Confucius doesn't look down on "his word must be kept"; he's saying that alone can't hold up a true scholar-official.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about the shi — Asked 3 times; see also 12.20 "Upright in substance and fond of what is right, weighing words and reading faces, mindful to defer to others" (the question was what makes a shi "distinguished") · 13.28 "Earnest, encouraging, and genial"

See also 13.28: Zilu asked: What must one be like to be called a scholar? The Master said: Earnest,…

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 22 of 38 (previous 12.23, next 13.24)

Do not use Naming: Avoid in names: “kengkeng” (硁硁), which describes narrow, shallow judgment

Occasion Starting a Job: Fine to use, but know the weight of the original: Confucius put "having a sense of shame in one's conduct" and "not disgracing the ruler's commission" in the first rank, and "words always kept, actions always carried through" only third, calling such people "stubborn". Zhu Xi reads this as narrow in outlook.

Careful Keeping your word is the baseline, not the highest praise. Whether to act depends on whether you should, not on pushing through just because you said so.

— Analects 13.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.21

Day 235 of the calendar · every August 23

子曰：不得中行而与之，必也狂狷乎！狂者进取，狷者有所不为也。

The Master said: If I cannot find those who walk the middle way to associate with, then I must have the ardent and the cautious! The ardent press forward; the cautious have things they will not do.

— Analects 13.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.22

Day 236 of the calendar · every August 24

子曰：南人有言曰：人而无恒，不可以作巫医。善夫！不恒其德，或承之羞。子曰：不占而已矣。

The Master said: The southerners have a saying: 'A man without constancy cannot even be a shaman or a doctor.' Well said! 'If one is not constant in his virtue, he may meet with disgrace.' The Master said: Such a man simply need not divine.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 13.21–13.22 discussed together)** Today: leading a team, what you most want is someone steady and capable. Failing that, you'd rather have one go-getter and one person with firm limits than a roomful of people-pleasers who never offend anyone. Rein in the go-getter, push the one with limits, and both are useful; the people-pleasers won't budge.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 16: Emperor Xuanzong of Tang, explaining "not knowing the constant, acting rashly: disaster", cites this line: one without constancy will meet with disgrace. a commentator's reading

— Analects 13.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.23

Day 237 of the calendar · every August 25

子曰：君子和而不同，小人同而不和。

The Master said: The gentleman is harmonious but does not conform; the petty man conforms but is not harmonious.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 4: Laozi speaks of "softening the glare and mingling with the dust"; Confucius of "harmony without sameness." Both speak of harmony, but one blends in and the other holds its ground. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Weddings: A line for newlyweds: two people needn't agree on everything; they can differ and still live in harmony. Going along with each other on everything while resenting it inside is what real discord is.

— Analects 13.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.24

Day 238 of the calendar · every August 26

子贡问曰：乡人皆好之，何如？子曰：未可也。乡人皆恶之，何如？子曰：未可也。不如乡人之善者好之，其不善者恶之。

Zigong asked: What if everyone in the village likes him? The Master said: Not enough. What if everyone in the village dislikes him? The Master said: Not enough. Better that the good people of the village like him and the bad ones dislike him.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 23 of 38 (previous 13.20, next 14.18)

— Analects 13.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.25

Day 239 of the calendar · every August 27

子曰：君子易事而难说也：说之不以道，不说也；及其使人也，器之。小人难事而易说也：说之虽不以道，说也；及其使人也，求备焉。

The Master said: The gentleman is easy to serve but hard to please. Try to please him by other than the Way, and he is not pleased; when he employs people, he uses each according to his capacity. The petty man is hard to serve but easy to please. Try to please him by other than the Way, and he is pleased; when he employs people, he expects everything of them.

Yikonglu's note(chapters 13.23–13.25 discussed together) Today: an official is being evaluated, and the public gives him full marks across the board. Confucius would say don't celebrate yet; ask: did the few who like to take advantage also give him full marks? If even they speak well of him, he may not be standing in anyone's way. Superiors are the same: one who is pleased by gifts is nitpicky about everything when he employs people; one who refuses gifts looks only at what you can do.

— Analects 13.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.26

Day 240 of the calendar · every August 28

子曰：君子泰而不骄，小人骄而不泰。

The Master said: The gentleman is at ease but not arrogant; the petty man is arrogant but not at ease.

— Analects 13.26 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.26 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.27

Day 240 of the calendar · every August 28

子曰：刚毅、木讷，近仁。

The Master said: Firm, resolute, simple, slow to speak — these are close to humaneness.

Yikonglu's note(chapters 13.26–13.27 discussed together) Today: at a dinner table, one person sits steady, listens to whoever is talking, and doesn't grab the floor; another is the loudest, but the moment someone raises something he doesn't know, he gets agitated. The first is at ease; the second is arrogant. Then look at the quietest old master craftsman at the company: when others brag, he doesn't join in; what's his to do, he does step by step. That is being firm, resolute, simple, and slow to speak.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 45: "Great eloquence seems tongue-tied": Confucius also says those slow of speech are close to humaneness. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 13.27 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.27 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.28

Day 241 of the calendar · every August 29

子路问曰：何如斯可谓之士矣？子曰：切切、偲偲、怡怡如也，可谓士矣。朋友切切、偲偲，兄弟怡怡。

Zilu asked: What must one be like to be called a scholar? The Master said: Earnest, encouraging, and congenial — such a one may be called a scholar. Earnest and encouraging with friends, congenial with brothers.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: ask the same question, "What makes someone dependable?", of someone who charges ahead and someone who talks well, and the answers differ. Zigong was a good talker, so Confucius told him not to just talk; Zilu was blunt, so Confucius told him to be gentler with people. And one more thing: don't nitpick your brothers the way you would coworkers, and don't go along with coworkers on everything the way you would with brothers.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about the shi — Asked 3 times; see also 12.20 "Upright in substance and fond of what is right, weighing words and reading faces, mindful to defer to others" (the question was what makes a shi "distinguished") · 13.20 "Have a sense of shame in your conduct; sent abroad, do not disgrace your ruler's commission"

See also 12.20: Zizhang asked: What must a scholar be like to be called accomplished? The Master said:...

See also 13.20: Zigong asked: What must one be like to be called a scholar? The Master said: One who...

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 26 of 41 (previous 13.3, next 14.13)

— Analects 13.28 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.28 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.29

Day 242 of the calendar · every August 30

子曰：善人教民七年，亦可以即戎矣。

The Master said: When a good man has taught the people for seven years, they too can be sent to war.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 30: Laozi says "do not use arms to dominate the world"; Confucius says the people need seven years of teaching before they go to war. Neither takes up arms lightly. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 13.29 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.29 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 13.30

Day 242 of the calendar · every August 30

子曰：以不教民战，是谓弃之。

The Master said: To send untrained people to war is to throw them away.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 13.29–13.30 discussed together)** Today: a new worker on a construction site is sent up high with no training, and when there's an accident, the boss says he was careless. Confucius would say: he wasn't careless; you threw him away. Teaching first treats people as people; using them untaught treats them as things to use up and discard.

— Analects 13.30 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/13.30 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 14 · Xian wen

Analects 14.1

Day 243 of the calendar · every August 31

宪问耻。子曰：邦有道，谷；邦无道，谷，耻也。

Xian asked about shame. The Master said: When the state has the Way, to draw a salary; when the state lacks the Way, to draw a salary — that is shameful.

This chapter connects to

People Yuan Si (Yuan Xian): appearance 2 of 3 (previous 6.3, next 14.2)

— Analects 14.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.2

Day 243 of the calendar · every August 31

克、伐、怨、欲不行焉，可以为仁矣？子曰：可以为难矣，仁则吾不知也。

If one does not give way to domineering, boasting, resentment, or greed, can he be called humane? The Master said: He may be called hard to find; whether he is humane, I do not know.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.1–14.2 discussed together)** Today: two people both say they've quit smoking. One locks the cigarettes in a drawer, wants one every day, and grits his teeth not to; that is holding back so it isn't acted on, and it's hard to do. The other truly doesn't want to smoke anymore; there are no cigarettes in his drawer at all. The first one still has the key in his pocket.

This chapter connects to

People Yuan Si (Yuan Xian): appearance 3 of 3 (previous 14.1)

— Analects 14.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.3

Day 244 of the calendar · every September 1

子曰：士而怀居，不足以为士矣。

The Master said: A scholar who cherishes his comfort is not worthy to be called a scholar.

— Analects 14.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.4

Day 244 of the calendar · every September 1

子曰：邦有道，危言危行；邦无道，危行言孙。

The Master said: When the state has the Way, be lofty in speech and lofty in action; when the state lacks the Way, be lofty in action but modest in speech.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.3–14.4 discussed together)** Today: a company has gone bad, and the boss tells the accountant to alter the books. She refuses; that is acting upright. But she doesn't pound the table and denounce the boss at a staff meeting either; that is speaking with restraint. What you do can't bend; what you say can be less. Mr. Yin's last line holds too: when a company gets to the point where even the accountant doesn't dare speak up in meetings, that company is in danger.

— Analects 14.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.5

Day 245 of the calendar · every September 2

子曰：有德者必有言，有言者不必有德；仁者必有勇，勇者不必有仁。

The Master said: Those with virtue are sure to have words worth hearing; those with words are not necessarily virtuous. The humane are sure to have courage; the courageous are not necessarily humane.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the livestreamer who speaks most movingly about filial piety isn't necessarily the woman who brings meals every day to the old man living alone downstairs. She's not much of a talker, but when she speaks, it's all real. The man who's ready to throw punches after a few drinks isn't necessarily the one who jumps into the river to save a child; the one who jumps may be the one most afraid of trouble day to day.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 56: "Those who know do not speak; those who speak do not know." Confucius says a person of virtue will have something to say, but one who has things to say does not necessarily have virtue. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 67: “Compassionate, therefore able to be brave”: Confucius also said the humane are sure to have courage. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 14.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.6

Day 246 of the calendar · every September 3

南宫适问于孔子曰：羿善射，奡荡舟，俱不得其死然；禹稷躬稼，而有天下。夫子不答，南宫适出。子曰：君子哉若人！尚德哉若人！

Nangong Kuo asked Confucius: Yi was a fine archer and Ao could push a boat over land, yet neither died a natural death. Yu and Ji labored at farming themselves, yet came to possess the realm. The Master did not answer. When Nangong Kuo had gone out, the Master said: What a gentleman that man is! How he esteems virtue!

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: at dinner, a young colleague says: those who climbed by pulling strings all ended up in trouble; the old factory director who always worked in the shop alongside the workers earned the whole factory's respect, just like you. The person being praised has the hardest time responding on the spot: accept it and he's claiming it, don't and the conversation goes cold, so he just looks down and eats. Only after the young man leaves does he say to the person beside him: that kid sees things straight.

This chapter connects to

People Nan Rong (Nangong Kuo): appearance 3 of 3 (previous 11.5)

People Yu: appearance 3 of 4 (previous 8.21, next 20.1)

People Yi: appears only here

People Ao: appears only here

People Hou Ji: appears only here

— Analects 14.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.7

Day 247 of the calendar · every September 4

子曰：君子而不仁者有矣夫，未有小人而仁者也。

The Master said: There may be gentlemen who are not humane, but there has never been a petty man who is humane.

— Analects 14.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.8

Day 247 of the calendar · every September 4

子曰：爱之，能勿劳乎？忠焉，能勿诲乎？

The Master said: Can you love someone without making him work hard? Can you be loyal to someone without instructing him?

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.7–14.8 discussed together)** Today: a grandmother who won't let her grandson lift a finger, still tying his shoelaces at ten, gives the love a cow gives its calf. A subordinate who sees a big hole in the boss's plan and just nods through the meeting without a word gives the loyalty of a palace maid or eunuch. Teaching a child to tie his own laces means half a day of crying, and quietly telling the boss "this won't work" means taking a risk. But that kind of love and loyalty runs deeper and counts for more.

— Analects 14.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.9

Day 248 of the calendar · every September 5

子曰：为命：裨谌草创之，世叔讨论之，行人子羽修饰之，东里子产润色之。

The Master said: In drafting state documents, Pi Chen made the first draft, Shishu examined and discussed it, the envoy Ziyu revised and polished it, and Zichan of Dongli gave it its final luster.

This chapter connects to

People Zichan: appearance 2 of 3 (previous 5.15, next 14.10)

People Bi Chen: appears only here

People Shishu: appears only here

People Ziyu: appears only here

— Analects 14.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.10

Day 249 of the calendar · every September 6

或问子产。子曰：惠人也。问子西。曰：彼哉！彼哉！问管仲。曰：人也。夺伯氏骈邑三百，饭疏食，没齿无怨言。

Someone asked about Zichan. The Master said: A kind man. He asked about Zixi. The Master said: That man! That man! He asked about Guan Zhong. The Master said: He was a man indeed. He took the three hundred households of Pian from the Bo family, and Bo, living on coarse food, never uttered a word of resentment to the end of his days.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.9–14.10 discussed together)** Today: an important contract is drafted by one person, combed through clause by clause by legal, reworded by the people who deal with the client, and finally checked word by word by the boss. That is how Zheng "drafted its documents." As for Bo: an old employee makes a mistake and is moved to another post at lower pay, and his old position goes to a new general manager, who brings the factory back to life within three years. The old employee later retires and never says a bitter word to anyone. It isn't that he's easygoing. He knows where he went wrong, and he respects what the other man achieved.

This chapter connects to

People Guan Zhong: appearance 2 of 4 (previous 3.22, next 14.17)

People Zichan: appearance 3 of 3 (previous 14.9)

People Zixi: appears only here

People Bo Shi: appears only here

People Someone who asked about Zichan: appears only here

— Analects 14.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.11

Day 250 of the calendar · every September 7

子曰：贫而无怨难，富而无骄易。

The Master said: To be poor without resentment is hard; to be rich without arrogance is easy.

— Analects 14.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.12

Day 250 of the calendar · every September 7

子曰：孟公绰为赵魏老则优，不可以为滕薛大夫。

The Master said: Meng Gongchuo would be more than fit to be chief retainer of the Zhao or Wei families, but he could not be a minister of Teng or Xue.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.11–14.12 discussed together)** Today: a man loses his job with rent still due, and he curses neither the company nor the world. That is far harder than a rich man not flaunting his wealth. As for Meng Gongchuo: a highly respected old university professor is sent to run a township middle school. Enrollment, the canteen, safety, parents' complaints: a pile of urgent matters every day, and he can't cope. It isn't that he's a bad person. The post calls for a kind of talent he happens to lack. Sending him to the wrong post, Yang Shi says, is as good as throwing the man away.

This chapter connects to

People Meng Gongchuo: appearance 1 of 2 (next 14.13)

— Analects 14.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.13

Day 251 of the calendar · every September 8

子路问成人。子曰：若臧武仲之知，公绰之不欲，卞庄子之勇，冉求之艺，文之以礼乐，亦可以为成人矣。曰：今之成人者何必然？见利思义，见危授命，久要不忘平生之言，亦可以为成人矣。

Zilu asked about the complete man. The Master said: One with the wisdom of Zang Wuzhong, the freedom from desire of Gongchuo, the courage of Bian Zhuangzi, and the skill of Ran Qiu, refined by ritual and music, may be called a complete man. He added: But why must the complete man of today be so? One who, seeing profit, thinks of what is right; seeing danger, offers his life; and does not forget a long-standing promise however long ago he made it — he too may be called a complete man.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: people who have everything are rare, but the three lesser things can still be seen. A courier finds a wallet with twenty thousand yuan in it and waits on the spot for an hour for the owner. That is seeing gain and thinking of what is right. A building catches fire at midnight, and he knocks on every door before running downstairs. That is seeing danger and offering up his life. Ten years ago he promised an old classmate, "I'll be at your wedding for sure." He's living far away, so he rides a train all night and really goes. That is not forgetting a promise made long ago.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 27 of 41 (previous 13.28, next 14.17)

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 15 of 16 (previous 13.14, next 16.1)

People Meng Gongchuo: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 14.12)

People Zang Wuzhong: appearance 1 of 2 (next 14.15)

People Bian Zhuangzi: appears only here

— Analects 14.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.14

Day 252 of the calendar · every September 9

子问公叔文子于公明贾曰：信乎，夫子不言、不笑、不取乎？公明贾对曰：以告者过也。夫子时然后言，人不厌其言；乐然后笑，人不厌其笑；义然后取，人不厌其取。子曰：其然，岂其然乎？

The Master asked Gongming Jia about Gongshu Wenzi: Is it true that your master does not speak, does not laugh, and does not take? Gongming Jia replied: Those who told you exaggerated. My master speaks only when it is time, so people do not tire of his speaking; he laughs only when he is happy, so people do not tire of his laughing; he takes only when it is right, so people do not tire of his taking. The Master said: Is that so? Can it really be so?

This chapter connects to

People Gongshu Wenzi: appearance 1 of 2 (next 14.19)

People Gongming Jia: appears only here

Other books Daodejing, ch. 27: Su Zhe, explaining "good speech has no flaw", speaks of "speaking only at the right time", which comes from this chapter.
a commentator's reading

— Analects 14.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.15

Day 253 of the calendar · every September 10

子曰：臧武仲以防求为后于鲁，虽曰不要君，吾不信也。

The Master said: Zang Wuzhong held on to Fang and demanded that an heir be appointed for him in Lu. Though he says he was not coercing his ruler, I do not believe it.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.14–14.15 discussed together)** Today: word goes around online that an old actor "never takes endorsement fees." His agent comes out and says: it's not that he never takes them, he takes them only

when it's right, and takes them so that nobody minds. You hear this and think: is that so? Can that really be so? As for Zang Wuzhong: a sales director who made a mistake has to leave. On his way out he emails the boss, very politely: all I ask is that my nephew take over my position, and I won't take a single client with me. Listen closely to "I won't take the clients with me." It means "if he doesn't get the job, the clients go with me."

This chapter connects to

People Zang Wuzhong: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 14.13)

— Analects 14.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 14.16

Day 253 of the calendar · every September 10

子曰：晋文公谲而不正，齐桓公正而不谲。

The Master said: Duke Wen of Jin was crafty and not upright; Duke Huan of Qi was upright and not crafty.

Yikonglu's note Today: two companies fight over the same market, and both are in it for money. One wages a price war, cutting prices and competing on service in the open. The other secretly poaches its rival's staff and spreads rumors that the rival is about to go under. Neither is doing charity, but the first is upright and the second is crafty.

This chapter connects to

People Duke Wen of Jin: appears only here

People Duke Huan of Qi: appearance 1 of 3 (next 14.17)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 21: "The five hegemons grew strong": Confucius both praised and faulted two of them. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 14.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.17

Day 254 of the calendar · every September 11

子路曰：桓公杀公子纠，召忽死之，管仲不死。曰：未仁乎？子曰：桓公九合诸侯，不以兵车，管仲之力也。如其仁！如其仁！

Zilu said: Duke Huan had Prince Jiu killed. Shao Hu died with him, but Guan Zhong did not. Was he not lacking in humaneness? The Master said: Duke Huan gathered the lords together nine times without using war chariots — that was Guan Zhong's doing. Such was his humaneness! Such was his humaneness!

This chapter connects to

See also 14.18: Zigong said: Was Guan Zhong not inhumane? When Duke Huan killed Prince Jiu, he could not…

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 28 of 41 (previous 14.13, next 14.23)

People Guan Zhong: appearance 3 of 4 (previous 14.10, next 14.18)

People Duke Huan of Qi: appearance 2 of 3 (previous 14.16, next 14.18)

People Prince Jiu: appearance 1 of 2 (next 14.18)

People Shao Hu: appears only here

— Analects 14.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.18

Day 255 of the calendar · every September 12

子贡曰：管仲非仁者与？桓公杀公子纠，不能死，又相之。子曰：管仲相桓公，霸诸侯，一匡天下，民到于今受其赐。微管仲，吾其被发左衽矣。岂若匹夫匹妇之为谅也，自经于沟渎而莫之知也。

Zigong said: Was Guan Zhong not inhumane? When Duke Huan killed Prince Jiu, he could not die for him, and even became Huan's minister. The Master said: Guan Zhong served as Duke Huan's minister, made him leader of the lords, and set the whole realm in order; to this day the people enjoy his gifts. But for Guan Zhong, we would be wearing our hair loose and folding our robes to the left. Would he be like a common man or woman keeping petty faith, hanging himself in a ditch with no one knowing?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: two brothers fight over an old family business. You were on the younger brother's side, and he lost. The elder brother invites you back as general manager, and you go. Ten years later the factory supports tens of thousands of people, and the whole street lives off it. Some call you spineless. Master Cheng would say: it depends on who should have taken over. If it was rightly the elder brother's, going back to him is no betrayal. If it was rightly the younger brother's, no matter how big you make the factory, that debt can't be wiped out.

This chapter connects to

See also 14.17: Zilu said: Duke Huan had Prince Jiu killed. Shao Hu died with him, but Guan Zhong did…

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 24 of 38 (previous 13.24, next 14.30)

People Guan Zhong: appearance 4 of 4 (previous 14.17)

People Duke Huan of Qi: appearance 3 of 3 (previous 14.17)

People Prince Jiu: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 14.17)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 21: Hegemons had their merits too: Confucius credited Guan Zhong with setting the whole realm right.

Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 14.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.19

Day 256 of the calendar · every September 13

公叔文子之臣大夫僎，与文子同升诸公。子闻之曰：可以为文矣。

Zhuan, a household officer of Gongshu Wenzi, rose together with Wenzi to the ducal court. When the Master heard of it, he said: He deserves to be called Wen.

This chapter connects to

People Gongshu Wenzi: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 14.14)

People Zhuan: appears only here

— Analects 14.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.20

Day 257 of the calendar · every September 14

子言卫灵公之无道也，康子曰：夫如是，奚而不丧？孔子曰：仲叔圉治宾客，祝鮀治宗庙，王孙贾治军旅。夫如是，奚其丧？

The Master spoke of Duke Ling of Wei's lack of the Way. Ji Kangzi said: If he is like that, why has he not lost his state? Confucius said: Zhongshu Yu handles foreign guests, Priest Tuo handles the ancestral temple, and Wangsun Jia handles the army. With such men, how would he lose it?

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.19–14.20 discussed together)** Today: a department head recommends the assistant who has worked for her for five years to the general manager. Later the assistant is promoted and sits in meetings as her equal. She had to judge people well, not fear being outshone, and think of the company. The three good things Hong names, she has every one. Now Duke

> Ling of Wei: a company's chairman has poor character, but the finance director keeps the books perfectly clean, legal keeps a tight grip on every contract, and the sales director can win markets. A company like that won't fall.

This chapter connects to

People Ji Kangzi: appearance 8 of 8 (previous 12.19)

People Wangsun Jia: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 3.13)

People Kong Wenzi: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 5.14)

People Zhu Tuo: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 6.14)

People Duke Ling of Wei: appearance 1 of 2 (next 15.1)

— Analects 14.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 14.21

Day 257 of the calendar · every September 14

子曰：其言之不怍，则为之也难。

The Master said: One who speaks without shame will find it hard to carry out his words.

— Analects 14.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.22

Day 258 of the calendar · every September 15

陈成子弑简公。孔子沐浴而朝，告于哀公曰：陈恒弑其君，请讨之。公曰：告夫三子！孔子曰：以吾从大夫之后，不敢不告也。君曰告夫三子者。之三子告，不可。孔子曰：以吾从大夫之后，不敢不告也。

Chen Chengzi murdered Duke Jian. Confucius bathed and went to court, and reported to Duke Ai: Chen Heng has murdered his ruler. I request that he be punished. The Duke said: Tell the three lords. Confucius said: Because I follow behind the ministers, I dared not fail to report. And the ruler says, 'Tell the three lords.' He went to the three lords and told them; they refused. Confucius said: Because I follow behind the ministers, I dared not fail to report.

This chapter connects to

See also 11.7: When Yan Yuan died, Yan Lu asked for the Master's carriage to make an outer coffin for…

People Duke Ai of Lu: appearance 5 of 5 (previous 12.9)

People Chen Heng (Chen Chengzi): appears only here

People Duke Jian of Qi: appears only here

People The Three Lords: appears only here

— Analects 14.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.23

Day 259 of the calendar · every September 16

子路问事君。子曰：勿欺也，而犯之。

Zilu asked about serving a ruler. The Master said: Do not deceive him, but stand up to him.

Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.21–14.23 discussed together) Today: at a joint venture, the partner company's boss is set up and pushed out by his own deputy. The retired former chairman shaves early, puts on a suit, goes to the meeting, and proposes a joint lawsuit. The current chairman says: go ask the major shareholders. They all do business with that deputy, and they all say no. On his way out, the old chairman says only: I sat on the board, so I couldn't leave this unsaid. As for "do not deceive him, but stand up to him": a secretary who finds a problem in the accounts doesn't hide it from the boss, and says "no" to his face when it's called for. First, don't deceive; then, push back.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 29 of 41 (previous 14.17, next 14.38)

— Analects 14.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.24

Day 259 of the calendar · every September 16

子曰：君子上达，小人下达。

The Master said: The gentleman reaches upward; the petty man reaches downward.

— Analects 14.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.25

Day 259 of the calendar · every September 16

子曰：古之学者为己，今之学者为人。

The Master said: In ancient times, people learned for their own sake; nowadays, people learn for the sake of others.

Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.24–14.25 discussed together) Today: two people are learning piano. One practices every night behind a closed door until she can play a piece smoothly. The other posts a video on social media every time

he learns a short passage and counts the likes. Three years later the first can teach the neighbors' kids. This is called completing things. The second quits when the likes dry up, and dust settles on the piano lid. This is called losing oneself.

— Analects 14.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.26

Day 260 of the calendar · every September 17

蘧伯玉使人于孔子。孔子与之坐而问焉，曰：夫子何为？对曰：夫子欲寡其过而未能也。使者出。子曰：使乎！使乎！

Qu Boyu sent a messenger to Confucius. Confucius sat with him and asked: What is your master doing? He replied: My master wishes to reduce his faults but has not yet managed it. When the messenger had left, the Master said: What a messenger! What a messenger!

Yikonglu's note Today: a seventy-year-old doctor asks a student to take a box of tea to an old classmate. The classmate asks: what's the old man busy with these days? The student says: my teacher says he's still working on his faults, and the more he works on them, the more of his past mistakes he finds. After seeing the student off, the classmate tells his family: that young man knows how to speak, and he understands his teacher.

This chapter connects to

People Qu Boyu: appearance 1 of 2 (next 15.6)

People Qu Boyu's messenger: appears only here

— Analects 14.26 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.26 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.27

Day 261 of the calendar · every September 18

子曰：不在其位，不谋其政。

The Master said: When not in the office, do not plan its affairs.

This chapter connects to

See also 8.14: The Master said: When not in the office, do not plan its affairs.

Occasion Starting a Job: Newcomers shouldn't go over others' heads to make their decisions for them. Each should look after their own patch.

Careful Often used to dodge things: "Not my business." This line already appeared in 8.14 (Taibo). There Zhu Xi quotes Master Cheng: if someone in office comes to ask, you should still tell them truthfully.

— Analects 14.27 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.27 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.28

Day 261 of the calendar · every September 18

曾子曰：君子思不出其位。

Zengzi said: The gentleman does not let his thoughts go beyond his position.

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 11 of 15 (previous 12.24, next 19.16)

— Analects 14.28 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.28 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.29

Day 261 of the calendar · every September 18

子曰：君子耻其言而过其行。

The Master said: The gentleman is ashamed to let his words outrun his deeds.

Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.27–14.29 discussed together) Today: an intern three days into the job holds forth on company strategy at meetings while his own spreadsheet sits unfinished. That is stepping outside his position. As for "ashamed to let his words outrun his deeds": a renovation worker takes a job and says only "about three days." He finishes in two and a half and sweeps the floor by the door too. Say a little less, do a little more.

This chapter connects to

See also 4.24: The Master said: The gentleman wishes to be slow in speech and quick in action.

— Analects 14.29 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.29 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 14.30

Day 262 of the calendar · every September 19

子曰：君子道者三，我无能焉：仁者不忧，知者不惑，勇者不惧。子贡曰：夫子自道也。

The Master said: The way of the gentleman has three parts, and I have achieved none of them: the humane do not worry, the wise are not perplexed, the brave do not fear. Zigong said: That is the Master describing himself.

Yikonglu's note Today: an old master who has trained apprentices for thirty years tells the newcomers: in this trade your heart mustn't race, your eyes mustn't blur, your hands mustn't shake, and I still haven't mastered any of the three. Behind his back the apprentices say: he's describing himself. Saying he can't do it is how he pushes himself. The apprentices see it clearly because he stands there every day showing them.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 25 of 38 (previous 14.18, next 14.31)

— Analects 14.30 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.30 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.31

Day 262 of the calendar · every September 19

子贡方人。子曰：赐也贤乎哉？夫我则不暇。

Zigong was comparing people. The Master said: Ci must be very worthy! As for me, I have no time for that.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 26 of 38 (previous 14.30, next 14.37)

— Analects 14.31 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.31 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.32

Day 263 of the calendar · every September 20

子曰：不患人之不己知，患其不能也。

The Master said: Do not worry that others do not know you; worry that you lack ability.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.31–14.32 discussed together)** Today: a few colleagues huddle over lunch. Who's rising fast, who's actually no good, whose kid got good grades: they can go on for an hour. An old accountant nearby carries her lunchbox back to her desk and keeps reconciling the books. Another man has repaired watches for thirty years, and nobody on the street knows his name. He worries about only one thing: whether his hands are as steady as they used to be.

This chapter connects to

See also 1.16: The Master said: Do not be troubled that others do not know you; be troubled that you do...

— Analects 14.32 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.32 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.33

Day 263 of the calendar · every September 20

子曰：不逆诈，不亿不信。抑亦先觉者，是贤乎！

The Master said: Not anticipating deceit, not presuming bad faith, yet being the first to perceive it — that is worthy indeed!

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a woman at a community service center never assumes anyone who comes in is lying. She takes their papers with a smile, but when someone brings an altered certificate, one look and she sets it down. A retired man trusts everyone, and when he gets a call saying "your grandson is in trouble," he transfers all his retirement savings. Yang Shi says the first is sincere and clear-sighted. The second truly doesn't suspect people, but he was cheated, and you can't call that worthy.

— Analects 14.33 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.33 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.34

Day 264 of the calendar · every September 21

微生亩谓孔子曰：丘，何为是栖栖者与？无乃为佞乎？孔子曰：非敢为佞也，疾固也。

Weisheng Mu said to Confucius: Qiu, why are you always so busily on the move? Are you not just a smooth talker? Confucius said: I would not dare be a smooth talker. It is stubbornness I dislike.

This chapter connects to

People Weisheng Mu: appears only here

— Analects 14.34 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.34 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.35

Day 265 of the calendar · every September 22

子曰：驥不称其力，称其德也。

The Master said: A fine steed is praised not for its strength but for its character.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.34–14.35 discussed together)** Today: a retired official, long out of office, says to the face of a neighborhood committee head who is always rushing about: all this running around, isn't it just that you're a smooth talker? She smiles and says: I wouldn't dare. I just can't stand to see things stay stuck. As for the fine horse: however fast the sports car, if the driver runs red lights the moment he hits the gas, you won't dare ride with him. When people praise an old driver, what they praise is twenty years without an accident.

— Analects 14.35 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.35 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.36

Day 265 of the calendar · every September 22

或曰：以德报怨，何如？子曰：何以报德？以直报怨，以德报德。

Someone said: What about repaying injury with kindness? The Master said: Then with what would you repay kindness? Repay injury with uprightness, and repay kindness with kindness.

> **Yikonglu's note** "Uprightness" means fairness. Treat him as he ought to be treated: no harsher because of the grudge, and no more ingratiating because of it either. It is not an eye for an eye.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the people upstairs renovate in the middle of the night and keep you awake, and instead of saying anything, you send them a box of fruit. Then what do you send the woman across the hall, who collects your packages every day and brought you porridge when you were sick? Repaying resentment with uprightness means knocking on their door and saying it plainly, and if that fails, filing a complaint by the rules. Do what's

right, hold no grudge, don't curry favor. The woman who helped you, remember her and repay her.

This chapter connects to

People Someone who asked about repaying injury: appears only here

Other books Daodejing, ch. 49: "Those who are not good, I am good to them too." Confucius instead advocates "repaying resentment with uprightness." Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 63: In the Analects someone put “repay resentment with virtue” to Confucius, and he answered “repay resentment with uprightness.” Zhu Xi's commentary: “What this person cited is now found in the book of Laozi.” source

Other books Daodejing, ch. 79: “Settle a great grievance, and some grievance is sure to remain.” Confucius held: “Repay injury with uprightness, repay kindness with kindness.” Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 14.36 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.36 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.37

Day 266 of the calendar · every September 23

子曰：莫我知也夫！子贡曰：何为其莫知子也？子曰：不怨天，不尤人。下学而上达。知我者其天乎！

The Master said: No one knows me! Zigong said: Why does no one know you? The Master said: I do not resent Heaven, nor blame others. I learn from below and reach up above. The one who knows me — is it Heaven?

Yikonglu's note Today: an old man has guarded a mountain forest for thirty years. A reporter asks: all these years and nobody knows you. Do you feel wronged? He says: no. I patrol the mountain once a day, and whichever tree is sick, I treat. As the reporter leaves, he adds one more line: the ones who know me are probably these trees.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 27 of 38 (previous 14.31, next 15.2)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 12: Start from sweeping and answering, and rise step by step: that is the path from the Lesser Learning to the Four Books. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 34: After the prodigies, the Beiyao commentary closes with "learn what is below and reach what is above": cleverness is not enough; you still have to learn step by step. a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 70: “Few understand me,” and Confucius too sighed, “No one understands me!” Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 14.37 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.37 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.38

Day 267 of the calendar · every September 24

公伯寮愬子路于季孙。子服景伯以告，曰：夫子固有惑志于公伯寮，吾力犹能肆诸市朝。子曰：道之将行也与？命也。道之将废也与？命也。公伯寮其如命何！

Gongbo Liao slandered Zilu to Jisun. Zifu Jingbo reported it, saying: My master has certainly been misled by Gongbo Liao, but I still have the power to have his corpse displayed in the marketplace. The Master said: If the Way is to prevail, it is fate. If the Way is to be cast aside, it is fate. What can Gongbo Liao do against fate?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an old colleague of yours bad-mouths your apprentice to the general manager, who half believes it. Another friend of yours slams the table: I know people, I can make sure he never works in this industry again. You say: let it go. We keep doing what we should, and whether it works out isn't up to one remark of his. You say this not out of fear of him, but because you never thought that remark mattered so much.

This chapter connects to

See also 19.23: Shusun Wushu said to the ministers at court: Zigong is worthier than Zhongni. Zifu Jingbo…

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 30 of 41 (previous 14.23, next 14.41)

People Gongbo Liao: appears only here

People Jisun: appears only here

People Zifu Jingbo: appearance 1 of 2 (next 19.23)

— Analects 14.38 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.38 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.39

Day 268 of the calendar · every September 25

子曰：贤者辟世，其次辟地，其次辟色，其次辟言。

The Master said: The worthy withdraw from the world; the next withdraw from a place; the next withdraw at a look; the next withdraw at a word.

— Analects 14.39 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.39 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.40

Day 268 of the calendar · every September 25

子曰：作者七人矣。

The Master said: Seven men have done so.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.39–14.40 discussed together)** Today: a company's culture has gone bad. Seeing the whole industry is like this, one person simply goes back home to farm. Another moves to a good company in another city. Another hands in his resignation as soon as the boss turns cold toward him. Another leaves only after the boss says something ugly in public. Master Cheng says: don't compare who ranks higher. Each met with different circumstances.

— Analects 14.40 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.40 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.41

Day 269 of the calendar · every September 26

子路宿于石门。晨门曰：奚自？子路曰：自孔氏。曰：是知其不可而为之者与？

Zilu spent the night at Stone Gate. The gatekeeper said: Where are you from? Zilu said: From the house of Kong. He said: Is that the one who knows it cannot be done and still does it?

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 31 of 41 (previous 14.38, next 14.45)

People The gatekeeper: appears only here

— Analects 14.41 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.41 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.42

Day 270 of the calendar · every September 27

子击磬于卫。有荷蒉而过孔氏之门者，曰：有心哉！击磬乎！既而曰：鄙哉！硜硜乎！莫己知也，斯已而已矣。深则厉，浅则揭。子曰：果哉！末之难矣。

The Master was playing the stone chimes in Wei. A man carrying a basket passed the gate of the Kong household and said: There is a heart in this playing of the chimes! After a while he said: How petty, this clanging! If no one knows you, then just stop. 'When the water is deep, wade in your clothes; when it is shallow, lift your hem.' The Master said: How decisive! There is nothing hard about that.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.41–14.42 discussed together)** Today: in a mountain village clinic, the young people have all left and only the old remain. Everyone knows it will close in a few years. Every morning the village doctor still opens the door, takes blood pressures, delivers medicine. A passerby

says: why bother? See how things are going and move to the city while you can. The doctor says: there are still people who need their blood pressure taken today. You could call him a fool. What he carries in his heart is those few dozen old people.

This chapter connects to

People The man carrying a basket: appears only here

Other books Book of Songs, Airs of Bei, "Pao You Ku Ye": "If deep, wade through in your clothes; if shallow, hitch them up." source

— Analects 14.42 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.42 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 14.43

Day 271 of the calendar · every September 28

子张曰：书云：高宗谅阴，三年不言。何谓也？子曰：何必高宗，古之人皆然。君薨，百官总己以听于冢宰三年。

Zizhang said: The Documents say, 'Gaozong, in the mourning hut, did not speak for three years.' What does this mean? The Master said: Why only Gaozong? The ancients were all so. When the ruler died, all the officials attended to their duties and took orders from the chief minister for three years.

This chapter connects to

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 11 of 20 (previous 12.20, next 15.5)

People Gaozong of Shang: appears only here

— Analects 14.43 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.43 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.44

Day 271 of the calendar · every September 28

子曰：上好礼，则民易使也。

The Master said: When those above love ritual, the people are easy to employ.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.43–14.44 discussed together)** Today: at an old factory, the director's mother dies and he goes home to mourn for a month. Before leaving he says only: if anything comes up, go to the deputy director. For that month the workshops run as usual, the accounts close as usual, and nobody calls him. Only when he returns do people say: so the rules he set all along were meant for times like this.

— Analects 14.44 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.44 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.45

Day 272 of the calendar · every September 29

子路问君子。子曰：修己以敬。曰：如斯而已乎？曰：修己以安人。曰：如斯而已乎？曰：修己以安百姓。修己以安百姓，尧舜其犹病诸！

Zilu asked about the gentleman. The Master said: He cultivates himself with reverence. Is that all? He cultivates himself to bring peace to others. Is that all? He cultivates himself to bring peace to all the people. Cultivating oneself to bring peace to all the people — even Yao and Shun found this hard!

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a new community director starts by governing herself: never late to meetings, every promise written in her notebook. A year later there are fewer quarrels in the building. Ten years later every old person on the street knows to come to her with problems. Someone praises her for having done it all. She says: just last week an old man living alone fell, and nobody found him for three days. That is what Confucius meant by "even Yao and Shun found this hard."

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about the gentleman — Asked 3 times; see also 2.13 "First act on your words, then let them follow" · 12.4 "The gentleman neither worries nor fears"

See also 6.28: Zigong said: If someone gave widely to the people and could relieve the multitude, what…

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 32 of 41 (previous 14.41, next 15.1)

People Yao: appearance 3 of 4 (previous 8.19, next 20.1)

People Shun: appearance 5 of 7 (previous 12.22, next 15.4)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 54: "Cultivate it in yourself, and your virtue will be genuine," extending step by step to the whole world; Confucius says "cultivate yourself to bring peace to the people." Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 14.45 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/14.45 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 14.46

Day 273 of the calendar · every September 30

原壤夷俟。子曰：幼而不孙弟，长而无述焉，老而不死，是为贼！以杖叩其胫。

Yuan Rang sat squatting, waiting. The Master said: Young, you were not humble or respectful to elders; grown, you accomplished nothing worth mentioning; old, you do not die — you are a pest! And he tapped him on the shin with his staff.

This chapter connects to

People Yuan Rang: appears only here

Do not use Birthday Wishes for Elders: Never use this at a birthday.

Careful Here Confucius is scolding one person, his old friend Yuan Rang. Yuan Rang squatted waiting for him, and Confucius berated him: "humble and respectful neither as a youth nor as a man, nothing worth mentioning," not one good thing from childhood to old age, then rapped him on the shin with his staff. The three lines go together and target this man, not all old people.

Analects 14.47

Day 274 of the calendar · every October 1

阙党童子将命。或问之曰：益者与？子曰：吾见其居于位也，见其与先生并行也。非求益者也，欲速成者也。

A boy from Que village was carrying messages. Someone asked about him: Is he making progress? The Master said: I see him sitting in the seat of an adult and walking side by side with his elders. He is not seeking progress; he wants to grow up fast.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 14.46–14.47 discussed together)** Today: at a class reunion, an old friend sprawls on the sofa with his feet on the coffee table, mocking other people as phonies. You laugh and scold him: a grown man your age, still like this! You tap his shin with a rolled-up newspaper: sit up. With an outsider, you wouldn't talk that way. Another scene: a new intern grabs the seat next to the director at meetings and walks side by side with him. The old hand supervising him has him pour tea and take the minutes. It isn't a punishment. It's so he first sees clearly who speaks first at a meeting and who speaks after.

This chapter connects to

People The boy from Que: appears only here

People Someone who asked about the boy: appears only here

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 39: On the "benefit" in "play brings no benefit," the Yinshu commentary cites this chapter: real progress takes slow work, not a rush for quick results. a commentator's reading

Book 15 · Wei Ling Gong

Analects 15.1

Day 275 of the calendar · every October 2

卫灵公问陈于孔子。孔子对曰：俎豆之事，则尝闻之矣；军旅之事，未之学也。明日遂行。在陈绝粮，从者病，莫能兴。子路愠见曰：君子亦有穷乎？子曰：君子固穷，小人穷斯滥矣。

Duke Ling of Wei asked Confucius about military formations. Confucius replied: Matters of sacrificial vessels I have heard about; military matters I have never studied. The next day he left. In Chen, their provisions ran out; his followers fell ill and could not rise. Zilu came to him, indignant: Does the gentleman, too, end up in straits? The Master said: The gentleman holds firm in straits; the petty man in straits loses all restraint.

> **Yikonglu's note** The gentleman too has times of hardship; he just doesn't run wild when hard up. Zhu Xi also cites Master Cheng's "firmly holding to one's hardship," which also makes sense.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: Two small restaurants on the same street are both doing so badly they can barely hang on. One owner cuts the menu to five dishes, stands at the stove himself every day, and still serves meat bought that day. The other starts buying expired frozen stock and adds extra MSG to the soup. When customers get sick, he blames another restaurant. Both are poor. One is just poor; the other "runs wild."

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 33 of 41 (previous 14.45, next 15.3)

People Duke Ling of Wei: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 14.20)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 31: Duke Ling of Wei asked about warfare. Confucius said he had never studied it, and left the next day. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 69: “Those who use troops have a saying,” yet Confucius said he had never studied military matters. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 15.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.2

Day 276 of the calendar · every October 3

子曰：赐也，女以予为多学而识之者与？对曰：然，非与？曰：非也，予一以贯之。

The Master said: Ci, do you think I am someone who has learned a great deal and remembers it all? He replied: Yes. Is it not so? The Master said: No. I have one thread running through it all.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A cook with thirty years at the stove is asked by his apprentice how many recipes he keeps in his head. "Not one," he says. The apprentice doesn't believe it; there are hundreds of dishes. The master says: I only watch the heat and taste for salt. The dishes change; those two don't. The apprentice copied a whole notebook of recipes, and his cooking fell apart as soon as he moved to a different stove.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 28 of 38 (previous 14.37, next 15.9)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 48: Su Zhe goes on to cite Confucius asking Zigong: I do not learn much and memorize it; I have "one thread running through it all"—which is exactly "in pursuing the Way, one loses daily." a commentator's reading

— Analects 15.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.3

Day 277 of the calendar · every October 4

子曰：由！知德者鲜矣。

The Master said: You, those who understand virtue are few.

Yikonglu's note Today: Someone who has never been in the water can still recite the definition of "buoyancy" perfectly. Put him in deep water and he panics and sinks. A swimmer knows that if you relax, the water holds you up. That "knowing" lives in the body, not in a book.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 34 of 41 (previous 15.1, next 16.1)

— Analects 15.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.4

Day 277 of the calendar · every October 4

子曰：无为而治者，其舜也与？夫何为哉？恭己正南面而已矣。

The Master said: One who governed by doing nothing — was that not Shun? What did he do? He made himself reverent and sat facing south, that was all.

Yikonglu's note Today: At a noodle shop open for decades, the old owner just sits in the chair by the door every day, nodding to regulars. The ones who knead the dough, cook the noodles and take the money each do their job, and nobody needs him to call out. A new worker thinks he doesn't manage anything. In fact he picked each of them himself, one by one, and trained them year after year.

This chapter connects to

People Shun: appearance 6 of 7 (previous 14.45, next 20.1)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 17: Laozi says that of the best ruler the people know only that he exists; Confucius too praises Shun for "governing by doing nothing". Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 37: Laozi says "The Way always does nothing, yet nothing is left undone." Confucius likewise says Shun "simply made himself reverent and faced south." Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 57: "I do nothing, and the people transform themselves"; Confucius also praises Shun for "governing by doing nothing." Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 60: “Governing a large state is like cooking a small fish”: commentators explain it through Shun's non-action, and Confucius praised Shun the same way. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 66: “Because he does not contend, no one in the world can contend with him.” Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 15.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.5

Day 278 of the calendar · every October 5

子张问行。子曰：言忠信，行笃敬，虽蛮貊之邦行矣；言不忠信，行不笃敬，虽州里行乎哉？立，则见其参于前也；在舆，则见其倚于衡也。夫然后行。子张书诸绅。

Zizhang asked how to get along. The Master said: Let your words be loyal and true and your conduct sincere and reverent, and you will get along even among the barbarian states. If your words are not loyal and true and your conduct not sincere and reverent, will you get along even in your own neighborhood? Standing, see these before you; in your carriage, see them leaning on the cross-bar. Then you will get along. Zizhang wrote this on his sash.

Yikonglu's note Today: A long-haul truck driver has a small slip of paper stuck in the middle of his steering wheel with one word on it: Slow. He has driven for twenty years without an accident. Someone asks: after all these years, you still need a reminder? He says: it's because I've driven so long that I need to see it every day.

This chapter connects to

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 12 of 20 (previous 14.43, next 15.41)

— Analects 15.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.6

Day 279 of the calendar · every October 6

子曰：直哉史鱼！邦有道，如矢；邦无道，如矢。君子哉蘧伯玉！邦有道，则仕；邦无道，则可卷而怀之。

The Master said: How upright Shi Yu is! When the state has the Way, he is like an arrow; when the state lacks the Way, he is like an arrow. What a gentleman Qu Boyu is! When the state has the Way, he serves; when the state lacks the Way, he can roll himself up and put himself away.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A company's accounts go wrong. An old accountant writes three reports in a row and nobody responds; on the day he retires, he still leaves a fourth on the boss's desk. A colleague sees there's no staying at this company, quietly hands in his resignation and goes elsewhere, taking his skills with him and saying nothing bad. Of the two, one is the arrow and the other is the bamboo scroll rolled up.

This chapter connects to

People Qu Boyu: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 14.26)

People Shi Yu: appears only here

— Analects 15.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.7

Day 280 of the calendar · every October 7

子曰：可与言而不与之言，失人；不可与言而与之言，失言。知者不失人，亦不失言。

The Master said: Not to speak with someone you should speak with is to lose a person; to speak with someone you should not speak with is to waste words. The wise lose neither people nor words.

Yikonglu's note Today: Two young people join your team. One stays after work every day to ask questions. You find it a bother and just say, "Look it up yourself." Half a year later he has moved to another company and become one of its key people. The other goes out of his way to find fault with you, yet you tell him all your complaints about the boss, and the next day the whole building knows. The first is losing a person; the second is wasting your words.

— Analects 15.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 15.8

Day 280 of the calendar · every October 7

子曰：志士仁人，无求生以害仁，有杀身以成仁。

The Master said: A resolute scholar and a humane man will not seek to live at the expense of humaneness; they will give their lives to achieve humaneness.

Yikonglu's note Today, most people will never face anything that calls for giving their life. But "the scale in your heart" is there every day. An old bridge inspector finds one figure in a report that fails the standard, and his superiors tell him to change it and sign. He refuses and is transferred to look after a warehouse. People call him a fool. He says: if I signed, I couldn't sleep at night; tens of thousands of people cross that bridge every day. ---

— Analects 15.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.9

Day 281 of the calendar · every October 8

子贡问为仁。子曰：工欲善其事，必先利其器。居是邦也，事其大夫之贤者，友其士之仁者。

Zigong asked about practicing humaneness. The Master said: A craftsman who wants to do his work well must first sharpen his tools. Living in a state, serve the worthiest of its ministers and befriend the most humane of its scholars.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A young cook just starting out asks an old master how to cook well. The master doesn't teach him knife work. First he says two things: in this restaurant, work under the woman at the stove who is the most exacting; after work, eat with the guy your age who practices latest every night. Half a year later, his knife work has improved, and he has steadied too.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about humaneness — Asked 8 times; see also 6.20 “The humane put the hard part first and the reward after” · 12.1 “To restrain oneself and return to ritual is humaneness” · 12.2 “What you do not want for yourself, do not do to others” · 12.3 “The humane are slow to speak” · 12.22 “Love people” · 13.19 “Be respectful at home, reverent in your work, loyal to others” · 17.6 “Respect, tolerance, trustworthiness, diligence, kindness”

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 29 of 38 (previous 15.2, next 15.23)

Occasion Graduation: For classmates heading to work or graduate school. The second half is “serve the worthiest of its officials, befriend the most humane of its scholars”: the best tools are following good seniors and making good friends.

Careful Originally Zigong asked how to practice humaneness, and Confucius used a craftsman as an analogy. It isn't only about tools.

— Analects 15.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.10

Day 282 of the calendar · every October 9

颜渊问为邦。子曰：行夏之时，乘殷之辂，服周之冕，乐则韶舞。放郑声，远佞人。郑声淫，佞人殆。

Yan Yuan asked about governing a state. The Master said: Use the calendar of Xia, ride the carriage of Yin, wear the cap of Zhou; for music, the Shao and its dances. Banish the tunes of Zheng and keep away glib talkers. The tunes of Zheng are licentious; glib talkers are dangerous.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: An old, established shop is reopening, and an old manager is asked to set the rules. He says: stock up by the seasons the older generation kept, when to bring in new rice and when to lay in dried goods. Deliver with the sturdiest old cart, not a flashy new one. Make the signboard over the door well; that's the face customers see. Play only quiet old tunes in the shop. The last two rules: no loudspeakers at the door to pull people in, and no keeping clerks with honeyed tongues who only say what the boss likes to hear. ---

This chapter connects to

People Yan Yuan (Yan Hui): appearance 21 of 21 (previous 12.1)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 27: "Powerful eunuchs ran rampant": Confucius said governing a state means keeping glib flatterers at a distance. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 3: Explaining "not exalting the worthy," Heshang Gong quotes this line but writes "keep glib people at a distance" as "keep beautiful women at a distance": one character's difference. a commentator's reading

— Analects 15.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.11

Day 283 of the calendar · every October 10

子曰：人无远虑，必有近忧。

The Master said: One who does not think far ahead will surely have worries close at hand.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: A housing complex repairs its roads, but each household fixes only the stretch outside its own door. Nobody looks after the drainage ditch in the middle; no one walks there anyway. Then a heavy rain comes, the water can't drain, and it floods the newly paved road outside every door.

This chapter connects to

Occasion New Year: Write this on your plan for the new year: if you don't think ahead, trouble is close at hand.

— Analects 15.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.12

Day 284 of the calendar · every October 11

子曰：已矣乎！吾未见好德如好色者也。

The Master said: It is hopeless! I have never seen anyone who loves virtue as much as he loves beauty.

This chapter connects to

See also 9.17: The Master said: I have never seen anyone who loves virtue as much as he loves beauty.

— Analects 15.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.13

Day 284 of the calendar · every October 11

子曰：臧文仲其窃位者与？知柳下惠之贤，而不与立也。

The Master said: Was Zang Wenzhong not one who held his post like a thief? He knew Liuxia Hui was worthy, yet did not bring him to stand beside him at court.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 15.12–15.13 discussed together)** Today: A department manager knows full well that the most capable person on his team is the old engineer. Every year when promotions are submitted, he crosses that name off, afraid that if the man moves up, his own seat won't be safe. He still runs the department, but this is what Confucius means by "stealing a position": the seat is his, and he knows in his heart it shouldn't be.

This chapter connects to

People Zang Wenzhong: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 5.17)

People Liuxia Hui: appearance 1 of 3 (next 18.2)

— Analects 15.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.14

Day 285 of the calendar · every October 12

子曰：躬自厚而薄责于人，则远怨矣。

The Master said: Demand much of yourself and little of others, and you will keep resentment far away.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: An amateur basketball team loses a game. As they leave, the captain speaks first: "That last pass was mine, and I blew it." Another player adds: "I didn't get back on defense either." Nobody counts other people's mistakes. They win the next game. The team next door fights after every loss, and by the end of the year the players have all drifted away.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 78: “Bearing the state's misfortunes”: blame yourself more and others less. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 15.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.15

Day 285 of the calendar · every October 12

子曰：不曰如之何如之何者，吾末如之何也已矣。

The Master said: With one who never asks, 'What should I do? What should I do?', I can do nothing at all.

This chapter connects to

See also 9.23: The Master said: Words of correction — can one fail to accept them? What matters is to…

— Analects 15.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.16

Day 286 of the calendar · every October 13

子曰：群居终日，言不及义，好行小慧，难矣哉！

The Master said: Those who gather all day long, whose talk never touches on what is right, and who love to show off petty cleverness — they are hard to deal with!

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 15.15–15.16 discussed together)** Today: An intern takes on tasks without ever asking, "How should this be done?" He goes by feel, and when he gets it wrong, he doesn't ask what went wrong. His supervisor says: if he came and asked, I could teach him ten things; since he doesn't ask, I can't get a single one across. In another dorm room, four students talk until two every night, about who's dating whom and how to get others to answer roll call for them. After four years, their talking has improved. Nothing else has.

— Analects 15.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.17

Day 286 of the calendar · every October 13

子曰：君子义以为质，礼以行之，孙以出之，信以成之。君子哉！

The Master said: The gentleman takes what is right as his substance, carries it out through ritual, expresses it with modesty, and completes it with good faith. That is a gentleman!

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: An old carpenter takes on a job. He picks sound timber and doesn't pass off inferior wood: that is "making rightness the substance." He makes every joint by the old rules: that is "carrying it out through ritual." On delivery day he says, if anything isn't convenient to use, bring it back anytime: that is "putting it forth with modesty." He promised the end of the month, and he delivers at the end of the month: that is "completing it with good faith." The customer says: this cabinet will last fifty years.

This chapter connects to

See also 17.23: Zilu said: Does the gentleman esteem courage? The Master said: The gentleman holds what…

— Analects 15.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.18

Day 287 of the calendar · every October 14

子曰：君子病无能焉，不病人之不己知也。

The Master said: The gentleman is troubled by his own lack of ability, not by others' failure to know him.

This chapter connects to

See also 4.14: The Master said: Do not worry about having no position; worry about what you would stand…

— Analects 15.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.19

Day 287 of the calendar · every October 14

子曰：君子疾没世而名不称焉。

The Master said: The gentleman dreads leaving the world without his name being spoken of.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 38: "Make one's name known": what the gentleman dreads is ending his life without having done anything worth praising. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 44: Laozi asks, "Fame or your own person, which is dearer?" Confucius, by contrast, feared dying without a good name: Confucians and Daoists clash head-on over "name." Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 15.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.20

Day 288 of the calendar · every October 15

子曰：君子求诸己，小人求诸人。

The Master said: The gentleman seeks it in himself; the petty man seeks it in others.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 15.18–15.20 discussed together)** Today: two design graduates send out their portfolios and hear nothing back. One posts every day that this industry can't recognize talent. The other takes three pieces apart, redoes them, and applies again six months later. The first keeps saying "Nobody understands me"; the second only asks himself, "Where am I still falling short?"

This chapter connects to

Occasion Coming of Age: For a child about to become independent: when things go wrong, first ask where you fell short, then look at others.

— Analects 15.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.21

Day 288 of the calendar · every October 15

子曰：君子矜而不争，群而不党。

The Master said: The gentleman is dignified but does not contend; he is sociable but not partisan.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 36: Liu Yan's answer about the character 朋 ("friend") mocked factions. It connects with Confucius's "sociable but not partisan." Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 15.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.22

Day 288 of the calendar · every October 15

子曰：君子不以言举人，不以人废言。

The Master said: The gentleman does not promote a man because of his words, nor reject words because of the man.

Yikonglu's note(chapters 15.21–15.22 discussed together) Today: an old editor receives two manuscripts. One carries a famous name, with beautiful prose and nothing inside; he sends it back. The author of the other has been in prison, and the piece is about teaching people to read behind bars. It is solid, and he runs it as the lead story. Someone asks him: aren't you afraid of gossip? He says: I'm reading the manuscript.

This chapter connects to

See also 5.9: Zai Yu slept in the daytime. The Master said: Rotten wood cannot be carved; a wall of…

— Analects 15.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.23

Day 289 of the calendar · every October 16

子贡问曰：有一言而可以终身行之者乎？子曰：其恕乎！己所不欲，勿施于人。

Zigong asked: Is there one word that one can practice all one's life? The Master said: Is it not reciprocity? What you do not want for yourself, do not do to others.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an old man who lived in an old building hated nothing more than the sound of chairs being dragged upstairs at midnight. The first thing he did in his new home was put felt pads on every chair leg. The neighbors below never heard a sound from his flat, and never knew why.

This chapter connects to

See also 12.2: Zhonggong asked about humaneness. The Master said: Going out the gate, act as if…

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 30 of 38 (previous 15.9, next 17.19)

— Analects 15.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.24

Day 290 of the calendar · every October 17

子曰：吾之于人也，谁毁谁誉？如有所誉者，其有所试矣。斯民也，三代之所以直道而行也。

The Master said: In my dealings with people, whom have I disparaged, whom have I praised? If there is someone I have praised, it is because he has been tested. These people are the same people by whom the Three Dynasties walked the straight Way.

— Analects 15.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.25

Day 291 of the calendar · every October 18

子曰：吾犹及史之阙文也，有马者借人乘之。今亡矣夫！

The Master said: I can still recall when scribes left blanks in their texts, and when those with horses lent them to others to ride. Now that is gone!

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 15.24–15.25 discussed together)** Today: an old editor at a local gazetteer office comes across a year he can't confirm. Rather than fill it in from legend, he leaves the space blank and writes "to be checked." A young colleague thinks it looks ugly. Twenty years later, someone finds the year in another archive and the blank is filled in exactly. The next county's gazetteer had filled in a guess, and later the whole page had to be reprinted.

— Analects 15.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.26

Day 291 of the calendar · every October 18

子曰：巧言乱德，小不忍则乱大谋。

The Master said: Clever words confuse virtue. Lack of patience in small things ruins great plans.

— Analects 15.26 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.26 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.27

Day 292 of the calendar · every October 19

子曰：众恶之，必察焉；众好之，必察焉。

The Master said: When everyone hates someone, you must look into it; when everyone loves someone, you must look into it.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 15.26–15.27 discussed together)** Today: a small shop gets slammed online until it's trending, and everyone piles on. Later someone goes to the shop and checks the security footage: the customer dropped the bowl himself. That same month, a much-praised influencer business owner is found to have paid for fake reviews. Both times, a whole crowd spoke as one, and nobody went to look first.

— Analects 15.27 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.27 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.28

Day 292 of the calendar · every October 19

子曰：人能弘道，非道弘人。

The Master said: It is people who can broaden the Way, not the Way that broadens people.

— Analects 15.28 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.28 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.29

Day 293 of the calendar · every October 20

子曰：过而不改，是谓过矣。

The Master said: To err and not correct it — that is truly to err.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 15.28–15.29 discussed together)** Today: the same copy of the Analects can sit on a shelf for a hundred years and make no one better; it is the reader, putting it into practice line by line, who makes it great. Another case: two programmers each write one wrong line of code. One notices that same day, quietly fixes it, and nothing happens. The other, afraid of losing face, figures that if nobody notices it doesn't matter. Three months later, the whole system goes down for a night.

This chapter connects to

Occasion New Year: For turning the page at New Year: last year's mistakes, once corrected, are behind you. Only if you don't correct them do they become real mistakes.

— Analects 15.29 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.29 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.30

Day 294 of the calendar · every October 21

子曰：吾尝终日不食，终夜不寝，以思，无益，不如学也。

The Master said: I once went all day without eating and all night without sleeping in order to think. It was of no use. It is better to learn.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 20: Laozi says "cut off learning and be free of worry"; Confucius says a whole day of empty thinking is not as good as going to learn.
Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 47: Laozi says "Without going out the door, one knows the world." Confucius instead says thinking without learning is useless.

Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 15.30 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.30 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.31

Day 294 of the calendar · every October 21

子曰：君子谋道不谋食。耕也，馁在其中矣；学也，禄在其中矣。君子忧道不忧贫。

The Master said: The gentleman plans for the Way, not for food. Farm, and hunger may still be there; learn, and a salary may come of it. The gentleman worries about the Way, not about poverty.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 15.30–15.31 discussed together)** Today: a student gets stuck on a math problem and thinks about it from after dinner until midnight, filling sheet after sheet of scrap paper without solving it. The next morning he opens the textbook, and the method is right there in line three of the worked example. He folds up the scrap paper, tucks it into the book, and writes beside it: Check the book first.

— Analects 15.31 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.31 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.32

Day 295 of the calendar · every October 22

子曰：知及之，仁不能守之；虽得之，必失之。知及之，仁能守之，不庄以涖之，则民不敬。知及之，仁能守之，庄以涖之，动之不以礼，未善也。

The Master said: If knowledge reaches it but humaneness cannot hold it, then even if he gains it, he is sure to lose it. If knowledge reaches it and humaneness can hold it, but he does not govern with dignity, the people will not be reverent. If knowledge reaches it, humaneness can hold it, and he governs with dignity, but does not move the people by ritual, it is still not good.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a newly promoted head nurse. She knows the rules better than anyone: that is "knowledge reaches it." She takes the front line on night shifts herself and never takes anything from patients: that is "humaneness can hold it." But on the ward she is always joking around, and the new nurses don't take her words very seriously: she still lacks "approaching them with dignity." Later she stands straighter and speaks more steadily, and she draws up the schedule by the rules, not by who is close to her. The department head says: now it's all there. ---

This chapter connects to

Variant The base text has “涖之”; the standard text has “莅之”

— Analects 15.32 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.32 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.33

Day 296 of the calendar · every October 23

子曰：君子不可小知，而可大受也；小人不可大受，而可小知也。

The Master said: The gentleman cannot be known through small things, but can be entrusted with great ones; the petty man cannot be entrusted with great things, but can be known through small ones.

— Analects 15.33 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.33 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.34

Day 297 of the calendar · every October 24

子曰：民之于仁也，甚于水火。水火，吾见蹈而死者矣，未见蹈仁而死者也。

The Master said: The people need humaneness more than water and fire. I have seen people die stepping into water and fire, but never seen anyone die stepping into humaneness.

— Analects 15.34 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.34 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.35

Day 298 of the calendar · every October 25

子曰：当仁不让于师。

The Master said: When it comes to humaneness, do not yield even to your teacher.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 15.33–15.35 discussed together)** Today: in class, an old professor presenting a case gets a patient's dosage wrong by one decimal place. A student hesitates, then raises his hand and says so. The professor is taken aback, goes home and checks, and opens the next class by saying: I was wrong last time; thank you to this student. As for "not known in small things

but entrusted with great ones": in the same department, the clumsy doctor who can never get a word in at meetings was the one who stayed up all night on the day of the emergency.

— Analects 15.35 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.35 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.36

Day 298 of the calendar · every October 25

子曰：君子贞而不谅。

The Master said: The gentleman is steadfast, but not rigidly bound by small promises.

— Analects 15.36 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.36 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.37

Day 298 of the calendar · every October 25

子曰：事君，敬其事而后其食。

The Master said: In serving a ruler, be reverent in your duties and put your salary last.

Yikonglu's note(chapters 15.36–15.37 discussed together) Today: a bookkeeper's boss privately asks her to promise one thing: don't tell anyone outside about a few entries in the books. She agrees. Later she finds out the books are cooked, to cheat hundreds of small shareholders out of their money. She speaks up. Someone calls her a promise-breaker. She says: I promised to keep a secret, not to help cheat people. Another new colleague, on his first day, asks first "Which part am I responsible for?" and only second "When is payday?" ---

This chapter connects to

Occasion Starting a Job: Do the work in front of you well first, then talk about pay. This doesn't mean you shouldn't talk money. It means pay follows the work you've done. Once the work is done, you can name your price with confidence.

— Analects 15.37 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.37 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.38

Day 299 of the calendar · every October 26

子曰：有教无类。

The Master said: In teaching, there are no classes of people.

> **Yikonglu's note** Teach without regard to rank or background. It means the same as "from those who brought a bundle of dried meat on up, I have never refused instruction": the door is open to everyone.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 35: Cai Wenji and Xie Daoyun could study: teaching was never meant to depend on background. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 27: "Always good at saving people, so no one is cast aside": Confucius too says teaching makes no distinction of background. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 62: “If people are not good, why abandon them?” Confucius likewise said that in teaching there is no distinction of background. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 15.38 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.38 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.39

Day 299 of the calendar · every October 26

子曰：道不同，不相为谋。

The Master said: Those whose ways differ do not make plans together.

> **Yikonglu's note** "Different Ways" means fundamentally different paths, as in good versus evil, right versus wrong. People with different methods or opinions can still plan together; don't use this line to split over small differences.

This chapter connects to

Occasion Farewells: Can be used when your basic paths differ and you can't work together.

Careful Often used to justify splitting over small disagreements. Zhu Xi means the difference between good and evil, right and wrong; different methods or opinions don't count.

— Analects 15.39 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.39 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 15.40

Day 299 of the calendar · every October 26

子曰：辞达而已矣。

The Master said: In words, it is enough that they get the meaning across.

> **Yikonglu's note(chapters 15.38–15.40 discussed together)** Today: a night school in a small town. In the class are a sixty-year-old grandmother learning to read, a young man just out of prison, and a young delivery rider who works days. When the teacher takes attendance, she doesn't look at anyone's background, only at who came today. Another small thing: an appliance manual that says "Turn clockwise until you hear a click" is far more useful than one with a page of "please use an elegant motion."

— Analects 15.40 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.40 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 15.41

Day 300 of the calendar · every October 27

师冕见，及阶，子曰：阶也。及席，子曰：席也。皆坐，子告之曰：某在斯，某在斯。师冕出。子张问曰：与师言之道与？子曰：然。固相师之道也。

Music Master Mian came to see the Master. When he reached the steps, the Master said: Here are the steps. When he reached the mat, the Master said: Here is your mat. When all were seated, the Master told him: So-and-so is here; so-and-so is here. When Music Master Mian had left, Zizhang asked: Is that the way to speak with a music master? The Master said: Yes. That is indeed the way to assist a music master.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: in an art museum, a guide accompanies a blind visitor through an exhibition, speaking softly all the way: three steps ahead there's a step; on your left is a wall, and on it hangs a landscape, with a river flowing from the upper left to the lower right; on your right stands an old gentleman, also looking at this painting. The blind visitor smiles and nods to his right. The old gentleman nods back.

This chapter connects to

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 13 of 20 (previous 15.5, next 17.6)

People Music Master Mian: appears only here

— Analects 15.41 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/15.41 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 16 · Ji shi

Analects 16.1

季氏将伐颛臾。冉有、季路见于孔子曰：季氏将有事于颛臾。孔子曰：求！无乃尔是过与？夫颛臾，昔者先王以为东蒙主，且在邦域之中矣，是社稷之臣也。何以伐为？冉有曰：夫子欲之，吾二臣者皆不欲也。孔子曰：求！周任有言曰：陈力就列，不能者止。危而不持，颠而不扶，则将焉用彼相矣？且尔言过矣。虎兕出于柙，龟玉毁于椟中，是谁之过与？冉有曰：今夫颛臾，固而近于费。今不取，后世必为子孙忧。孔子曰：求！君子疾夫舍曰欲之，而必为之辞。丘也闻有国有家者，不患寡而患不均，不患贫而患不安。盖均无贫，和无寡，安无倾。夫如是，故远人不服，则修文德以来之。既来之，则安之。今由与求也，相夫子，远人不服而不能来也；邦分崩离析而不能守也。而谋动干戈于邦内。吾恐季孙之忧，不在颛臾，而在萧墙之内也。

The Ji family was about to attack Zhuanyu. Ran You and Jilu came to see Confucius and said: The Ji family is about to take action against Zhuanyu. Confucius said: Qiu, is this not your fault? Zhuanyu was long ago made by the former kings the lord of the sacrifices to Mount Dongmeng; moreover, it lies within our borders and is a vassal of the state. Why attack it? Ran You said: Our master wants it; neither of us two ministers does. Confucius said: Qiu, Zhou Ren had a saying: 'Put forth your strength and take your place; if you cannot, step down.' If he is in danger and you do not hold him steady, if he stumbles and you do not support him, what use are you as his helper? And what you say is wrong. When a tiger or rhinoceros escapes from its cage, or tortoiseshell and jade are smashed in their case, whose fault is it? Ran You said: But Zhuanyu is well fortified and close to Bi. If it is not taken now, it will surely trouble his descendants in later generations. Confucius said: Qiu, the gentleman hates those who, instead of

saying 'I want it,' insist on making excuses. I have heard that those who hold a state or a family do not worry about having few people but about unequal shares, do not worry about poverty but about unrest. For where there is equality there is no poverty, where there is harmony there is no shortage of people, where there is peace there is no toppling. That being so, if people far away do not submit, cultivate culture and virtue to attract them; once they have come, give them peace. Now you, You and Qiu, assist your master; people far away do not submit and you cannot attract them; the state is splitting apart and you cannot hold it together; and yet you plan to take up arms within the state. I fear that the Ji family's trouble lies not in Zhuanyu, but within their own walls.

> **Yikonglu's note** "Even" does not mean equal shares but each getting their due. Going by the next line, "with even distribution there is no poverty, with harmony no scarcity," the original probably read "worry not about poverty but about uneven distribution, not about scarcity but about unrest"; the Qing scholar Yu Yue emended it this way. The video follows the received text.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: at a food factory, the manager wants to relabel expired ingredients and keep using them. The head of quality control says at the meeting, "That doesn't seem right." The manager ignores him, and he goes back to his office and signs the release form. When things go wrong, he says: I objected at the time. The investigator pushes the form in front of him: you objected, so why is your name on this?

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: the owner of a small company has his eye on the shop space next door. It's a good location, he says, and if he doesn't take it, a rival will. But in his own company, two partners haven't spoken in six months over profit shares, and wages are two months late. At the meeting, the woman who keeps the books says quietly: I'm afraid our trouble isn't next door.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 35 of 41 (previous 15.3, next 17.5)

People the Ji family: appearance 6 of 7 (previous 13.2, next 18.3)

People Ran You (Ran Qiu): appearance 16 of 16 (previous 14.13)

People Zhou Ren: appears only here

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 27: Disaster often starts close at hand: the Ming fell to its eunuchs, trouble from right inside its own walls. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 46: "No calamity is greater than not knowing contentment": Confucius says that in governing a state, the worry is not scarcity but unequal distribution. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 61: “If a great state places itself below a small state, it wins the small state”; Confucius said that if distant people do not submit, cultivate refinement and virtue to draw them in. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 77: “The Way of Heaven takes from what has surplus to make up what is lacking”; Confucius said not to worry about having little but about its being uneven. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 16.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.2

Day 302 of the calendar · every October 29

孔子曰：天下有道，则礼乐征伐自天子出；天下无道，则礼乐征伐自诸侯出。自诸侯出，盖十世希不失矣；自大夫出，五世希不失矣；陪臣执国命，三世希不失矣。天下有道，则政不在大夫。天下有道，则庶人不议。

Confucius said: When the realm has the Way, ritual, music, and punitive expeditions come from the Son of Heaven; when the realm lacks the Way, they come from the lords. When they come from the lords, it is rare for power not to be lost within ten generations; when from the ministers, rare within five; when retainers of ministers hold the state's commands, rare within three. When the realm has the Way, government does not rest with the ministers. When the realm has the Way, the common people do not debate it.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a residents' committee used to settle everything at a general meeting of owners. Then the chair started deciding alone; later, the chair's relatives took over the parking lot, and the property company's security chief began collecting money for himself. Three sets of people came and went in one year. An old man playing chess downstairs says: when the estate is run properly, all we do is play chess.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 21: What "the royal order fell" looks like: ritual, music and punitive campaigns no longer come from the Son of Heaven. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 24: The Sui "was not passed on again and lost the line": Confucius said long ago that a realm not won by the right way does not last many generations. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 25: Most of the Five Dynasties began with generals seizing the throne, and they often fell within one or two generations. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 16.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.3

Day 303 of the calendar · every October 30

孔子曰：禄之去公室，五世矣；政逮于大夫，四世矣；故夫三桓之子孙，微矣。

Confucius said: It has been five generations since the revenues left the ducal house, and four since government passed to the ministers. That is why the descendants of the Three Huan are in decline.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: two vice presidents team up to sideline the founder, and from then on they decide everything, big and small. Three years later, their own department managers have learned to go around them, signing deals directly with clients and setting up on their own. A vice president pounds the table at a meeting: do you even see me anymore? Nobody says a word.

— Analects 16.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.4

Day 304 of the calendar · every October 31

孔子曰：益者三友，损者三友。友直，友谅，友多闻，益矣。友便辟，友善柔，友便佞，损矣。

Confucius said: There are three kinds of friends who help and three who harm. Friends who are upright, friends who are faithful, friends who know much — they help. Friends who are ingratiating, friends who are fawning, friends who are glib — they harm.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a young man just promoted to team leader finds two kinds of people around him. One kind says "Great talk!" after every meeting. The other kind is just one old colleague, who after a meeting pulls him into

the stairwell and says: you interrupted people three times today. His face burned at the time. Six months later, on the day he is transferred, the only person he takes out to dinner is that old colleague.

This chapter connects to

See also 16.5: Confucius said: There are three kinds of enjoyment that help and three that harm....

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 3: "Draw close to teachers and friends": which friends? Three kinds: the upright, the trustworthy and the well-informed. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 16.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.5

Day 305 of the calendar · every November 1

孔子曰：益者三乐，损者三乐。乐节礼乐，乐道人之善，乐多贤友，益矣。乐骄乐，乐佚游，乐宴乐，损矣。

Confucius said: There are three kinds of enjoyment that help and three that harm. Enjoying the regulation of ritual and music, enjoying speaking of others' good points, enjoying having many worthy friends — they help. Enjoying arrogant pleasures, enjoying idle wandering, enjoying feasting — they harm.

Yikonglu's note Today: two old colleagues, just retired. One joins a choir, rehearses twice a week, and often comes home saying "Lao Wang sang his part beautifully today." The other starts drinking at noon every day and plays cards until midnight, annoyed by anyone who tries to talk him out of it. A year later they run into each other at the market: one looks livelier than a year ago, the other older. ---

This chapter connects to

See also 16.4: Confucius said: There are three kinds of friends who help and three who harm. Friends who...

— Analects 16.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.6

Day 306 of the calendar · every November 2

孔子曰：侍于君子有三愆：言未及之而言谓之躁，言及之而不言谓之隐，未见颜色而言谓之瞽。

Confucius said: In attending a gentleman there are three errors. To speak before it is your turn is called rashness; not to speak when it is your turn is called concealment; to speak without watching his expression is called blindness.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: at a job interview, the candidate jumps in before the interviewer finishes the question, and answers something other than what was asked. Asked why he left his last company, he hems and haws and won't say. The interviewer checks his watch three times, and he is still talking about his university club. All three in one.

— Analects 16.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.7

Day 307 of the calendar · every November 3

孔子曰：君子有三戒：少之时，血气未定，戒之在色；及其壮也，血气方刚，戒之在斗；及其老也，血气既衰，戒之在得。

Confucius said: The gentleman guards against three things. In youth, when the blood and breath are not yet settled, he guards against lust. In his prime, when the blood and breath are strong, he guards against strife. In old age, when the blood and breath have declined, he guards against greed.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a bureau chief close to retirement has gone thirty years without a blemish. In his last two years, he thinks that after a lifetime of hard work, taking a little isn't much, and finding his son a post isn't much either. Three months before retirement, he is taken away. His old college roommate says: when he was twenty, he wouldn't even let someone buy him a meal. ---

This chapter connects to

See also 16.8: Confucius said: The gentleman holds three things in awe: the decree of Heaven, great men,...

See also 16.10: Confucius said: The gentleman has nine things to think about: in seeing, to see clearly;...

Other books Daodejing, ch. 9: "Holding it and filling it to the brim is not as good as stopping": know when to stop. Confucius names things to guard against in three stages: youth, prime and old age. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Birthday Wishes for Elders: Suits the birthday person's own speech: now that I'm old, I remind myself not to be greedy. It's not suitable for the young to use it to lecture their elders.

— Analects 16.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.8

Day 308 of the calendar · every November 4

孔子曰：君子有三畏：畏天命，畏大人，畏圣人之言。小人不知天命而不畏也，狎大人，侮圣人之言。

Confucius said: The gentleman holds three things in awe: the decree of Heaven, great men, and the words of the sages. The petty man does not know the decree of Heaven and so does not hold it in awe; he is overfamiliar with great men and mocks the words of the sages.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: an old doctor with thirty years' experience reads the patient's file from start to finish before every operation. Young doctors laugh at him: you've done this surgery a thousand times. He says: the patient only has this once. Another young doctor scrolls his phone before surgery and jokes to the nurse, "I could do this with my eyes closed." The nurse doesn't laugh.

This chapter connects to

See also 16.7: Confucius said: The gentleman guards against three things. In youth, when the blood and...

Other books Daodejing, ch. 20: "What people fear, one cannot but fear": Confucius says the gentleman holds three things in awe. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 72: “When the people do not fear authority, a great terror arrives”; Confucius said the gentleman holds three things in awe. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 16.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.9

Day 309 of the calendar · every November 5

孔子曰：生而知之者，上也；学而知之者，次也；困而学之，又其次也；困而不学，民斯为下矣。

Confucius said: Those born knowing are the highest; those who learn and come to know are next; those who learn when they meet difficulty are next again; those who meet difficulty and still do not learn — these people are the lowest.

Yikonglu's note Today: a fifty-year-old woman loses her factory job and goes to learn how to run an online shop. The first month she can't even upload a picture, so she writes every step in a notebook and tries again and again. Six months later her shop makes dozens of sales a day. Her former coworker also lost her job, spent six months at home complaining "Everything's so hard nowadays," and learned nothing.

— Analects 16.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.10

Day 310 of the calendar · every November 6

孔子曰：君子有九思：视思明，听思聪，色思温，貌思恭，言思忠，事思敬，疑思问，忿思难，见得思义。

Confucius said: The gentleman has nine things to think about: in seeing, to see clearly; in hearing, to hear keenly; in his expression, to be warm; in his bearing, to be respectful; in his words, to be loyal; in his work, to be reverent; in doubt, to ask; in anger, to think of the consequences; and when seeing gain, to think of what is right.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a bus driver has a fight with his wife at home and leaves still fuming. Before getting on, he stands at the bus door for ten seconds and breathes the anger out, and only then takes the driver's seat. He says: there are forty-some people on that bus; my temper can't come aboard.

This chapter connects to

See also 16.7: Confucius said: The gentleman guards against three things. In youth, when the blood and…

— Analects 16.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.11

Day 311 of the calendar · every November 7

孔子曰：见善如不及，见不善如探汤。吾见其人矣，吾闻其语矣。隐居以求其志，行义以达其道。吾闻其语矣，未见其人也。

Confucius said: 'Seeing good, act as if you could not reach it; seeing evil, act as if testing boiling water.' I have seen such men and heard such words. 'Living in seclusion to pursue one's aims, practicing what is right to fulfill one's Way.' I have heard such words, but have not seen such men.

Yikonglu's note Today: a village teacher had the chance to move to the city when he was young, but stayed in the mountains and taught for thirty years. He filled dozens of notebooks, all about how to help mountain children understand their lessons. The year he retired, the county invited him to lecture to all its teachers. His first words on stage were: I've been preparing this lesson all these years. ---

— Analects 16.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 16.12

Day 312 of the calendar · every November 8

齐景公有马千驷，死之日，民无德而称焉。伯夷叔齐饿于首阳之下，民到于今称之。其斯之谓与?

Duke Jing of Qi had a thousand teams of four horses, yet on the day he died the people found no virtue in him to praise. Boyi and Shuqi starved at the foot of Mount Shouyang, and the people praise them to this day. Is this not what it means?

Yikonglu's note Today: a small town has two stone tablets. One was put up when a businessman donated money to build a road; it bears his name in large characters, and is now covered in moss, ignored by passersby. The other stands by the river, in memory of an old boatman who in several decades pulled more than twenty people out of the water, and who did not come back up the last time he went in. Every Qingming festival, there are flowers in front of it.

This chapter connects to

People Bo Yi: appearance 3 of 4 (previous 7.14, next 18.8)

People Shu Qi: appearance 3 of 4 (previous 7.14, next 18.8)

People Duke Jing of Qi: appearance 2 of 3 (previous 12.11, next 18.3)

— Analects 16.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.13

Day 313 of the calendar · every November 9

陈亢问于伯鱼曰：子亦有异闻乎？对曰：未也。尝独立，鲤趋而过庭。曰：学诗乎？对曰：未也。不学诗，无以言。鲤退而学诗。他日又独立，鲤趋而过庭。曰：学礼乎？对曰：未也。不学礼，无以立。鲤退而学礼。闻斯二者。陈亢退而喜曰：问一得三，闻诗，闻礼，又闻君子之远其子也。

Chen Kang asked Boyu: Have you heard anything different from your father? He replied: Not yet. Once when he was standing alone, I hurried across the courtyard. He said: Have you studied the Odes? I replied: Not yet. Without studying the Odes, you will have nothing to say. I withdrew and studied the Odes. Another day he was again standing alone, and I hurried across the courtyard. He said: Have you studied ritual? I replied: Not yet. Without studying ritual, you will have nothing to stand on. I withdrew and studied ritual. These two things I have heard. Chen Kang withdrew and said happily: I asked one thing and got three: I heard about the Odes, I heard about ritual, and I also heard that the gentleman keeps a distance from his own son.

> **Yikonglu's note** Today: a secondary school principal's son studies at his own school. The whole school assumes the principal gives his son extra lessons. One classmate can't hold back and asks the boy: does your dad go over problems with you at home? The boy says: twice. Once he asked whether I'd finished my essay, and once whether I'd said good morning to the old gatekeeper. The classmate reports back to everyone: relax, he's just like us.

This chapter connects to

People Chen Kang (Ziqin): appearance 2 of 3 (previous 1.10, next 19.25)

People Kong Li (Boyu): appearance 2 of 3 (previous 11.7, next 17.10)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 15: "Ritual and music complete": Confucius's words to his son: without learning ritual, you have nothing to stand on. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion A New Baby: Confucius taught his son Kong Li just two things: study the Songs, or you won't know how to speak; study ritual, or you won't know how to stand. A family motto for a child's first birthday.

Careful Chen Kang thought Confucius had secretly taught his son more, but he hadn't. Confucius taught his son just as he taught his students. This too is worth telling new parents.

— Analects 16.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 16.14

Day 314 of the calendar · every November 10

邦君之妻，君称之曰夫人，夫人自称曰小童；邦人称之曰君夫人，称诸异邦曰寡小君；异邦人称之亦曰君夫人。

The wife of a ruler of a state: the ruler calls her 'Lady'; she calls herself 'little child'; the people of the state call her 'the ruler's Lady'; speaking of her to other states, they call her 'our little ruler'; people of other states also call her 'the ruler's Lady'.

Yikonglu's note Today: the same woman. At home her husband calls her by name, and she calls herself "I"; at work, colleagues call her "Director Liu"; introducing her office to outsiders, she says "our little office"; visitors from other offices also call her "Director Liu." One person, four ways of naming, each kept perfectly clear, and nobody gets them wrong.

— Analects 16.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/16.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 17 · Yang Huo

Analects 17.1

Day 315 of the calendar · every November 11

阳货欲见孔子，孔子不见，归孔子豚。孔子时其亡也，而往拜之，遇诸涂。谓孔子曰：来！予与尔言。曰：怀其宝而迷其邦，可谓仁乎？曰：不可。好从事而亟失时，可谓知乎？曰：不可。日月逝矣，岁不我与。孔子曰：诺。吾将仕矣。

Yang Huo wanted Confucius to come see him, but Confucius would not, so Yang Huo sent Confucius a pig. Confucius chose a time when he was out to go and thank him, but met him on the road. Yang Huo said to Confucius: Come, I will talk with you. Can one who hides his treasure and lets his state go astray be called humane? He said: He cannot. Can one who loves to take part in affairs yet keeps missing his chances be called wise? He said: He cannot. The days and months slip by; the years do not wait for us. Confucius said: Very well. I will take office.

This chapter connects to

See also 17.20: Ru Bei wanted to see Confucius; Confucius declined, pleading illness. As the messenger...

People Yang Huo: appears only here

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 2: The closing line of Beiyao's exhortation to study uses Yang Huo's words urging Confucius to take office: time waits for no one. a commentator's reading

Variant The base text has “遇诸涂”; the standard text has “遇诸途”

— Analects 17.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.2

Day 316 of the calendar · every November 12

子曰：性相近也，习相远也。

The Master said: By nature people are close to one another; by practice they grow far apart.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 1: The two lines "by nature close, by practice far apart" come straight from Confucius's own words. source

— Analects 17.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.3

Day 316 of the calendar · every November 12

子曰：唯上知与下愚不移。

The Master said: Only the wisest and the most foolish do not change.

> **Yikonglu's note** It isn't that they can't change, but that they won't. Only those who give up on themselves do not move.

— Analects 17.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.4

Day 317 of the calendar · every November 13

子之武城，闻弦歌之声。夫子莞尔而笑，曰：割鸡焉用牛刀？子游对曰：昔者偃也闻诸夫子曰：君子学道则爱人，小人学道则易使也。子曰：二三子！偃之言是也。前言戏之耳。

The Master went to Wucheng and heard the sound of strings and singing. The Master smiled and said: Why use an ox knife to kill a chicken? Ziyou replied: Some time ago I heard you say, Master: 'When the gentleman learns the Way, he loves others; when the petty man learns the Way, he is easy to employ.' The Master said: My friends, what Yan says is right. What I said before was only a joke.

This chapter connects to

See also 17.7: Bi Xi summoned the Master, and the Master wanted to go. Zilu said: Some time ago I heard…

People Ziyou (Yan Yan): appearance 5 of 8 (previous 11.2, next 19.12)

— Analects 17.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.5

Day 318 of the calendar · every November 14

公山弗扰以费畔，召，子欲往。子路不说，曰：末之也已，何必公山氏之之也。子曰：夫召我者而岂徒哉？如有用我者，吾其为东周乎？

Gongshan Furao held Bi in revolt and summoned the Master, and the Master wanted to go. Zilu was displeased and said: If there is nowhere to go, then do not go. Why must you go to Gongshan? The Master said: Would the one who summons me do so for nothing? If anyone would employ me, could I not make a Zhou in the east?

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 36 of 41 (previous 16.1, next 17.7)

People Gongshan Furao: appears only here

— Analects 17.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.6

Day 319 of the calendar · every November 15

子张问仁于孔子。孔子曰：能行五者于天下，为仁矣。请问之。曰：恭、宽、信、敏、惠。恭则不侮，宽则得众，信则人任焉，敏则有功，惠则足以使人。

Zizhang asked Confucius about humaneness. Confucius said: One who can practice five things throughout the world is humane. He asked what they were. Respect, generosity, good faith, diligence, and kindness. With respect, you will not be insulted; with generosity, you will win the many; with good faith, others will rely on you; with diligence, you will achieve results; with kindness, you will be able to employ others.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about humaneness — Asked 8 times; see also 6.20 “The humane put the hard part first and the reward after” · 12.1 “To restrain oneself and return to ritual is humaneness” · 12.2 “What you do not want for yourself, do not do to others” · 12.3 “The humane are slow to speak” · 12.22 “Love people” · 13.19 “Be respectful at home, reverent in your work, loyal to others” · 15.9 “Serve the worthiest of its officials, befriend the most humane of its scholars” (the question was how to practice humaneness)

See also 20.1: Yao said: Ah, you, Shun! The succession ordained by Heaven rests in your person. Hold…

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 14 of 20 (previous 15.41, next 19.1)

— Analects 17.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.7

Day 320 of the calendar · every November 16

佛肸召，子欲往。子路曰：昔者由也闻诸夫子曰：亲于其身为不善者，君子不入也。佛肸以中牟畔，子之往也，如之何！子曰：然。有是言也。不曰坚乎，磨而不磷；不曰白乎，涅而不缁。吾岂匏瓜也哉？焉能系而不食？

Bi Xi summoned the Master, and the Master wanted to go. Zilu said: Some time ago I heard you say, Master: 'A gentleman does not enter the domain of one who personally does wrong.' Bi Xi holds Zhongmou in revolt. How can you go to him? The Master said: Yes, I did say that. But is it not said that what is truly hard can be ground without being worn thin, and what is truly white can be dyed without turning black? Am I a bitter gourd, to hang there and not be eaten?

This chapter connects to

See also 17.4: The Master went to Wucheng and heard the sound of strings and singing. The Master smiled…

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 37 of 41 (previous 17.5, next 17.8)

People Bi Xi: appears only here

— Analects 17.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.8

Day 321 of the calendar · every November 17

子曰：由也，女闻六言六蔽矣乎？对曰：未也。居！吾语女。好仁不好学，其蔽也愚；好知不好学，其蔽也荡；好信不好学，其蔽也贼；好直不好学，其蔽也绞；好勇不好学，其蔽也乱；好刚不好学，其蔽也狂。

The Master said: You, have you heard of the six words and their six flaws? He replied: Not yet. Sit down; I will tell you. Loving humaneness without loving learning, the flaw is foolishness. Loving wisdom without loving learning, the flaw is aimlessness. Loving good faith without loving learning, the flaw is doing harm. Loving straightness without loving learning, the flaw is harshness. Loving courage without loving learning, the flaw is disorder. Loving firmness without loving learning, the flaw is recklessness.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 38 of 41 (previous 17.7, next 17.23)

— Analects 17.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.9

Day 322 of the calendar · every November 18

子曰：小子！何莫学夫诗？诗，可以兴，可以观，可以群，可以怨。迩之事父，远之事君。多识于鸟兽草木之名。

The Master said: My young friends, why does none of you study the Odes? The Odes can rouse you, help you observe, help you live with others, and let you voice complaints. Near at hand, they teach you to serve your father; further off, to serve your ruler. And you learn many names of birds, beasts, plants, and trees.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 16: Why "recite and chant" the Songs: Beiyao cites this very chapter. a commentator's reading

— Analects 17.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.10

Day 323 of the calendar · every November 19

子谓伯鱼曰：女为周南召南矣乎？人而不为周南召南，其犹正墙面而立也与？

The Master said to Boyu: Have you studied the Zhounan and Shaonan? A man who has not studied the Zhounan and Shaonan is like one standing with his face right up against a wall!

This chapter connects to

People Kong Li (Boyu): appearance 3 of 3 (previous 16.13)

— Analects 17.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.11

Day 324 of the calendar · every November 20

子曰：礼云礼云，玉帛云乎哉？乐云乐云，钟鼓云乎哉？

The Master said: Ritual, they say, ritual — is it only jade and silk? Music, they say, music — is it only bells and drums?

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 10: Music is more than bells and drums; read this alongside the "eight sounds". Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 38: Emperor Xuanzong of Tang explains "Ritual is the thinning of loyalty and trust" by citing Confucius: is ritual just jade and silk? a commentator's reading

— Analects 17.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.12

Day 325 of the calendar · every November 21

子曰：色厉而内荏，譬诸小人，其犹穿窬之盗也与?

The Master said: Stern in appearance but weak within — among petty men, he is like a thief who bores through walls!

— Analects 17.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.13

Day 325 of the calendar · every November 21

子曰：乡原，德之贼也。

The Master said: The village worthy is the thief of virtue.

This chapter connects to

Do not use Naming: Avoid in names: “village worthy” (乡原), called “the thief of virtue”

Variant The base text has “乡原”; the standard text has “乡愿”

— Analects 17.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.14

Day 325 of the calendar · every November 21

子曰：道听而涂说，德之弃也。

The Master said: To hear something on the road and repeat it along the way is to throw virtue away.

This chapter connects to

Variant The base text has “道听而涂说”; the standard text has “道听而途说”

— Analects 17.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.15

Day 326 of the calendar · every November 22

子曰：鄙夫可与事君也与哉？其未得之也，患得之；既得之，患失之。苟患失之，无所不至矣。

The Master said: Can one serve a ruler alongside a base man? Before he gets it, he worries about getting it; once he has it, he worries about losing it. If he worries about losing it, there is nothing he will not do.

This chapter connects to

Other books Daodejing, ch. 13: "Alarmed by favor and disgrace alike": before getting it, afraid of not getting it; once it is got, afraid of losing it. This is what Confucius calls a "base fellow". Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 17.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.16

Day 327 of the calendar · every November 23

子曰：古者民有三疾，今也或是之亡也。古之狂也肆，今之狂也荡；古之矜也廉，今之矜也忿戾；古之愚也直，今之愚也诈而已矣。

The Master said: In ancient times, people had three failings; now perhaps even these are gone. The wild of old were unrestrained; the wild of today are dissolute. The proud of old were scrupulous; the proud of today are quarrelsome. The foolish of old were straightforward; the foolish of today are simply deceitful.

— Analects 17.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.17

Day 328 of the calendar · every November 24

子曰：巧言令色，鲜矣仁。

The Master said: Clever words and an ingratiating look — seldom are they humane.

This chapter connects to

See also 1.3: The Master said: Clever words and a pleasing face — rarely is there humaneness in them.

See also 5.24: The Master said: Fine words, an ingratiating face, excessive deference — Zuoqiu Ming was…

— Analects 17.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.18

Day 328 of the calendar · every November 24

子曰：恶紫之夺朱也，恶郑声之乱雅乐也，恶利口之覆邦家者。

The Master said: I hate purple taking the place of vermilion; I hate the tunes of Zheng confusing proper music; I hate sharp tongues that overturn states and families.

— Analects 17.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.19

Day 329 of the calendar · every November 25

子曰：予欲无言。子贡曰：子如不言，则小子何述焉？子曰：天何言哉？四时行焉，百物生焉，天何言哉？

The Master said: I would rather not speak. Zigong said: If you do not speak, Master, what will we disciples pass on? The Master said: Does Heaven speak? The four seasons go round, and all things are born. Does Heaven speak?

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 31 of 38 (previous 15.23, next 17.24)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 6: "These four seasons turn without end": Heaven says nothing, yet the seasons run their course. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 1: Laozi said the Way cannot be spoken. Confucius also said Heaven never speaks, yet the four seasons run on. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 43: "Teaching without words": Confucius also says Heaven does not speak, yet the four seasons still run their course. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Daodejing, ch. 73: Su Zhe, explaining "The Way of Heaven does not contend yet excels at winning, does not speak yet excels at responding," quotes Confucius's "What does Heaven say?" a commentator's reading

— Analects 17.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.20

Day 330 of the calendar · every November 26

孺悲欲见孔子，孔子辞以疾。将命者出户，取瑟而歌。使之闻之。

Ru Bei wanted to see Confucius; Confucius declined, pleading illness. As the messenger went out the door, he took up his zither and sang, making sure he heard it.

This chapter connects to

See also 17.1: Yang Huo wanted Confucius to come see him, but Confucius would not, so Yang Huo sent…

People Ru Bei: appears only here

People The messenger: appears only here

— Analects 17.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.21

Day 331 of the calendar · every November 27

宰我问：三年之丧，期已久矣。君子三年不为礼，礼必坏；三年不为乐，乐必崩。旧谷既没，新谷既升，钻燧改火，期可已矣。子曰：食夫稻，衣夫锦，于女安乎？曰：安。女安则为之！夫君子之居丧，食旨不甘，闻乐不乐，居处不安，故不为也。今女安，则为之！宰我出。子曰：予之不仁也！子生三年，然后免于父母之怀。夫三年之丧，天下之通丧也。予也有三年之爱于其父母乎？

Zai Wo asked: Three years of mourning — a year is already long enough. If a gentleman does not practice ritual for three years, ritual will surely decay; if he does not practice music for three years, music will surely collapse. The old grain is used up, the new grain has risen, the fire-drilling woods have gone round — a year should be enough. The Master said: Eating that rice and wearing that brocade — would you be at ease? He said: I would. If you would be at ease, then do it! When a gentleman is in mourning, fine food has no taste, music gives no joy, and his home gives no comfort, so he does not do these things. Now if you are at ease, then do it! Zai Wo went out. The Master said: How inhumane Yu is! A child is three years old before it leaves its parents' arms. Three years of mourning is the mourning common to all under Heaven. Did Yu not have three years of love from his parents?

This chapter connects to

People Zai Wo (Zai Yu): appearance 5 of 5 (previous 11.2)

Occasion A New Baby: Only after three years does a child leave its parents' arms. New parents reading this while up at night with the baby will see that they too were carried this way.

Careful This comes from Confucius's argument with Zai Wo over three years of mourning; originally it's about what we owe our parents. It's fine alone on a card,

but don't include the mourning context around it.

— Analects 17.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.22

Day 332 of the calendar · every November 28

子曰：饱食终日，无所用心，难矣哉！不有博弈者乎，为之犹贤乎已。

The Master said: To eat one's fill all day and give one's mind to nothing — that is hard indeed! Are there not games like bo and yi? Playing them would still be better than nothing.

This chapter connects to

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 37: "People who do not learn are worse than creatures": the Zengzhu commentary uses this saying of Confucius.
a commentator's reading

— Analects 17.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.23

Day 333 of the calendar · every November 29

子路曰：君子尚勇乎？子曰：君子义以为上。君子有勇而无义为乱，小人有勇而无义为盗。

Zilu said: Does the gentleman esteem courage? The Master said: The gentleman holds what is right as highest. A gentleman with courage but without rightness makes trouble; a petty man with courage but without rightness becomes a robber.

This chapter connects to

See also 15.17: The Master said: The gentleman takes what is right as his substance, carries it out…

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 39 of 41 (previous 17.8, next 18.6)

— Analects 17.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.24

Day 334 of the calendar · every November 30

子贡曰：君子亦有恶乎？子曰：有恶：恶称人之恶者，恶居下流而讪上者，恶勇而无礼者，恶果敢而窒者。曰：赐也亦有恶乎？恶徼以为知者，恶不孙以为勇者，恶讦以为直者。

Zigong said: Does the gentleman also have things he hates? The Master said: He does. He hates those who speak of others' faults; he hates those in low places who slander those above; he hates the brave who lack ritual; he hates the bold who are obstinate. He said: Ci, do you also have things you hate? I hate those who take prying for wisdom, those who take insolence for courage, and those who take exposing others for honesty.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 32 of 38 (previous 17.19, next 19.20)

— Analects 17.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.25

Day 335 of the calendar · every December 1

子曰：唯女子与小人为难养也，近之则不孙，远之则怨。

The Master said: Women and petty men are the hardest to deal with. Keep them close and they become insolent; keep them at a distance and they resent it.

> **Yikonglu's note** "Women and petty people" means the servants and concubines of a household. The line carries the prejudice of its era; Yikonglu neither makes excuses for Confucius nor joins the abuse online.

— Analects 17.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 17.26

Day 335 of the calendar · every December 1

子曰：年四十而见恶焉，其终也已。

The Master said: One who is still disliked at forty will end that way.

— Analects 17.26 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/17.26 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 18 · Weizi

Analects 18.1

Day 336 of the calendar · every December 2

微子去之，箕子为之奴，比干谏而死。孔子曰：殷有三仁焉。

The Viscount of Wei left, the Viscount of Ji became a slave, and Bi Gan remonstrated and died. Confucius said: Yin had three humane men.

This chapter connects to

People Weizi: appears only here

People Jizi: appears only here

People Bigan: appears only here

People Zhou of Shang: appearance 1 of 2 (next 19.20)

— Analects 18.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/18.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 18.2

Day 337 of the calendar · every December 3

柳下惠为士师，三黜。人曰：子未可以去乎？曰：直道而事人，焉往而不三黜？枉道而事人，何必去父母之邦？

Liuxia Hui served as chief judge and was dismissed three times. Someone said: Is it not time for you to leave? He said: If I serve others by the straight Way, where could I go and not be dismissed three times? If I serve others by a crooked Way, why should I leave the land of my parents?

This chapter connects to

People Liuxia Hui: appearance 2 of 3 (previous 15.13, next 18.8)

People Someone who spoke to Liuxia Hui: appears only here

— Analects 18.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/18.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 18.3

Day 338 of the calendar · every December 4

齐景公待孔子，曰：若季氏则吾不能，以季、孟之闲待之。曰：吾老矣，不能用也。孔子行。

Duke Jing of Qi, discussing how to treat Confucius, said: I cannot treat him as the Ji family is treated; I will treat him somewhere between the Ji and the Meng. Then he said: I am old; I cannot make use of him. Confucius left.

This chapter connects to

People the Ji family: appearance 7 of 7 (previous 16.1)

People Duke Jing of Qi: appearance 3 of 3 (previous 16.12)

People the Meng family: appearance 1 of 2 (next 19.19)

Variant The base text has “季孟之閒”; the standard text has “季孟之间”

— Analects 18.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/18.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 18.4

Day 338 of the calendar · every December 4

齐人归女乐，季桓子受之。三日不朝，孔子行。

The people of Qi sent a troupe of female musicians, and Ji Huanzi accepted them. For three days no court was held, and Confucius left.

This chapter connects to

People Ji Huanzi: appears only here

— Analects 18.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/18.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 18.5

Day 339 of the calendar · every December 5

楚狂接輿歌而过孔子曰：凤兮！凤兮！何德之衰？往者不可谏，来者犹可追。已而，已而！今之从政者殆而！孔子下，欲与之言。趋而辟之，不得与之言。

Jieyu, the madman of Chu, passed Confucius singing: Phoenix! Phoenix! How your virtue has declined! What is past cannot be corrected; what is to come can still be pursued. Give it up, give it up! Those who govern today are in peril! Confucius got down, wanting to speak with him, but he hurried away to avoid him, and Confucius could not speak with him.

This chapter connects to

People Jieyu: appears only here

Occasion Farewells: For someone changing jobs or cities: the past can't be changed; the future is still within reach.

Careful This was sung to Confucius by Jieyu, a recluse of Chu, urging him to stop traveling about seeking office; when Confucius wanted to speak with him, he slipped away. Fine to borrow for a farewell, but don't present it as Confucius's words.

— Analects 18.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/18.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 18.6

Day 340 of the calendar · every December 6

长沮、桀溺耦而耕，孔子过之，使子路问津焉。长沮曰：夫执舆者为谁？子路曰：为孔丘。曰：是鲁孔丘与？曰：是也。曰：是知津矣。问于桀溺，桀溺曰：子为谁？曰：为仲由。曰：是鲁孔丘之徒与？对曰：然。曰：滔滔者天下皆是也，而谁以易之？且而与其从辟人之士也，岂若从辟世之士哉？耰而不辍。子路行以告。夫子怃然曰：鸟兽不可与同群，吾非斯人之徒与而谁与？天下有道，丘不与易也。

Changju and Jieni were ploughing side by side. Confucius passed by and sent Zilu to ask them where the ford was. Changju said: Who is that holding the reins? Zilu said: It is Kong Qiu. Is it Kong Qiu of Lu? It is. Then he knows where the ford is. Zilu asked Jieni. Jieni said: Who are you? I am Zhong You. Are you a follower of Kong Qiu of Lu? He replied: I am. The whole world is a rushing flood, and who can change it? Rather than follow a man who avoids certain people, would you not do better to follow a man who avoids the whole world? And he went on covering the seed without stopping. Zilu went and reported this. The Master said sadly: One cannot flock with birds and beasts. If I do not associate with these people, with whom should I associate? If the world had the Way, I would not be trying to change it.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 40 of 41 (previous 17.23, next 18.7)

People Changju: appears only here

People Jieni: appears only here

— Analects 18.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/18.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 18.7

Day 341 of the calendar · every December 7

子路从而后，遇丈人，以杖荷蓧。子路问曰：子见夫子乎？丈人曰：四体不勤，五谷不分。孰为夫子？植其杖而芸。子路拱而立。止子路宿，杀鸡为黍而食之，见其二子焉。明日，子路行以告。子曰：隐者也。使子路反见之。至则行矣。子路曰：不仕无义。长幼之节，不可废也；君臣之义，如之何其废之？欲洁其身，而乱大伦。君子之仕也，行其义也。道之不行，已知之矣。

Zilu, following the Master, fell behind and met an old man carrying a basket on his staff. Zilu asked: Have you seen my master? The old man said: Your four limbs do no work, you cannot tell the five grains apart — who is your master? He planted his staff and began weeding. Zilu stood with his hands folded. The old man kept Zilu for the night, killed a chicken, cooked millet, fed him, and introduced his two sons. The next day Zilu went on and reported this. The Master said: He is a recluse. He sent Zilu back to see him, but when he arrived the man had gone. Zilu said: Not to serve is not right. The proper order between old and young cannot be discarded; how can the duty between ruler and minister be discarded? Wishing to keep himself pure, he throws the great relationships into disorder. A gentleman serves in order to do what is right. That the Way does not prevail, he already knows.

> **Yikonglu's note** This is the old man with the basket criticizing Zilu: you don't work with your four limbs, you can't tell the five grains apart, so who is your teacher? Some Qing scholars read it as the old man speaking of himself; it is worth noting as an alternative.

This chapter connects to

People Zilu (Zhong You): appearance 41 of 41 (previous 18.6)

People The old man with the basket: appears only here

People The old man's first son: appears only here

People The old man's second son: appears only here

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 8: The six grains lead straight to the old man with the basket: "Your four limbs do no work, and you cannot tell the five grains apart." Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 18.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/18.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 18.8

Day 342 of the calendar · every December 8

逸民：伯夷、叔齐、虞仲、夷逸、朱张、柳下惠、少连。子曰：不降其志，不辱其身，伯夷、叔齐与？谓：柳下惠、少连，降志辱身矣。言中伦，行中虑，其斯而已矣。谓：虞仲、夷逸，隐居放言。身中清，废中权。我则异于是，无可无不可。

Men who withdrew from the world: Boyi, Shuqi, Yuzhong, Yiyi, Zhu Zhang, Liuxia Hui, Shaolian. The Master said: Not lowering their aims nor disgracing themselves — that was Boyi and Shuqi. Of Liuxia Hui and Shaolian he said: They lowered their aims and disgraced themselves, but their words accorded with reason and their conduct with forethought — that was all. Of Yuzhong and Yiyi he said: They lived in seclusion and spoke freely; their persons were pure, and their withdrawal was well judged. I am different from all of them: for me there is nothing that must be done and nothing that must not be done.

This chapter connects to

People Bo Yi: appearance 4 of 4 (previous 16.12)

People Shu Qi: appearance 4 of 4 (previous 16.12)

People Liuxia Hui: appearance 3 of 3 (previous 18.2)

People Yuzhong: appears only here

People Yi Yi: appears only here

People Zhu Zhang: appears only here

People Shao Lian: appears only here

Other books Daodejing, ch. 34: Su Zhe explains "The great Way flows everywhere; it can go left or right" with Confucius's words about himself: "nothing I must do, nothing I must not do." a commentator's reading

— Analects 18.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/18.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 18.9

Day 343 of the calendar · every December 9

大师挚适齐，亚饭干适楚，三饭缭适蔡，四饭缺适秦。鼓方叔入于河，播鼗武入于汉，少师阳、击磬襄入于海。

Grand Music Master Zhi went to Qi; Gan, master of the second meal, went to Chu; Liao, master of the third meal, went to Cai; Que, master of the fourth meal, went to Qin. Fangshu the drummer went to the Yellow River region; Wu, player of the hand drum, went to the Han; Yang, the assistant music master, and Xiang, player of the stone chimes, went to the coast.

This chapter connects to

People Music Master Zhi: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 8.15)

People Gan, musician for the second meal: appears only here

People Liao, musician for the third meal: appears only here

People Que, musician for the fourth meal: appears only here

People Fangshu the drummer: appears only here

People Wu of the hand drum: appears only here

People Yang, the assistant music master: appears only here

People Xiang the chime player: appears only here

— Analects 18.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/18.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 18.10

Day 344 of the calendar · every December 10

周公谓鲁公曰：君子不施其亲。不使大臣怨乎不以。故旧无大故，则不弃也。无求备于一人。

The Duke of Zhou said to the Duke of Lu: The gentleman does not neglect his kin. He does not give the great ministers cause to resent not being used. Old friends, unless there is a grave reason, he does not cast off. He does not expect everything of one person.

This chapter connects to

People the Duke of Zhou: appearance 4 of 4 (previous 11.16)

People Duke of Lu (Boqin): appears only here

— Analects 18.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/18.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 18.11

Day 345 of the calendar · every December 11

周有八士：伯达、伯适、仲突、仲忽、叔夜、叔夏、季随、季騧。

Zhou had eight scholars: Boda, Bokuo, Zhongtu, Zhonghu, Shuye, Shuxia, Jisui, and Jigua.

This chapter connects to

People Bo Da: appears only here

People Bo Kuo: appears only here

People Zhong Tu: appears only here

People Zhong Hu: appears only here

People Shu Ye: appears only here

People Shu Xia: appears only here

People Ji Sui: appears only here

People Ji Gua: appears only here

— Analects 18.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/18.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 19 · Zizhang

Analects 19.1

Day 346 of the calendar · every December 12

子张曰：士见危致命，见得思义，祭思敬，丧思哀，其可已矣。

Zizhang said: A scholar who, seeing danger, offers his life; seeing gain, thinks of what is right; at sacrifices, thinks of reverence; in mourning, thinks of grief — such a one will do.

This chapter connects to

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 15 of 20 (previous 17.6, next 19.2)

— Analects 19.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.2

Day 346 of the calendar · every December 12

子张曰：执德不弘，信道不笃，焉能为有？焉能为亡？

Zizhang said: One who holds to virtue but not broadly, who believes in the Way but not firmly — how can it be said he has it? How can it be said he lacks it?

This chapter connects to

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 16 of 20 (previous 19.1, next 19.3)

— Analects 19.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.3

Day 347 of the calendar · every December 13

子夏之门人问交于子张。子张曰：子夏云何？对曰：子夏曰：可者与之，其不可者拒之。子张曰：异乎吾所闻：君子尊贤而容众，嘉善而矜不能。我之大贤与，于人何所不容？我之不贤与，人将拒我，如之何其拒人也？

Zixia's disciples asked Zizhang about making friends. Zizhang said: What does Zixia say? They replied: Zixia says, 'Associate with those who are suitable; reject those who are not.' Zizhang said: That is different from what I have heard. The gentleman honors the worthy and embraces the many; he praises the good and pities those who lack ability. If I am greatly worthy, whom could I not embrace? If I am not worthy, others will reject me — how could I reject others?

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 10 of 20 (previous 13.17, next 19.4)

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 17 of 20 (previous 19.2, next 19.15)

People Zixia's disciples: appears only here

— Analects 19.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.4

Day 348 of the calendar · every December 14

子夏曰：虽小道，必有可观者焉；致远恐泥，是以君子不为也。

Zixia said: Even minor arts surely have something worth seeing; but if pursued far, one fears getting bogged down. That is why the gentleman does not pursue them.

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 11 of 20 (previous 19.3, next 19.5)

— Analects 19.4 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.4 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.5

Day 348 of the calendar · every December 14

子夏曰：日知其所亡，月无忘其所能，可谓好学也已矣。

Zixia said: One who each day learns what he did not know, and each month does not forget what he has mastered, may be called fond of learning.

This chapter connects to

See also 1.14: The Master said: A gentleman does not seek to eat his fill or live in comfort; he is…

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 12 of 20 (previous 19.4, next 19.6)

Occasion Starting School: Can be made into a term plan: each day learn one thing you don't know; each month look back to make sure you haven't forgotten what you know. 亡 is the same as 无, read wú.

— Analects 19.5 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.5 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.6

Day 349 of the calendar · every December 15

子夏曰：博学而笃志，切问而近思，仁在其中矣。

Zixia said: Learn broadly and keep your aims firm; ask earnestly and reflect on what is close at hand. Humaneness lies in this.

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 13 of 20 (previous 19.5, next 19.7)

Occasion Naming: Possible names: Duzhi 笃志, Jinsi 近思, Qiewen 切问, Boxue 博学. Jinsi means starting your thinking from what is close to you, not “thinking shallowly.”

— Analects 19.6 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.6 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.7

Day 350 of the calendar · every December 16

子夏曰：百工居肆以成其事，君子学以致其道。

Zixia said: The hundred artisans stay in their workshops to complete their work; the gentleman learns in order to reach his Way.

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 14 of 20 (previous 19.6, next 19.8)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 3: Craftsmen make their wares in the workshop; the gentleman reaches the Way through learning. This follows on from "If people do not learn, they do not know what is right."

Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 19.7 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.7 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.8

Day 350 of the calendar · every December 16

子夏曰：小人之过也必文。

Zixia said: When the petty man errs, he is sure to gloss it over.

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 15 of 20 (previous 19.7, next 19.9)

— Analects 19.8 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.8 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.9

Day 350 of the calendar · every December 16

子夏曰：君子有三变：望之俨然，即之也温，听其言也厉。

Zixia said: The gentleman has three aspects. From afar he looks stern; up close he is warm; when you hear him speak, he is exacting.

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 16 of 20 (previous 19.8, next 19.10)

— Analects 19.9 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.9 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.10

Day 351 of the calendar · every December 17

子夏曰：君子信而后劳其民，未信则以为厉己也；信而后谏，未信则以为谤己也。

Zixia said: The gentleman wins the trust of his people before he works them; without their trust, they will think he is oppressing them. He wins trust before he remonstrates; without trust, the ruler will think he is slandering him.

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 17 of 20 (previous 19.9, next 19.11)

— Analects 19.10 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.10 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.11

Day 351 of the calendar · every December 17

子夏曰：大德不逾闲，小德出入可也。

Zixia said: In great matters of virtue, do not overstep the bounds; in small matters, some leeway is acceptable.

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 18 of 20 (previous 19.10, next 19.12)

— Analects 19.11 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.11 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.12

Day 352 of the calendar · every December 18

子游曰：子夏之门人小子，当洒扫、应对、进退，则可矣。抑末也，本之则无。如之何？子夏闻之曰：噫！言游过矣！君子之道，孰先传焉？孰后倦焉？譬诸草木，区以别矣。君子之道，焉可诬也？有始有卒者，其惟圣人乎！

Ziyou said: Zixia's disciples and young followers are fine when it comes to sprinkling and sweeping, answering and responding, coming forward and withdrawing. But these are mere branches; of the root they have nothing. What about that? Zixia heard this and said: Ah, Yan You is mistaken! In the way of the gentleman, what is to be taught first, and what is to be left until later? It is like plants, which are sorted into kinds. How can the way of the gentleman be falsified? Having both beginning and end — only the sage, perhaps!

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 19 of 20 (previous 19.11, next 19.13)

People Ziyou (Yan Yan): appearance 6 of 8 (previous 17.4, next 19.14)

— Analects 19.12 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.12 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.13

Day 353 of the calendar · every December 19

子夏曰：仕而优则学，学而优则仕。

Zixia said: When one in office has energy to spare, he should learn; when one who learns has energy to spare, he should take office.

> **Yikonglu's note** 优 here means having strength to spare, not excellence. With strength to spare in office, study; with strength to spare in study, take office.

This chapter connects to

People Zixia (Bu Shang): appearance 20 of 20 (previous 19.12)

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 30: "Though already in office, they studied diligently": if office leaves you energy to spare, keep studying. Yikonglu's comparison

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 38: "Learn when young, act when grown": learning and doing take turns throughout life. Yikonglu's comparison

Occasion Graduation: A graduation speech can use the original sense: if you do your work well and have energy to spare, keep learning; if you learn well and have energy to spare, go and work. Learning and doing alternate all your life.

Careful You 优 means having energy to spare, not “excellent grades.” It is often taken as “those who study well should become officials,” which reads it backward.

— Analects 19.13 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.13 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Analects 19.14

Day 353 of the calendar · every December 19

子游曰：丧致乎哀而止。

Ziyou said: In mourning, carry grief to its fullest, and stop there.

This chapter connects to

People Ziyou (Yan Yan): appearance 7 of 8 (previous 19.12, next 19.15)

Occasion Mourning: To comfort a bereaved family: grieve fully, then stop; don't harm your own health.

Careful Zhu Xi felt the words "and stop there" were a little too brief, and feared people would use them to skip the finer points of ritual.

— Analects 19.14 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.14 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.15

Day 353 of the calendar · every December 19

子游曰：吾友张也，为难能也。然而未仁。

Ziyou said: My friend Zhang does what is hard to do. Yet he is not yet humane.

This chapter connects to

People Ziyou (Yan Yan): appearance 8 of 8 (previous 19.14)

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 18 of 20 (previous 19.3, next 19.16)

— Analects 19.15 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.15 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.16

Day 354 of the calendar · every December 20

曾子曰：堂堂乎张也，难与并为仁矣。

Zengzi said: How imposing Zhang is! It is hard to practice humaneness alongside him.

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 12 of 15 (previous 14.28, next 19.17)

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 19 of 20 (previous 19.15, next 20.2)

— Analects 19.16 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.16 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.17

Day 354 of the calendar · every December 20

曾子曰：吾闻诸夫子：人未有自致者也，必也亲丧乎！

Zengzi said: I have heard from the Master: People never give themselves fully — except, surely, at the mourning of their parents!

This chapter connects to

See also 19.18: Zengzi said: I have heard from the Master: As for the filial piety of Meng Zhuangzi, the…

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 13 of 15 (previous 19.16, next 19.18)

— Analects 19.17 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.17 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.18

Day 355 of the calendar · every December 21

曾子曰：吾闻诸夫子：孟庄子之孝也，其他可能也；其不改父之臣，与父之政，是难能也。

Zengzi said: I have heard from the Master: As for the filial piety of Meng Zhuangzi, the rest of it others could manage; but his not changing his father's ministers or his father's policies — that is hard to manage.

This chapter connects to

See also 19.17: Zengzi said: I have heard from the Master: People never give themselves fully — except,…

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 14 of 15 (previous 19.17, next 19.19)

People Meng Zhuangzi: appears only here

People Meng Xianzi: appears only here

— Analects 19.18 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.18 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.19

Day 356 of the calendar · every December 22

孟氏使阳肤为士师，问于曾子。曾子曰：上失其道，民散久矣。如得其情，则哀矜而勿喜。

The Meng family made Yang Fu chief judge, and he asked Zengzi for advice. Zengzi said: Those above have lost the Way, and the people have long been scattered. If you get at the truth of a case, feel grief and pity, and do not rejoice.

This chapter connects to

People Zengzi (Zeng Shen): appearance 15 of 15 (previous 19.18)

People the Meng family: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 18.3)

People Yang Fu: appears only here

— Analects 19.19 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.19 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.20

Day 357 of the calendar · every December 23

子贡曰：纣之不善，不如是之甚也。是以君子恶居下流，天下之恶皆归焉。

Zigong said: Zhou's wickedness was not as extreme as they say. That is why the gentleman hates to dwell in low places, where all the evils of the world flow together.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 33 of 38 (previous 17.24, next 19.21)

People Zhou of Shang: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 18.1)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 61: “A great state is the lower reaches of the river”: Zigong said the gentleman most dreads dwelling in the lower reaches, yet Laozi wants a great state to be content there. Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 19.20 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.20 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.21

Day 358 of the calendar · every December 24

子贡曰：君子之过也，如日月之食焉：过也，人皆见之；更也，人皆仰之。

Zigong said: The faults of the gentleman are like eclipses of the sun and moon. When he errs, everyone sees it; when he corrects it, everyone looks up to him.

This chapter connects to

See also 7.30: The Minister of Crime of Chen asked whether Duke Zhao knew ritual. Confucius said: He…

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 34 of 38 (previous 19.20, next 19.22)

— Analects 19.21 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.21 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.22

Day 359 of the calendar · every December 25

卫公孙朝问于子贡曰：仲尼焉学？子贡曰：文武之道，未坠于地，在人。贤者识其大者，不贤者识其小者，莫不有文武之道焉。夫子焉不学？而亦何常师之有？

Gongsun Chao of Wei asked Zigong: From whom did Zhongni learn? Zigong said: The Way of Kings Wen and Wu has not fallen to the ground; it lives among people. The worthy remember its great parts, the unworthy its small parts; there is no one without something of the Way of Wen and Wu. From whom did the Master not learn? And what need had he of a fixed teacher?

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 35 of 38 (previous 19.21, next 19.23)

People King Wu of Zhou: appearance 2 of 3 (previous 8.20, next 20.1)

People King Wen of Zhou: appearance 3 of 3 (previous 9.5)

People Gongsun Chao of Wei: appears only here

Other books Three Character Classic, lesson 30: Confucius took Xiang Tuo as his teacher: he had no fixed teacher and learned from anyone who had the Way.
Yikonglu's comparison

— Analects 19.22 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.22 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.23

Day 360 of the calendar · every December 26

叔孙武叔语大夫于朝，曰：子贡贤于仲尼。子服景伯以告子贡。子贡曰：譬之宫墙，赐之墙也及肩，窥见室家之好。夫子之墙数仞，不得其门而入，不见宗庙之美，百官之富。得其门者或寡矣。夫子之云，不亦宜乎！

Shusun Wushu said to the ministers at court: Zigong is worthier than Zhongni. Zifu Jingbo told Zigong. Zigong said: Compare it to the walls of a house. My wall reaches only to the shoulder, so one can peer over and see the fine rooms inside. The Master's wall is many yards high; unless one finds the gate and goes in, one cannot see the beauty of the ancestral temple or the richness of its many officers. Those who find the gate may be few. That the gentleman should say so — is it not natural?

This chapter connects to

See also 14.38: Gongbo Liao slandered Zilu to Jisun. Zifu Jingbo reported it, saying: My master has…

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 36 of 38 (previous 19.22, next 19.24)

People Zifu Jingbo: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 14.38)

People Shusun Wushu: appearance 1 of 2 (next 19.24)

— Analects 19.23 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.23 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.24

Day 361 of the calendar · every December 27

叔孙武叔毁仲尼。子贡曰：无以为也，仲尼不可毁也。他人之贤者，丘陵也，犹可逾也；仲尼，日月也，无得而逾焉。人虽欲自绝，其何伤于日月乎？多见其不知量也！

Shusun Wushu disparaged Zhongni. Zigong said: It is no use; Zhongni cannot be disparaged. The worthiness of other men is like hills and mounds, which can still be climbed over. Zhongni is like the sun and moon, which no one can climb over. Though a man may wish to cut himself off from them, what harm does that do the sun and moon? It only shows he does not know his own measure.

This chapter connects to

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 37 of 38 (previous 19.23, next 19.25)

People Shusun Wushu: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 19.23)

— Analects 19.24 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.24 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 19.25

Day 362 of the calendar · every December 28

陈子禽谓子贡曰：子为恭也，仲尼岂贤于子乎？子贡曰：君子一言以为知，一言以为不知，言不可不慎也。夫子之不可及也，犹天之不可阶而升也。夫子之得邦家者，所谓立之斯立，道之斯行，绥之斯来，动之斯和。其生也荣，其死也哀，如之何其可及也。

Chen Ziqin said to Zigong: You are just being modest. How could Zhongni be worthier than you? Zigong said: A gentleman is judged wise by one word and foolish by one word; one cannot be careless in speech. That the Master cannot be equaled is like the sky, which cannot be climbed by steps. If the Master had obtained a state or a family to govern, it would have been as they say: he sets them up and they stand, he guides them and they go, he comforts them and they come, he moves them and they live in harmony. In life he was honored, in death he was mourned. How could he be equaled?

This chapter connects to

People Chen Kang (Ziqin): appearance 3 of 3 (previous 16.13)

People Zigong (Duanmu Ci): appearance 38 of 38 (previous 19.24)

— Analects 19.25 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/19.25 original page, recitation, video, errata

Book 20 · Yao yue

Analects 20.1

Day 363 of the calendar · every December 29

尧曰：咨！尔舜！天之历数在尔躬。允执其中。四海困穷，天禄永终。舜亦以命禹。曰：予小子履，敢用玄牡，敢昭告于皇皇后帝：有罪不敢赦。帝臣不蔽，简在帝心。朕躬有罪，无以万方；万方有罪，罪在朕躬。周有大赉，善人是富。虽有周亲，不如仁人。百姓有过，在予一人。谨权量，审法度，修废官，四方之政行焉。兴灭国，继绝世，举逸民，天下之民归心焉。所重：民、食、丧、祭。宽则得众，信则民任焉，敏则有功，公则说。

Yao said: Ah, you, Shun! The succession ordained by Heaven rests in your person. Hold faithfully to the middle. If all within the four seas suffer hardship, Heaven's bounty will end forever. Shun likewise charged Yu with this. Tang said: I, the little one, Lü, dare to offer a black bull and dare to announce plainly to the most august Lord on High: the guilty I dare not pardon; your servants I will not conceal; the choice rests in your heart, O Lord. If I myself am guilty, let it not fall on the people of the myriad lands; if the people of the myriad lands are guilty, let the guilt rest on me. Zhou bestowed great gifts, and good men were enriched. 'Though I have close kin, they are not equal to humane men. If the people have faults, they rest on me alone.' He set weights and measures with care, examined the statutes, restored the offices that had lapsed, and government prevailed in all four quarters. He revived states that had been destroyed, restored lines that had been cut off, raised up men who had withdrawn, and the people of the realm gave him their hearts. What he gave weight to: the people, food, mourning, and sacrifice. Generosity wins the many; good faith earns the people's reliance; diligence brings results; fairness brings contentment.

This chapter connects to

See also 17.6: Zizhang asked Confucius about humaneness. Confucius said: One who can practice five…

People Yao: appearance 4 of 4 (previous 14.45)

People Shun: appearance 7 of 7 (previous 15.4)

People Yu: appearance 4 of 4 (previous 14.6)

People King Wu of Zhou: appearance 3 of 3 (previous 19.22)

People Tang of Shang: appearance 2 of 2 (previous 12.22)

Other books Daodejing, ch. 29: Emperor Xuanzong's commentary uses "the succession of Heaven rests on you", from Yao's words when handing the throne to Shun. a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 78: Lü Huiqing, explaining “Who bears the state's disgrace is called lord of the altars,” quotes Tang: “If the people of the myriad regions have sinned, the guilt lies with me.” These words are in the Analects, in “Yao Said.” a commentator's reading

Other books Daodejing, ch. 80: Jiao Hong records Wang Pang's note: the Analects and the Mencius both end by naming Yao, Shun, Yu and Tang; Laozi closes with this chapter for the same purpose. a commentator's reading

— Analects 20.1 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/20.1 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 20.2

子张问于孔子曰：何如斯可以从政矣？子曰：尊五美，屏四恶，斯可以从政矣。子张曰：何谓五美？子曰：君子惠而不费，劳而不怨，欲而不贪，泰而不骄，威而不猛。子张曰：何谓惠而不费？子曰：因民之所利而利之，斯不亦惠而不费乎？择可劳而劳之，又谁怨？欲仁而得仁，又焉贪？君子无众寡，无小大，无敢慢，斯不亦泰而不骄乎？君子正其衣冠，尊其瞻视，俨然人望而畏之，斯不亦威而不猛乎？子张曰：何谓四恶？子曰：不教而杀，谓之虐。不戒视成，谓之暴。慢令致期，谓之贼。犹之与人也，出纳之吝；谓之有司。

Zizhang asked Confucius: What must one do to take part in government? The Master said: Honor the five excellences and banish the four evils; then you may take part in government. Zizhang said: What are the five excellences? The Master said: The gentleman is generous without being wasteful, works the people without their resenting it, desires without being greedy, is at ease without being arrogant, and is commanding without being fierce. Zizhang said: What is meant by generous without being wasteful? The Master said: To benefit the people by what benefits them — is that not generous without being wasteful? To choose what work is fit and have them do it — who will resent it? To desire humaneness and attain it — what greed is there? The gentleman, whether dealing with many or few, with great or small, never dares be negligent — is that not being at ease without arrogance? The gentleman straightens his robe and cap and makes his gaze dignified, so that people look on him with awe — is that not commanding without being fierce? Zizhang said: What are the four evils? The Master said: To execute without having taught is called cruelty. To

demand results without having given warning is called tyranny. To be slack in giving orders yet insist on deadlines is called harming. And to give to people grudgingly, as if one were the clerk in charge of stores — that is called being a petty official.

This chapter connects to

Same question Asked about government — Asked 10 times; see also 12.7 "Enough food. Enough arms. The people's trust" · 12.11 "Let the ruler be a ruler, the minister a minister, the father a father, the son a son" · 12.14 "Hold the post without weariness; carry it out with loyalty" · 12.17 "To govern is to set right" · 12.19 "In governing, why use killing?" · 13.1 "Go before them; work hard for them" · 13.2 "Lead your officials, pardon small faults, promote the worthy and talented" · 13.16 "Those near are pleased, those far off come" · 13.17 "Do not seek speed; do not look to small gains"

People Zizhang (Zhuansun Shi): appearance 20 of 20 (previous 19.16)

— Analects 20.2 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/20.2 original page, recitation, video, errata

Analects 20.3

Day 365 of the calendar · every December 31

子曰：不知命，无以为君子也。不知礼，无以立也。不知言，无以知人也。

The Master said: Without knowing fate, one cannot be a gentleman. Without knowing ritual, one cannot stand. Without knowing words, one cannot know people.

This chapter connects to

Variant The base text has “子曰”; the standard text has “孔子曰”

— Analects 20.3 · Yikonglu yikonglu.com/en/lunyu/20.3 original page, recitation, video, errata

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Que, musician for the fourth meal 18.9

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Calendar: a chapter a day

From 1 January 2027 the whole book is read in 365 lessons, the same chapter on the same day every year. Find your birthday — that chapter is your birthday chapter.

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January 6	6	1.8
January 7	7	1.9
January 8	8	1.10
January 9	9	1.11
January 10	10	1.12
January 11	11	1.13
January 12	12	1.14
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January 15	15	2.1
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February 7	38	3.8
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February 9	40	3.10 3.11
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February 15	46	3.21
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February 21	52	4.3 4.4
February 22	53	4.5
February 23	54	4.6
February 24	55	4.7
February 25	56	4.8
February 26	57	4.9 4.10
February 27	58	4.11 4.12
February 28	59	4.13 4.14
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March 3	62	4.18 4.19
March 4	63	4.20 4.21
March 5	64	4.22 4.23 4.24
March 6	65	4.25
March 7	66	4.26
March 8	67	5.1
March 9	68	5.2 5.3
March 10	69	5.4 5.5
March 11	70	5.6
March 12	71	5.7
March 13	72	5.8
March 14	73	5.9
March 15	74	5.10 5.11
March 16	75	5.12 5.13
March 17	76	5.14

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March 19	78	5.16 5.17
March 20	79	5.18
March 21	80	5.19 5.20
March 22	81	5.21
March 23	82	5.22 5.23
March 24	83	5.24
March 25	84	5.25
March 26	85	5.26 5.27
March 27	86	6.1
March 28	87	6.2
March 29	88	6.3
March 30	89	6.4 6.5
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April 10	100	6.19
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April 20	110	7.8 7.9
April 21	111	7.10
April 22	112	7.11
April 23	113	7.12 7.13
April 24	114	7.14
April 25	115	7.15
April 26	116	7.16 7.17
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May 5	125	7.31 7.32
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May 8	128	7.36
May 9	129	7.37
May 10	130	8.1

May 11	131	8.2
May 12	132	8.3
May 13	133	8.4
May 14	134	8.5
May 15	135	8.6
May 16	136	8.7
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May 19	139	8.13
May 20	140	8.14 8.15 8.16
May 21	141	8.17 8.18
May 22	142	8.19
May 23	143	8.20
May 24	144	8.21
May 25	145	9.1 9.2
May 26	146	9.3 9.4
May 27	147	9.5
May 28	148	9.6
May 29	149	9.7
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June 9	160	9.23
June 10	161	9.24
June 11	162	9.25
June 12	163	9.26
June 13	164	9.27
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June 15	166	9.30
June 16	167	10.1
June 17	168	10.2
June 18	169	10.3
June 19	170	10.4
June 20	171	10.5
June 21	172	10.6
June 22	173	10.7
June 23	174	10.8
June 24	175	10.9 10.10
June 25	176	10.11 10.12
June 26	177	10.13
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July 4	185	11.7
July 5	186	11.8 11.9
July 6	187	11.10
July 7	188	11.11
July 8	189	11.12
July 9	190	11.13
July 10	191	11.14
July 11	192	11.15
July 12	193	11.16
July 13	194	11.17 11.18
July 14	195	11.19 11.20
July 15	196	11.21
July 16	197	11.22
July 17	198	11.23
July 18	199	11.24
July 19	200	11.25
July 20	201	12.1
July 21	202	12.2
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July 23	204	12.4
July 24	205	12.5
July 25	206	12.6
July 26	207	12.7
July 27	208	12.8
July 28	209	12.9
July 29	210	12.10
July 30	211	12.11

July 31	212	12.12 12.13
August 1	213	12.14 12.15
August 2	214	12.16
August 3	215	12.17 12.18
August 4	216	12.19
August 5	217	12.20
August 6	218	12.21
August 7	219	12.22
August 8	220	12.23 12.24
August 9	221	13.1 13.2
August 10	222	13.3
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August 12	224	13.5 13.6
August 13	225	13.7 13.8
August 14	226	13.9
August 15	227	13.10 13.11
August 16	228	13.12 13.13
August 17	229	13.14
August 18	230	13.15
August 19	231	13.16 13.17
August 20	232	13.18
August 21	233	13.19
August 22	234	13.20
August 23	235	13.21
August 24	236	13.22
August 25	237	13.23
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August 27	239	13.25
August 28	240	13.26 13.27
August 29	241	13.28
August 30	242	13.29 13.30
August 31	243	14.1 14.2
September 1	244	14.3 14.4
September 2	245	14.5
September 3	246	14.6
September 4	247	14.7 14.8
September 5	248	14.9
September 6	249	14.10
September 7	250	14.11 14.12
September 8	251	14.13
September 9	252	14.14
September 10	253	14.15 14.16
September 11	254	14.17
September 12	255	14.18
September 13	256	14.19
September 14	257	14.20 14.21
September 15	258	14.22
September 16	259	14.23 14.24 14.25
September 17	260	14.26
September 18	261	14.27 14.28 14.29
September 19	262	14.30 14.31
September 20	263	14.32 14.33
September 21	264	14.34
September 22	265	14.35 14.36

September 23	266	14.37
September 24	267	14.38
September 25	268	14.39 14.40
September 26	269	14.41
September 27	270	14.42
September 28	271	14.43 14.44
September 29	272	14.45
September 30	273	14.46
October 1	274	14.47
October 2	275	15.1
October 3	276	15.2
October 4	277	15.3 15.4
October 5	278	15.5
October 6	279	15.6
October 7	280	15.7 15.8
October 8	281	15.9
October 9	282	15.10
October 10	283	15.11
October 11	284	15.12 15.13
October 12	285	15.14 15.15
October 13	286	15.16 15.17
October 14	287	15.18 15.19
October 15	288	15.20 15.21 15.22
October 16	289	15.23
October 17	290	15.24
October 18	291	15.25 15.26
October 19	292	15.27 15.28

October 20	293	15.29
October 21	294	15.30 15.31
October 22	295	15.32
October 23	296	15.33
October 24	297	15.34
October 25	298	15.35 15.36 15.37
October 26	299	15.38 15.39 15.40
October 27	300	15.41
October 28	301	16.1
October 29	302	16.2
October 30	303	16.3
October 31	304	16.4
November 1	305	16.5
November 2	306	16.6
November 3	307	16.7
November 4	308	16.8
November 5	309	16.9
November 6	310	16.10
November 7	311	16.11
November 8	312	16.12
November 9	313	16.13
November 10	314	16.14
November 11	315	17.1
November 12	316	17.2 17.3
November 13	317	17.4
November 14	318	17.5
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November 16	320	17.7
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November 18	322	17.9
November 19	323	17.10
November 20	324	17.11
November 21	325	17.12 17.13 17.14
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November 24	328	17.17 17.18
November 25	329	17.19
November 26	330	17.20
November 27	331	17.21
November 28	332	17.22
November 29	333	17.23
November 30	334	17.24
December 1	335	17.25 17.26
December 2	336	18.1
December 3	337	18.2
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December 5	339	18.5
December 6	340	18.6
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December 9	343	18.9
December 10	344	18.10
December 11	345	18.11
December 12	346	19.1 19.2

December 13	347	19.3
December 14	348	19.4 19.5
December 15	349	19.6
December 16	350	19.7 19.8 19.9
December 17	351	19.10 19.11
December 18	352	19.12
December 19	353	19.13 19.14 19.15
December 20	354	19.16 19.17
December 21	355	19.18
December 22	356	19.19
December 23	357	19.20
December 24	358	19.21
December 25	359	19.22
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December 29	363	20.1
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After reading

A new version comes out every month: notes for newly explained chapters, new threads and corrections. Latest version: yikonglu.com/duben.html.

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